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HORMUZ, NUCLEAR PROGRAM AT CENTRE OF DEAL

Breakthrough at last? US, Iran edge closer to war-ending deal

MPOST BUREAU

WASHINGTON/NEW DELHI: The United States and Iran appear to be edging toward a possible agreement to end months of conflict, with officials on both sides signaling progress while continuing to dispute key elements of the proposed deal.

The prospect of a breakthrough emerged on Friday as regional officials and senior US administration figures indicated that negotiations were nearing completion after weeks of mediation efforts. The talks come after a war launched by the United States and Israel against Iran on February 28, a conflict that destabilized the Middle East, disrupted energy supplies and triggered repeated military exchanges across the region. Although a fragile ceasefire has been in place since April 7, sporadic clashes have continued.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said in a post on X that an agreement had “never been closer,” while stressing that a final deal had yet to be concluded. US President Donald Trump amplified Araghchi’s message on social media, but later accused Tehran of misrepresenting the contents of the proposed accord.

“The terms that Iran leaked out to the Fake News have NOTHING to do with agreed text

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FILE PHOTO/PTI

CLOSER LOOK

» Iran FM Abbas Araghchi says agreement has “never been closer,” but says final deal not yet reached

» Trump accuses Iran of leaking false terms, says reported details have “NOTHING” to do with agreed text

» US says deal requires destruction of Iran’s nuclear material, dismantling of nuclear program, open Strait of Hormuz, end to support for terrorist groups

» Washington says frozen Iranian funds will be released only after Tehran meets obligations

India summons the US charge d’affaires again

Trump tries to pin blame on Iran

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India on Friday sharply escalated its diplomatic protest against the United States after three Indian sailors were killed in a strike on a merchant vessel in the Gulf of Oman, summoning US Charge d’Affaires Jason Meeks for the second time this week and describing the American military’s actions against commercial ships carrying Indian crew members as “unacceptable”.

In a strongly worded statement, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said it lodged a fresh protest over what it called the continued attacks by US naval forces on commercial vessels employing Indian seafarers. The government said the incidents had already resulted in the “tragic and avoidable loss” of three Indian lives and raised serious concerns about the safety of civilian shipping in one of the world’s most important maritime corridors.

Additional Secretary (Americas) Nagaraj Naidu conveyed India’s objections to Meeks at the MEA headquarters

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RESTRICTIONS FOR 90 DAYS

Centre caps diesel sales at 200 l/day, bars bulk buyers from fuel pumps

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre has imposed temporary restrictions on the sale of petrol and diesel through retail fuel outlets, capping diesel purchases at 200 litres per vehicle per day and barring industrial, commercial and institutional consumers from buying fuel at petrol pumps. The move comes amid concerns over possible supply disruptions caused by global geopolitical tensions and a sharp rise in fuel demand at retail outlets due to large-scale purchases by bulk consumers. The new rules, notified by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas on June 11, will remain in force for up to 90 days and are aimed at ensuring adequate fuel availability for ordinary consumers and preventing local shortages.

Under the Motor Spirit and High Speed Diesel (Temporary Regulation of Supply through Retail Outlets) Order, 2026, diesel can now be sold only into a vehicle’s fuel tank or a Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO)-approved container. Retail outlets have been directed not to sell more than 200 litres of diesel to a customer or vehicle in a single day. The order also states that fuel purchased under these provisions cannot be resold.

See P9

TAKEAWAYS

» Industrial, commercial and institutional users barred from retail fuel purchases

» Users must source fuel through bulk/consumer pumps

» Restrictions valid for up to 90 days

» Move aims to prevent local shortages amid global supply disruptions

CENTRE TIGHTENS SECURITY FOR RE-EXAM

NEET re-test gets extra time, more rough-work space

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The National Testing Agency (NTA) has announced a series of changes for the NEET (UG) 2026 re-examination on June 21, while the Centre has warned of strict action against any attempt to compromise the test’s integrity after the cancellation of the earlier exam over an alleged paper leak.

The revised measures include an extension of the examination window, additional rough-work space in question booklets, and changes aimed at improving convenience for candidates, including left-handed students. At the same time, the government has stepped up coordination among central and state agencies and strengthened security arrangements to ensure the smooth conduct of the high-stakes medical entrance examination.

NEET (UG) 2026 will be conducted from 2 pm to 5:15 pm, giving candidates a total examination window of 195 minutes. The NTA said the additional 15 minutes have been included to accommodate mandatory invigilation procedures and signing formalities at the beginning and end of the examination.

According to the agency, candidates had previously reported that administrative requirements reduced their effective writing time. The revised schedule is intended to ensure that students can focus fully on attempting the paper without losing time to procedural tasks.

THE NTA has also increased the number of rough-work pages in the question paper booklet from two to four. The extra space is expected to help candidates with calculations, diagrams, reasoning and other working notes during the examination.

Another significant change relates to the placement of rough-work pages. Earlier, they were available only at the end of the booklet. Under the revised format, two rough-work pages will be placed immediately after the instruction page, while the remaining two pages will remain at the end of the booklet. The arrangement will be available in both English and regional-language versions of the question paper.

The agency said the redesign was introduced after receiving feedback from candidates and is expected to be particularly

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NEET (UG) 2026 will be conducted from 2 pm to 5:15 pm, giving candidates a total examination window of 195 minutes

Elon Musk is world’s first trillionaire

NEW YORK: Elon Musk became the world’s first trillionaire on Friday after SpaceX shares surged 23 per cent in their Wall Street debut, lifting the company’s market value to about USD 2.18 trillion. Forbes estimated Musk’s net worth at USD 1.1 trillion as the stock climbed to USD 166.90 from its USD 135 IPO price. The record-breaking USD 75 billion offering surpassed Saudi Aramco’s 2019 listing.

See P9

Amazon reveals data centres used 9 billion litres of water in 2025

SEATTLE: Amazon has, for the first time, publicly disclosed how much water its global data centre operations consume, revealing that facilities it owns and operates directly used about 2.5 billion gallons, or more than 9 billion litres, of water in 2025.

The disclosure comes as data centre operators face increasing questions about the environmental impact of artificial intelligence and the growing demand for electricity and water. Amazon said its water consumption fell by 2 per cent from 2024 levels despite continued expansion of its global data centre network.

The figures were released in a company blog post, where Amazon argued that its facilities are among the most water-efficient in the industry. According to the company, its data centres used 0.12 litres of water per kilowatt-hour of electricity in 2025, lower than figures it presented for rivals Microsoft, Google and Meta.

However, the comparison is not entirely like-for-like. Amazon’s numbers cover its broader operations, while the Google figures cited in the chart focus specifically on Gemini AI data centres, which typically require more cooling because of high-performance graphics

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SC dismisses Natarajan’s plea challenging rejection of Rajya Sabha nomination

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: In a setback to the Congress, the Supreme Court on Friday dismissed Congress leader Meenakshi Natarajan’s plea against rejection of her nomination papers for the Rajya Sabha election from Madhya Pradesh while granting her liberty to raise the challenge in an election petition.

A bench comprising justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and Atul S Chandurkar rejected the argument by senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi, appearing for Natarajan, that Article 32 can be invoked to cure “glaring and manifest” errors in the rejection of her nomination.

The apex court said whenever an attempt has been made to invoke the jurisdiction of this court under Article 32, or that of the High Courts under Article 226, during the process of elections, it has repeatedly declined interference due to the constitutional mandate contained in Article 329(b) of the Constitution.

Article 329 of the Constitution bars courts from interfering in electoral matters, ensuring elections proceed without judicial delays.

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IMD confirms El Nino, raises concerns over monsoon rainfall

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The India Meteorological Department (IMD) on Friday officially declared the onset of El Nino conditions over the equatorial Pacific Ocean, saying the phenomenon is expected to strengthen further during the ongoing southwest monsoon season, a development that could influence rainfall patterns across India in the coming months.

In its latest ENSO and Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) bulletin, the weather office said warming in the central and eastern tropical Pacific Ocean has crossed the threshold required for El Nino conditions. The IMD noted that the atmosphere has also responded to the rise in sea surface temperatures, confirming

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Food costs push May retail inflation up to 3.93%

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Retail inflation rose to 3.93 per cent in May from 3.48 per cent in April, driven mainly by higher food prices and the early impact of rising fuel costs on the broader economy, according to data released by the National Statistics Office (NSO).

Inflation in the food basket increased to 4.78 per cent in May from 4.2 per cent in the previous month. The rise comes as higher global energy prices have begun feeding into domestic petrol and diesel rates, raising transportation and input costs across sectors.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), which uses Consumer Price Index (CPI)-based inflation as a key measure for monetary policy decisions, has been tasked with keeping headline inflation at 4 per cent, with a tolerance band of 2 percentage points on either side.

NSO data showed that precious metal jewellery, tomato, ginger, raisin (kishmish) and monacca recorded the highest inflation among key items in May. In contrast, potato, peas, motor car and jeep, cumin (jeera), and motorcycle and scooter were among the items with the lowest inflation levels.

The inflation data comes days after the RBI revised its inflation forecast for the current

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Architect of India’s shooting revolution is gone

Jaspal Rana passes away at 49 after a recent heart attack and subsequent complications

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Jaspal Rana, one of India’s most decorated shooters and the coach credited with guiding Manu Bhaker to her historic twin bronze medals at the Paris Olympics, died on Friday at the age of 49 following complications arising from a heart condition. His death has sent shockwaves through Indian sport, bringing to an abrupt end a career that spanned decades as a champion shooter, mentor and architect of India’s rise as a global shooting power.

Rana, who was serving as the National Rifle Association of India (NRAI) high-performance coach for the 25m pistol discipline, died at Max Super Speciality Hospital in Saket after suffering a sudden cardiac rupture. He is survived by his wife Reena Rana, daughter Devanshi, son Yuvraj, father Narayan Singh Rana, sister Sushma Singh and brother Subhash Rana.

According to NRAI president Kalikesh Narayan Singh Deo, Rana breathed his last on Thursday night. His last rites are scheduled to be held in Varanasi on Saturday.

Doctors said the former champion had

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CLOSER LOOK

» Rana was India’s 25m pistol high-performance coach

» Fell ill returning from ISSF World Cup, Munich; underwent stent procedure

» Died at Max Hospital, Saket, after a sudden cardiac rupture during recovery

» Guided Manu Bhaker to her historic two bronze medals at the Paris Olympics

» Mentored Saurabh Chaudhary, Anish Bhanwala and Chinki Yadav

» Won first national gold at age 12

» Claimed 1994 Commonwealth and Asian Games golds

» Won 3 golds and 1 silver at the 2006 Asian Games

» India’s most successful Commonwealth Games shooter with 15 medals (9 gold)

» AWARDS: ARJUNA (1994), PADMA SHRI (1997), DRONACHARYA (2020)

BACK FOR FAMILY, LOST TO FIRE

Final act of love: Govindpuri fire victim re-entered blaze to save family, say locals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Pankaj, one of the victims of Delhi's Govindpuri building fire, nearly survived when locals initially pulled him out alive. However, in a devastating final act of love, the 28-year-old rushed back into the flames to look for his family members and did not return. The massive fire that broke out in a five-storey residential building in southeast Delhi's Govindpuri area in the early hours of Friday killed three people and critically injured two. According to police, a PCR call regarding the blaze was received at the Govindpuri police station at around 2.31 am.

The deceased were identified as Pankaj (28), his maternal grandmother Sushila Devi (70) and his sister Soni (20), all residents of the third floor of the building, police said. Pankaj's other sister Moni (18) and his mother Guddi Devi (50) sustained critical injuries and are undergoing treatment. "The incident still sends a chill down our spine. It was the early morning hours, everything was quiet one minute and then it was filled with screams of people asking to be rescued,"



A police official stands guard near a cordon after a fire broke out in a five-storey residential building at Tughlakabad Extension area, in New Delhi, on Friday

an eyewitness told PTI. Saurabh Sharma, a neighbour of the victims, said that as soon as the fire raged, locals rushed to help in one way or another. "In one such rescue bid, we almost saved Pankaj. As soon as the fire officials brought the fire under control, we ran into the building to search for survivors," he said. He further added that they found Pankaj in one of the

rooms on the ground floor. "I was so relieved when I found him. We caught him by the shoulders and rushed him out of the building while he was in a semi-conscious state," he said. But Pankaj cared about neither his safety nor life, according to Sharma. "As we were bringing him outside, all he wanted to know was about his family. Then he did the unthinkable. In a des-

perate attempt to find his family members, he immediately ran back into the building amid the blaze," he told PTI. Locals said that he almost made it to the second floor of the building, but due to the suffocating smoke, his breathing slowed down and he was found completely unconscious on the same floor by first responders. Pankaj lost his life in the heart-breaking courageous attempt.

The scenes during the rescue operation depicted not just agony and fear -- as the locals kept hearing screams of the trapped people -- but also several selfless attempts by neighbours to save lives. Renu Bhutani, a neighbour, said the blast sounded almost like an explosion. "My son and I immediately rushed to the backside of the building to help residents. The terrace door was locked and, due to the heat, we were unable to open it. "We got onto the terrace of an adjacent four-storey building, from which we suspended a wooden ladder onto the top of the burning five-storey building," she said. Bhubani said she and her son Manav managed to get onto the terrace and decided to make use of the five to six water tanks there, each storing up to a thousand litres of water. "We quickly picked up stones and started hitting the pipeline system connecting the tanks to use the water to cool down the heated terrace gate. The pipes finally broke, releasing bouts of water onto the gate, making it possible for us to open it," she said. "After finally being able to

open the door, there was intense heat hitting us from within the building. To bear the heat, we poured buckets of water over ourselves, rushed in and rescued people from the other floors," she said. Locals residents said around nine families lived in the building, but many of them were away on vacation at the time of the incident. Combined with the swift response of neighbours and local residents, this helped prevent a higher death toll, they claimed. Police said that preliminary inquiry suggests that the fire may have originated due to an electrical short circuit on the ground floor of the building and that at least six two-wheelers, including motorcycles, scooters and a bicycle, caught fire. A senior MCD official said that the colony in which the building is situated is an unauthorised regularised settlement. "The building is also an unauthorised regularised structure; we are looking into the matter and an investigation is ongoing," the official said. Another police officer said that multiple teams have been deployed to properly investigate the matter.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and others pay tribute to citizens who lost their life in the tragic incidents of Malviya Nagar and Saidulajab during a meeting, in New Delhi, on Friday

CM honours bravehearts

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief minister Rekha Gupta on Friday felicitated rescuers and local people who saved lives in the recent Malviya Nagar fire tragedy and Saidulajab building collapse. She also paid tributes to the victims of the tragedy. Twenty-three people were killed in the fire at a hotel in Malviya Nagar last week, while six died in the collapse of a building in Saidul Ajab earlier. At a special programme held at the Delhi Secretariat, the chief minister met and honoured citizens, police personnel, administrative officials and rescue workers who risked their own lives to save others. The bravehearts were presented with commendation certificates and cheques of Rs 21,000 each in recognition of their efforts, a Delhi CMO statement said.

Gupta honoured Riyazuddin Mansoori, who displayed presence of mind during the Malviya Nagar fire incident by laying out mattresses from his shop that helped save several lives, the statement said. Appreciating his humanitarian effort, she ensured reimbursement of the cost of the mattresses he used and also presented him with a cheque of Rs 21,000, the CMO said. The chief minister expressed condolences to the bereaved families and said the Delhi government would provide an ex-gratia payment of Rs 10 lakh to the family members of each victim in the two incidents. In addition, financial assistance of Rs two lakh will be provided to those injured, she said. She directed officials to ensure that the relief and compensation are disbursed swiftly, transparently and within a fixed timeframe so that affected families receive immediate support. Those honoured by the chief minister included Chander Prakash, district project officer, South District Disaster Management Authority, inspector Ritesh Kumar Sharma of Delhi Police, constables Manish Kumar Jangid and Vivek Shukla and Angad Meena, local residents Kapil Giri and Harjeet Kumar and Dr Rafiq Khan for their bravery in Saidulajab building collapse incident. She also honoured Israr Khan, Kamal Kumar, Shashi Kumar, Pawan Kumar, Rakesh Kumar, Sanjay Goyal, Shiv Kumar, Govind, Kunal, Mohammad Uwais, Mohammad Afzal, Mohammad Anees, Aamir Khan, Wasim Raja, Mohammad Sohaib Khan, Riyazuddin, Wasim Khan Gauri, Rajpal, inspector Vinay Yadav, head constables Dinesh, Kartar, Rajveer and Deshraj, for their courageous role in rescue efforts during the Malviya Nagar fire, the statement said.



Man arrested in dowry abuse case

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police's SPUWAC team has arrested a 32-year-old man in connection with a dowry harassment case. The accused has been identified as Girish Anand (32), a resident of Ludhiana, Punjab. According to the police, the accused was arrested on June 11 by the staff of the Police Station Crime Against Women Cell (CWC), Special Police Unit for Women and Children (SPUWAC). Police officials said the arrest was made through sustained technical surveillance and the development of local intelligence inputs, which helped track the accused after prolonged efforts. The accused, Girish Anand, was wanted in connection with an FIR registered under Sections 498A, 406, and 34 of the Indian Penal Code at the CWC Police Station, SPUWAC, on September 6, 2019. The case pertains to allegations of dowry harassment and related offences. The accused had been declared a proclaimed offender by the court of Ms. Abhila-sha Singh, Judicial Magistrate First Class (JMFC), Mahila Court, Dwarka, on April 26,

2025, after repeatedly failing to appear before the court during trial proceedings. Following the proclamation order, efforts were intensified to trace and apprehend him. The operation was carried out on the directions of Ms. Neha Yadav, IPS, Deputy Commissioner of Police, SPUWAC. A dedicated police team was constituted under the leadership of Inspector Saroj Singh, Station House Officer of PS CWC, and supervised by ACP Renukata. The team comprised ASI Om Prakash, Head Constable Keshar Dev Plaiwal, Head Constable Dinesh Kumar and Head Constable Kapil. Police officials stated that the successful apprehension demonstrates the department's commitment to ensuring that accused persons do not evade the judicial process. Following his arrest, the proclaimed offender was taken into custody and further legal proceedings have been initiated in accordance with the law. Delhi Police said CWC Police Station, SPUWAC remains committed to safeguarding the rights of women, ensuring justice in cases of harassment and abuse, and taking strict action against offenders who attempt to abscond from legal proceedings.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of Delhi Police has arrested a man for allegedly cheating more than 20 unemployed youths of around Rs 5.5 lakh on the false promise of securing contractual jobs at Guru Teg Bahadur (GTB) Hospital in east Delhi, police said on Friday. The accused, identified as Manish Kumar, was arrested from GTB Enclave in Shahdara on June 9 after allegedly evading arrest by frequently changing locations. Police said Manish, who did a B.Sc in nursing, had allegedly

developed a gambling habit and accumulated debts. To repay those liabilities, he allegedly devised a job scam targeting unemployed youths. According to police, the case was registered on the complaint of Krishan Pal and 22 other victims who alleged that Manish promised them jobs as Data Entry Operators and Nursing Assistants at GTB Hospital on a contractual basis with a monthly salary of around Rs 21,000, police said in an official statement. To gain their trust, the accused allegedly claimed that his father held a senior position at GTB Hospital and that

he had strong connections within the hospital administration, enabling him to facilitate appointments. Additional Commissioner of Police (EOW) Ravi Kumar Singh said. Believing his claims, the victims submitted their educational certificates, Aadhaar cards, PAN cards and other personal documents to him. He then allegedly collected between Rs 20,000 and Rs 25,000 from each victim as a security deposit for the purported recruitment process, he said. Police said the accused continued to assure the complainants that the recruitment process was underway and later

claimed that the vacancies had been temporarily put on hold. He allegedly promised that appointment letters would be issued within 45 days. However, when no jobs materialised, and the victims repeatedly sought updates, the accused allegedly stopped answering calls, switched off his mobile phone and went into hiding. During the investigation, police verified with GTB Hospital authorities, who confirmed that no recruitment process for the posts of Nursing Assistant or Data Entry Operator was underway during the relevant period.

Two Gzb criminals carrying Rs 50K bounty shot, arrested after encounter

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two criminals carrying rewards of Rs 50,000 each and wanted in a sensational kidnapping-murder case in Ghaziabad were arrested after an exchange of fire with the Delhi Police in south Delhi, an official said on Friday. The accused, Saurabh alias Bhola alias Prince (25) and Gopal (23), both residents of Loni in Ghaziabad, sustained bullet injuries to their legs during the encounter near Aurobindo College in Malviya Nagar in the early hours of Thursday, police said. They were admitted to the hospital under police security. Police said the two were wanted in separate cases relating to the alleged kidnapping and murder of a man in Ghaziabad and had been evading arrest for nearly two weeks. According to the Crime Branch, specific intelligence was received that the duo had

entered Delhi and were allegedly planning to carry out a murder over an old rivalry. Acting on the input, police laid a trap near Aurobindo College. "At 2 am, police spotted the suspects riding a motorcycle and signalled them to stop. Instead, they allegedly attempted to flee and opened fire on the police team using sophisticated semi-automatic pistols," police said. Officials said Saurabh allegedly fired four rounds from a .32-bore Beretta semi-automatic pistol made in Italy, while Gopal allegedly fired two rounds from a .30-bore semi-automatic pistol. During the exchange of fire, ACP Satendra Mohan was struck by a bullet on his bullet-proof jacket, police said. The police retaliated in self-defence. A case has been registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Arms Act. Police recovered

the weapons, four live cartridges and a stolen motorcycle — found to be linked to a theft case registered at Delhi's Sarai Rohilla police station — from the accused. According to investigators, the accused were involved in a violent feud in their native village in Loni. Police said Gopal's brother was allegedly murdered earlier, after which the duo and their associates allegedly conspired to take revenge. As part of the alleged revenge plot, they first attempted to attack a man named Devansh, who managed to escape. Subsequently, they allegedly kidnapped Devansh's father, Omkaar, assaulted him, murdered him, and disposed of his body in the Ganga canal, police said. Two cases related to the attack on Devansh and the kidnapping and murder of Omkaar are being investigated by the Ghaziabad Police.

NOBLE CAUSE



As many as 82 Delhi Police personnel donated blood at a camp organised at the Police Headquarters here on Friday ahead of World Blood Donor Day, an official said. The blood donation camp was organised by the Welfare Division of Delhi Police in collaboration with AIIMS Delhi under the supervision of Special Commissioner of Police (Vigilance, Welfare and Licensing) Atul Katiyar

MPOST

FOR GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING

UP CM Yogi Adityanath flags off 45 e-buses

DIIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Friday flagged off 45 electric buses for Gautam Buddha Nagar through video conferencing from Lok Bhavan in Lucknow and inaugurated the Noida Electric Bus Depot. The electric buses, operated by the Uttar Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (UPSRTC), will serve commuters across Noida, Greater Noida and the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) area. Officials said the initiative is expected to provide residents



with a modern, comfortable and environment-friendly transport option while reducing dependence on conventional diesel-powered vehicles. The main launch event was held at Lok Bhavan, where senior officials from the transport and industrial development

departments were present. Public representatives and administrative officers from Gautam Buddha Nagar also joined the programme virtually. Along with the rollout of the new fleet, the chief minister inaugurated the Noida Electric Bus Depot, which has been

developed to support the operation of the buses. The depot will function as the primary hub for charging, maintenance and fleet management. Officials said the facility will play a crucial role in ensuring smooth operations and facilitate the future expansion of electric bus services in the district. The state government has been actively promoting electric mobility as part of its broader strategy to reduce pollution and develop a cleaner urban transport ecosystem. According to transport department officials, the induction of electric buses will help lower carbon emissions and contribute to improved air

quality in rapidly growing urban centres. The initiative is also expected to strengthen public transport connectivity to the upcoming Jewar International Airport. Authorities said the new services would provide better access for passengers travelling between Noida, Greater Noida and the airport region, enhancing mobility and supporting future infrastructure growth. Officials added that the number of electric buses in the district is likely to increase in the coming years to meet rising demand and further improve seamless, sustainable transportation across the region.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: An alleged sex racket operating from a building in central Delhi's Paharganj area was busted, with police rescuing four women and arresting a 29-year-old man, officials said on Friday. The accused, Shahrukh, a resident of Laxmi Nagar, was arrested following a raid at Saran Building on Qutub Road in Paharganj, police said. According to Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh, police received specific information on Thursday evening about an alleged sex racket being oper-

ated from the premises. As part of the operation, constable Feru was deployed as a decoy customer to verify the information. After confirming the illegal activity, the police team conducted a raid at the premises and apprehended the accused, the officer said. During the raid, four women aged between 20 and 34 years were rescued from the building. Police registered a case under Sections 3, 4 and 5 of the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act (ITP Act) in connection with the case. Police said separate legal action was also initiated against the owner of the rented prem-

ises, identified as Harikishan alias Raju Champion (58), a resident of Dwarka. A case under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) has been registered against him. Evidence linked to the alleged illegal activity was seized during the raid and taken into police possession, they said. Investigators are probing the accused's role in operating the racket and are trying to identify other persons connected with the network. The accused's previous criminal involvement is also being verified, the police added.

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‘REVIVAL REMAINS GOVT’S TOP PRIORITY’

Mission Yamuna: No let-up, says CM

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With the Yamuna cleanup emerging as one of the Delhi government's top priorities, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday said efforts to restore the heavily polluted river were being carried out through a comprehensive, multi-pronged strategy, even as the Centre intensified monitoring of the project through periodic reviews.

"Cleaning the Yamuna is one of our government's top priorities, and the work is being carried out with detailed planning and a clear roadmap," Gupta said. Highlighting progress in strengthening Delhi's sewage treatment infrastructure, she said, "We are upgrading all existing Sewage Treatment Plants to ensure they meet the required standards, and that work is almost complete. Tenders for 12 new STPs have already been awarded. This is a long process, but the work is moving ahead steadily."

The Centre has also tightened its oversight of the river rejuvenation exercise. Taking serious note of the Yamuna's deteriorating condition, Union Home Minister Amit Shah recently directed that the river's status be reviewed every 20 days. Under a time-bound roadmap, a target has been set to establish 59 new Sewage Treatment Plants by 2027, with regular assessments to track progress.

Gupta said the government was addressing all major sources

MISSION MODE

» Cleaning the Yamuna is one of our government's top priorities, and the work is being carried out with detailed planning and a clear roadmap: CM Rekha

» 'We are upgrading all existing Sewage Treatment Plants to ensure they meet the required standards, and that work is almost complete. Tenders for 12 new STPs have already been awarded. This is a long process, but the work is moving ahead steadily'



of pollution entering the river. "We are in constant touch with neighbouring authorities to stop untreated discharge from drains entering Delhi. We are also taking strict action against industrial waste flowing into the Yamuna. I want to assure the people that no aspect of this work is being neglected," she

said. Speaking about waste management efforts linked to the cleanup drive, the Chief Minister said, "Two biogas plants are almost ready to become operational, while work on six more is underway. This year, we are aiming to remove 20,000 to 22,000 metric tonnes of waste. Last year, around 20,000 metric tonnes were cleared. We will have to work simultaneously on every segment if we want lasting results."

As part of efforts to turn the river restoration exercise into a public movement, the Delhi government will organise the 'Yamuna Riverfront Cleanliness Campaign 2026' on June 14. Nearly 500 social, religious, educational and voluntary organisations are expected to participate in cleanliness drives and awareness programmes at major ghats.

Emphasising the need for public participation, Gupta said, "The Yamuna is not merely a river; it is an integral part of Delhi's cultural, religious and environmental heritage. Cleaning it cannot be a one-day exercise. Only through collective participation can we realise the vision of a clean, rejuvenated and life-giving Yamuna." The renewed push for Yamuna rejuvenation comes even as water quality remains a major concern for many Delhi residents. Several neighbourhoods, including affluent areas such as Gulmohar Park, have recently reported contaminated water supply linked to ageing pipelines.

CM hails 12 years of PM Modi's governance

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday highlighted various achievements of the Modi government over the last 12 years, saying that India has been on a "historic" journey of change and transformation under the leadership of the prime minister.

In a joint press conference with Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra, Gupta said the last 12 years under Modi's leadership marked achievements in various fields and earned the "unshakeable" trust of 140 crore people.

Modi set the record for the longest-serving elected prime minister on June 10, coinciding with the BJP's 12 years in power at the Centre.

Gupta said Modi has scripted a new definition of



Delhi BJP state president Harsh Malhotra along with CM addresses a PC

change and transformation in urban transport, witnessing the Metro rail network expand to over 1,000 kilometres in the last 14 years, India emerging as the third-biggest aviation mar-

ket, and digital transformation.

She said 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' led to a sixfold growth in electronics manufacturing during the period, defence sector corridors were set up in UP

DTC introduces three routes: Connectivity push across city

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: With the aim to improve connectivity, the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) has introduced three new routes in the city, transport minister Pankaj Singh said on Friday.

The DTC introduced a new Route 806A, launched Devi Route D-6606, and extended the existing Route RL-79 to better serve residents in rapidly growing residential and peripheral areas of Delhi.

"These route additions and extensions have been planned after carefully assessing the mobility needs of residents living in emerging residential clusters and peripheral localities," Singh said.

According to the minister, by improving first and last-mile connectivity, we are ensuring that more citizens can seamlessly access metro stations, major transport hubs, educational institutions and workplaces, he added.

The newly introduced Route 806A, operating between Dwarka Mor and Paprawat village on a pilot basis, will provide direct connectivity to residents of Paprawat, Nangli Sakrawati, Kakrola and adjoining localities.

The route addresses a long-standing demand for improved public transport services in the rural-urban fringe areas of South-West Delhi.

"DTC has launched Devi

Route D-6606 connecting Uttam Nagar Terminal with DDA Flats Bakkarwala. The route will serve rapidly expanding residential pockets, including Bakkarwala, Kakrola, Matiala and Dwarka sectors," Singh said in a statement.

Further strengthening Delhi's transport network, DTC has extended Route RL-79 beyond Dwarka Sector-23 Pochanpur up to Dwarka Sector-23B (Mahadev Apartments).

The extension will provide direct connectivity between New Delhi Railway Station and newly developed residential areas in Dwarka, significantly improving access to public transport for residents of Sector-23B and nearby colonies.



Britannia Chowk now Ashwini Chopra Chowk

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi government renamed Britannia Chowk in north Delhi to 'Ashwini Chopra (Minna) Chowk' in honour of the late senior journalist, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta announced on Friday.

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Gupta jointly inaugurated the chowk and unveiled the plaque.

Remembering Chopra, a noted journalist, Sandhu said he was not just a journalist or a public representative, but a personality deeply committed to society and the nation.

"His large-heartedness, courage and affection for people made him truly distinctive. It is now the collective responsibility of citizens, the administration and the family to ensure that this chowk becomes one of Delhi's cleanest, most beautiful and well-maintained public spaces," Sandhu said.

The chief minister noted that Chopra dedicated every moment of his life to truth, society and national interest.

"As a fearless journalist, he used his pen to amplify the voice of society and brought issues of public concern into the national discourse," she added.

Chopra was a former Bharatiya Janata Party MP from Karnal, a senior journalist and an editor of a local Hindi daily newspaper.

Chopra was a former BJP MP from Karnal, a senior journalist and an editor of a local Hindi daily newspaper

City Briefs

DERC ALLOWS DELHI DISCOMS TO RECOVER HIGHER POWER PURCHASE COST FOR APRIL

NEW DELHI: Power regulator DERC has allowed Delhi discoms to recover higher FPPA surcharge from consumers due to the rising electricity purchase costs amid the energy crisis triggered by geopolitical tensions, officials said on Friday. The move will impact the consumers not covered by subsidy schemes. However, those getting subsidies (full or 50 per cent) will not be affected. The fuel and power purchase adjustment surcharge (FPPAS) is applied as a percentage of total energy and fixed costs. It is dependent on fuel prices. Recently, there has been a significant increase in coal prices due to higher imports and transport costs, officials said. Delhi's power distribution companies- BRPL, BYPL and TPDDL- in their representations to the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC), in May, sought relaxation on the recovery of FPPAS, which is capped at 10 per cent. In their representation, the discoms had urged the DERC to increase the FPPAS recovery limit for April. They submitted that the actual power purchase cost in April increased significantly as compared to the approved base power purchase cost considered in the prevailing tariff order of September 30, 2021. According to the DERC order, the FPPAS for April stood at 31.5 per cent in the case of BRPL, 35.26 per cent for BYPL, and 16 per cent in the case of TPDDL. The Commission allowed a relaxation in the 10 per cent FPPAS recovery limit to "remove the difficulties" faced by discoms in recovering "a reasonable part" of the increase in the power purchase cost.

DTC LAUNCHES FEEDBACK SURVEY

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) on Friday launched a public survey aimed at understanding the experiences and expectations of commuters, officials said. The exercise requires people to scan a QR code and submit feedback, which is part of an ongoing bus route rationalisation study. "DTC is undertaking a Passenger Feedback Survey, which aims to better understand the travel patterns, experiences and expectations of commuters. The feedback received will help identify areas for improvement and support the development of a more efficient and passenger-centric bus network for Delhi," an official said. The survey is part of the bus route rationalisation study being carried out to improve the efficiency and connectivity of Delhi's bus network. It will require commuters to provide details about their travel habits, including whether they use bus or any other vehicle for commuting, types of passes used and the timings of their journeys. Respondents can also share suggestions to improve bus services.

NDMC launches initiative to strengthen plastic waste mgmt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Friday launched a new initiative aimed at strengthening plastic waste management through scientific collection, segregation, and recycling across the Lutyns' Delhi area.

Named 'Project D.R.O.P.' (Develop Responsible Outlook for Plastic), the initiative has been launched in collaboration with Kia India and the Indian Pollution Control Association (IPCA), according to a statement.

At the launch, NDMC Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal unveiled community bins made from recycled plastic waste and flagged off a collection vehicle that will be used for the systematic collection and

transportation of plastic waste in the NDMC area.

Addressing the event, Chahal said the initiative aligns with the vision of Swachh Bharat, Mission LiFE, and Viksit Bharat @2047, and seeks to promote responsible disposal of plastic waste while encouraging greater public participation in environmental protection.

"NDMC's jurisdiction includes Parliament House, central government offices, embassies and other key institutions, making cleanliness and environmental initiatives in the area significant at both national and international levels," Chahal said in a statement.

NDMC has been working with the IPCA on solid waste management since 2021. As part of the partnership, 115

aerobins have been installed, over 62,900 kg of wet waste processed and more than 10,000 kg of compost produced, he said.

Building on that collaboration, Project D.R.O.P. will facilitate the installation of dedicated plastic collection bins and ensure that plastic waste is channelled through authorised recycling systems, Chahal said.

NDMC Council Member Anil Valmiki said plastic waste poses serious environmental and health challenges and stressed that public participation would be crucial for the success of the initiative.

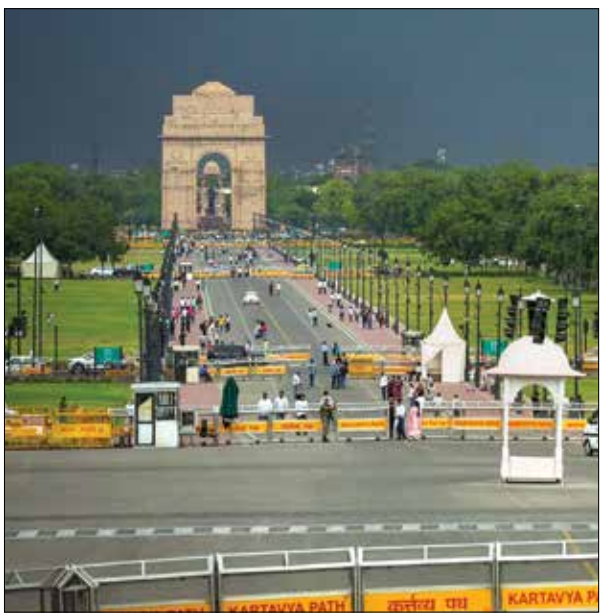
He urged resident welfare associations, market traders' associations and voluntary groups to support efforts towards proper segregation and disposal of plastic waste.

L-G reviews desilting action before monsoon

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu reviewed the desilting action plan with Delhi Development Authority (DDA) ahead of the monsoon season, officials said on Friday. According to officials, during the meeting, detailed assessments were undertaken on the Yamuna Riverfront development as well. "The review also evaluated the time-bound restoration of 101 water bodies under Phase-I, including flagship projects in Dwarka and Rohini and the comprehensive plan to revitalise Yamuna Bazar and the adjoining ghats," officials said. MP05T

RAIN, STORMS BRING RELIEF FROM HEAT

Relief: Capital records coolest June day so far



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Rain and thunderstorm activity brought temperatures down sharply across Delhi on Friday, making it the coolest day of June so far, while the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast more thunderstorms, rain and gusty winds through Saturday.

The maximum temperature at Safdarjung, the city's base station, settled at 34.6 degrees Celsius, 5.3 degrees Celsius below normal and 4.1 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day. The minimum temperature was recorded at 22.8 degrees Celsius, 5.2 degrees Celsius below normal and 7.2 degrees Celsius lower than a day earlier.

At Palam, the maximum temperature was 33.5 degrees Celsius, 6.7 degrees Celsius below normal and 4.3 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day. The minimum temperature was 21.6 degrees Celsius, 6.5 degrees Celsius below normal and 7.0 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day.

At Lodhi Road, the maximum temperature was 33.1 degrees Celsius, 5.9 degrees Celsius below normal and 4.7 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day. The minimum temperature was 22.0 degrees Celsius, 6.0 degrees Celsius below normal and 6.8 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day.

At Ridge, the maximum temperature was 33.6 degrees Celsius, 6.7 degrees Celsius

below normal and 4.5 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day. The minimum temperature was 20.9 degrees Celsius, 5.7 degrees Celsius below normal and 7.5 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day.

At Anagar, the maximum temperature was 33.2 degrees Celsius, 8.3 degrees Celsius below normal and 4.8 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day. The minimum temperature was 22.6 degrees Celsius, 4.9 degrees Celsius below normal and 8.0 degrees Celsius lower than the previous day.

Safdarjung recorded 11.2 mm of rainfall in the 24 hours ending 8.30 am on Friday.

Mahesh Palawat, Vice-President, Meteorology and Climate Change at Skymet Weather, said a Western Dis-

turbance currently affecting the Himalayan region is moving away but will continue to influence the weather over Delhi.

"Delhi is likely to witness thunderstorms, dust storms and strong winds on Friday night and Saturday. Similar weather activity is expected on the following day as well. There could be some discomfort as temperatures start rising again, but humidity levels will also increase," he said.

Palawat noted that winds during Thursday's storm generally remained in the 60-70 kmph range and touched nearly 80 kmph at a few places.

He said that weather conditions are expected to improve after the next two days, following which temperatures will start rising again.

Breakthrough at last? US, Iran edge closer to war-ending deal

Continued from Page 1

Do with the terms that were agreed to, in writing,” Trump wrote on his Truth Social platform. He described Iranian accounts of the negotiations as unrelated to the actual discussions and added: “They better get their act together, and FAST!”

According to three regional officials familiar with the negotiations, the emerging agreement

could lead to the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, the gradual easing of sanctions on Iran and the release of frozen Iranian assets. The officials, speaking on condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the talks, said a formal signing ceremony could take place within days if the deal receives final approval in Washington and Tehran.

However, significant differences remain between the public positions taken by both sides.

A senior US official said the tentative agreement is built around several core conditions. These include the removal and destruction of Iran’s nuclear material, the dismantling of Tehran’s nuclear program, keeping the Strait of Hormuz open to international shipping and a commitment by Iran to stop funding terrorist groups. The official also said that frozen Iranian assets would not be released until Tehran ful-

fills its obligations under the agreement.

“This is what they have agreed to. This is a performance-based deal,” the official said.

Vice President JD Vance echoed that position, rejecting suggestions that Iran would receive immediate financial benefits. “The Iranians are not receiving any cash, and no funds are being released for simply signing a deal or attending a meeting,” Vance said. “If the

Islamic Republic of Iran meets its obligations, then economic benefits will flow to them and to the entire region.”

Iranian officials and state media have presented a different picture of the negotiations. The official IRNA news agency reported that Tehran has not agreed to surrender its enriched nuclear material and intends to retain control over the Strait of Hormuz. Iran has effectively controlled shipping through the

strategic waterway since fighting began, allowing only limited transit and requiring vessels to obtain permission from Iranian authorities.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmaeil Baqaei said no final agreement had been reached. He noted that mediators remained active and that the text of a deal was largely complete, but stressed that negotiations were still ongoing.

Reports carried by Iranian

media outlined a draft framework that would go beyond nuclear issues. According to those reports, the proposal would end hostilities across multiple fronts, including fighting between Israel and Hezbollah in Lebanon. The reported draft also includes the release of \$24 billion in frozen Iranian assets, a 60-day period for negotiations on Tehran’s nuclear activities, suspension of sanctions on Iranian oil and

petrochemical exports and an end to the US naval blockade imposed on Iranian ports since mid-April.

The reported Iranian version also seeks reparations and reconstruction commitments worth at least \$300 billion.

The dispute over the agreement’s contents reflects broader efforts by both sides to portray themselves as negotiating from a position of strength after months of warfare.

From Page 1

India summons

in New Delhi. The ministry said it had also expressed “deep concern” over the use of “lethal and deadly force” against civilian vessels.

“Such actions are unacceptable and undermine the safety, security and stability of international maritime commerce in a sensitive region at a difficult time,” the MEA said. India asked the senior American diplomat to convey New Delhi’s concerns to Washington and ensure that US forces operating in the region take all necessary measures to prevent civilian casualties.

The latest diplomatic move came a day after India publicly confirmed that three merchant ships carrying Indian crew members had been targeted by the US military off the coast of Oman during the past week. The incidents marked New Delhi’s first official acknowledgement that the attacks originated from the US Navy.

According to Indian authorities, the first vessel, the Palau-flagged oil tanker Marivex, carrying 24 Indian seafarers, was disabled by US forces on June 8. All crew members were rescued safely.

A day later, another Palau-flagged tanker, MT Settebello, came under attack. Three Indian sailors on board were killed. The deceased were identified as Patnala Suresh, 44, a marine engineer from Visakhapatnam; Aditya Sharma, 23, an engine fitter from Uttar Pradesh; and Shivanand Chaurasia, 38, a deck cadet trainee from Himachal Pradesh.

The third incident involved Jalveer, a Guinea-Bissau-flagged tanker carrying 20 Indian nationals. The vessel was struck on June 11, but all crew members were reported safe. Jalveer is known to operate freight services between the United Arab Emirates and India.

Union Ports, Shipping and Waterways Minister Sarbananda Sonowal expressed grief over the deaths, saying, “This is a profound loss to our maritime family. The Modi government stands firmly with the bereaved during this difficult hour and is fully committed to supporting the next of kin.”

The Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways said the government had placed all relevant agencies on the “highest” level of alert to safeguard Indian seafarers in the Gulf region. Authorities are closely monitoring developments around the Strait of Hormuz and adjoining waters while coordinating with maritime administrations of friendly countries and shipping companies.

The ministry said recent security incidents had highlighted growing risks for commercial shipping and directed vessel operators, ship managers and shipping companies to strictly follow maritime safety protocols. Indian seafarers travelling through the region have also been advised to exercise caution.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said the attacks on Marivex, Settebello and Jalveer were carried out by the US Navy. He noted that two of the vessels were under sanctions administered by the US Treasury Department’s Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC), while another had been classified as non-compliant.

The US Central Command said it acted against Marivex on June 8, Settebello on June 9 and Jalveer on June 11, alleging that the vessels were attempting to breach a US blockade aimed at restricting access to Iranian ports and were involved in activities violating sanctions linked to Iranian and Russian oil trade.

The developments have also triggered competing claims from Washington and Tehran. US President Donald Trump on Friday accused Iran of carrying out drone

attacks against Indian ships leaving the Strait of Hormuz, calling the alleged action “totally unacceptable” in a post on Truth Social. Trump also accused Tehran of leaking details of a proposed peace arrangement to the media.

Iran, however, directed its criticism at Washington. Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmaeil Baqaei extended condolences to the families of the deceased Indian sailors and to the Indian government. In a statement posted on X, Baqaei said the attacks demonstrated conduct that “continues to threaten global peace and security while endangering the freedom of navigation”.

NEET re-test

useful for left-handed students, who account for nearly 10 per cent of NEET candidates. By providing space at both the front and back of the booklet, the new layout is intended to make working during the examination more comfortable.

In its notice, the NTA said the changes reflect its effort to make the examination process fair, secure and responsive to the needs of candidates. It added that even small modifications in examination design can improve the experience of students appearing for a high-pressure test.

Candidates have been advised to carefully read the instructions provided in their admit cards and information bulletin and cooperate with examination staff for the smooth conduct of the test.

Meanwhile, Cabinet Secretary T. V. Somanathan reviewed preparedness for the re-examination with NTA Director General Abhishek Singh and other stakeholders. He said the central government, state governments and district administrations were working in close coordination to ensure the smooth and secure conduct of the examination.

“The full might and weight of law will fall on any person trying in any manner to distort, disrupt, or tamper with the integrity or smooth conduct of the re-examination,” Somanathan said.

Officials said the Ministry of Home Affairs has directed the CRPF and CISF to provide security during the transportation of question papers. The Cabinet Secretary had earlier reviewed preparations with central government departments on June 1 and with state chief secretaries on June 4.

NEET-UG was originally conducted on May 3 but was cancelled by the NTA on May 12 following allegations of a paper leak. The case is being investigated by the CBI, which has made several arrests as part of the probe.

Delhi fire

Two other family members, Moni, 18, and Guddi Devi, 50, sustained serious injuries and are undergoing treatment. Guddi Devi, who is speech-impaired, remains in critical but stable condition in the intensive care unit of Safdarjung Hospital, according to police.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Southeast) Hemant Tiwari said a PCR call about the fire was received at 2.31 am. Police personnel, fire services and medical teams rushed to the scene and launched evacuation efforts as heavy smoke engulfed the building and trapped residents inside.

Authorities said eight occupants were rescued and shifted to Safdarjung Hospital and the AIIMS Trauma Centre. Firefighters and rescue personnel worked in difficult conditions as smoke spread quickly through the structure.

Preliminary investigations suggest the fire originated from an electrical short circuit on the ground floor. Police said at least six two-wheelers caught fire, while local accounts indicated that as many as seven vehicles, including an electric scooter that was reportedly being charged, were engulfed by the flames. Investigators said

the exact cause will be determined after a detailed inquiry.

Residents played a major role in rescue efforts before emergency teams arrived. Neighbours broke doors, climbed adjoining buildings and used ropes, sarees and wooden planks to help trapped occupants escape.

Renu Bhutani, a local resident, said people were initially recording videos of the incident, but volunteers quickly shifted their focus to rescue work. “Many were recording videos when I shouted at them to stop recording and bring buckets from their houses so that people who got trapped could be saved,” she said.

Another resident, Pawan, said thick smoke moved rapidly to the upper floors. “Residents tied ropes and even sarees to help people climb down,” he said, adding that some people were rescued from the rear side of the building while others were brought out through the front.

Residents also broke water tank pipelines on rooftops and passed buckets of water to volunteers entering the smoke-filled structure. Some used iron cutters to remove window grills and create escape routes.

Several locals said a locked terrace gate may have hampered evacuation efforts. “The terrace gate was locked. If it had been opened in time, perhaps the outcome would have been different,” Pawan said.

According to residents, around nine families lived in the building, though many were away on vacation when the fire broke out, helping prevent a higher death toll.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta expressed grief over the tragedy and offered condolences to the families of the victims. In a statement, she said the loss of lives was deeply saddening and assured that the injured were receiving the best possible medical care and support.

Police, forensic experts and fire authorities have launched a detailed investigation. CCTV footage from nearby buildings is being examined, while civic officials said the building is located in an unauthorised regularised colony and inquiries are underway into possible safety lapses.

The incident comes a week after a major fire at a bed-and-breakfast hotel in Delhi’s Malviya Nagar claimed 23 lives, including several foreign nationals.

Natarajan’s plea

The apex court refused to accept Singhvi’s submission that SC should intervene where the rejection of a nomination is *ex facie* illegal, manifestly arbitrary and demonstrably erroneous.

“To accept the petitioner’s submission would amount to reading into the constitutional scheme an exception which has not been provided by the Constitution itself,” it said.

The top court clarified that any observations made in this order concerning the basis of rejection of the petitioner’s nomination have been made only for the purpose of considering the maintainability of the present proceedings.

“Nothing stated herein shall affect the rights and contentions of the petitioner, or of any other person, in any election petition that may be filed before the competent High Court in accordance with law,” the bench said.

Singhvi submitted that the returning officer acted completely arbitrarily and referred to Section 33A of the Representation of the People Act and said only the criminal cases where charges have been framed by the trial court need to be disclosed in the nomination papers.

The senior lawyer argued that Natarajan has only received the notice under Section 223, and the court has neither taken cognisance of the complaint nor framed charges.

Without cognisance, there is no criminal proceeding in the eyes of law, he said.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for the returned candidate, questioned the maintainability of the plea under Article 32 of the Constitution and said Article 329 creates a constitutional bar.

Rohatgi said the constitutional scheme is that any challenge must ordinarily await the completion of the election process and be raised through the election law mechanism.

An order by the Rajya Sabha election returning officer Arvind Sharma stated that it was found after examining available documents that Natarajan submitted an incomplete affidavit, omitting a court complaint in Form 26 submitted with her nomination.

After the scrutiny of papers, the returning officer on Thursday declared all the three BJP candidates elected unopposed.

Meanwhile, the Congress doubled down on its allegations of collusion between the Election Commission and the BJP, saying it was apparent to everyone that the seat was stolen.

Responding to a question on the Supreme Court dismissing Natarajan’s plea, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge told reporters in Bengaluru that the party would follow the Supreme Court’s directive.

Kharge said the rejection of Natarajan’s nomination was “illegal, immoral and anti-democratic”.

“This wouldn’t have happened without the direction of PM Modi, this is such a big thing. Modi is purposely doing this as part of a conspiracy to finish Congress party, democracy. He has ensured his people are everywhere. People who like him are made returning officers and they are made to do such things (rejecting opposition candidate nominations),” he alleged.

Pointing out that the BJP-backed independent candidate in Jharkhand, Parimal Nathwani, is an industrialist, the AICC chief said, “A person who does not have majority support is a candidate. This means, purchase or divide votes to elect a corporate agent.”

Stating that the Congress had raised objections, accusing Nathwani of providing false and incomplete information in the affidavit attached to his nomination papers, Kharge said, “But he was given time and allowed to rectify (by election officials), but on the other hand, the nomination (of the Congress candidate) in Madhya Pradesh was rejected the same evening. Is this democracy? Is this impartial?”

In her reaction, Natarajan said it was apparent to everyone that “seat chori” had taken place and asserted that “we are ready to fight”. Natarajan said it is not a question about “personal defeat” but more worrisome are the “shocks that democracy is repeatedly receiving”.

Speaking to reporters, she said, “The shocks that democracy is receiving repeatedly, we are worried about that. This is not a question of personal defeat.”

El Nino

that the coupled ocean-atmosphere system now displays characteristics associated with El Nino.

“Currently, El Nino conditions are present over the equatorial Pacific Ocean and are expected to strengthen further during the Southwest Monsoon season,” the IMD said. Forecasts generated by the Monsoon Mission Coupled Forecast System suggest that the event is likely to intensify as the season advances.

According to the bulletin, sea surface temperatures in the central tropical Pacific exceeded the El Nino threshold in June 2026. The latest three-month average Nino 3.4 index, a key measure used to track the phenomenon, has risen above +0.5 degrees Celsius, marking the official onset of El Nino conditions.

The IMD also reported strong positive temperature anomalies beneath the ocean surface across large parts of the equatorial Pacific. These warmer subsurface waters

are expected to continue rising, helping sustain and strengthen El Nino over the coming months. Forecasts indicate that positive sea surface temperature anomalies will persist through June-August and expand further across the central and eastern Pacific from July onward. Current model guidance points to moderate to strong El Nino conditions during much of the monsoon season.

El Nino is one of the three phases of the El Nino Southern Oscillation, or ENSO, a climate system driven by changes in ocean temperatures and atmospheric circulation over the tropical Pacific. While El Nino generally has a warming effect on global temperatures, its opposite phase, La Nina, is usually associated with cooling conditions. ENSO also has a neutral phase.

For India, El Nino has often been linked with weaker monsoon rainfall, higher temperatures, longer dry spells and, in some years, drought conditions. Experts say its emergence may be one reason the country is expected to receive below-normal rainfall this year.

Food costs

financial year to 5.1 per cent from 4.6 per cent. The central bank cited mounting input costs resulting from the pass-through of higher global energy prices to retail fuel rates.

Since May, petrol prices have increased by a cumulative 7.4 per cent, while diesel prices have risen by 8.4 per cent. In its monetary policy statement, the RBI said the fuel price increase would have a direct impact of about 36 basis points on headline inflation, with additional effects likely to be reflected in consumer prices in the coming months.

Rural inflation stood at 4.25 per cent in May, above the national average, while urban inflation remained lower at 3.93 per cent. Among states, Telangana recorded the highest inflation at 6.15 per cent, while Mizoram reported the lowest at 1.03 per cent.

The NSO compiles inflation data using real-time price information collected from 1,407 urban markets, including online platforms, and 1,465 villages across all states and Union Territories.

Amazon

processing units used for AI workloads.

Reports also note that Amazon’s calculations do not include water used during the construction of new data centres or water consumed by power plants that generate electricity for those facilities. Amazon operates around 924 data centres worldwide. A leaked internal memo from 2022 projected that the company’s data centres could consume 7.7 billion gallons of water annually by 2030, although Amazon did not address those projections in its latest disclosure.

Public concern over data centre growth remains significant. A Reuters poll that concluded on June 8 found that only one in three Americans supported data centre construction, while just 14 per cent said they would be comfortable with a facility being built near their homes.

The broader outlook suggests water demand from the sector could rise sharply. The United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health has estimated that the global water footprint of data centres could reach 9.3 trillion litres by 2030, enough to meet the yearly domestic water needs of all 1.3 billion residents of sub-Saharan Africa.

Amazon said its water use remains small compared with other forms of consumption. The company noted that Americans use about 3.3 trillion gallons of water annually on lawns and gardens, more than 1,300 times the amount used by its data centres.

The company said it aims to become “water positive” by 2030, meaning it will return more

water to communities than it uses in direct data centre operations. Amazon said it has already achieved 75 per cent of that target.

To reduce demand for freshwater, Amazon said 26 sites currently operate using 100 per cent reclaimed or treated wastewater, while another 130 sites have been contracted globally. The company added that most of the water it consumes is used to cool servers and that its facilities rely on outside air for cooling about 90 per cent of the time, turning to water-based evaporative cooling only during the hottest periods.

The disclosure comes amid wider efforts to increase transparency around data centre water use. In recent months, The Dalles in Oregon agreed to release records on Google’s water consumption following a legal dispute, while Utah became the first US state to require certain new data centre projects to publicly disclose annual water usage. AGENCIES

Rana

initially shown significant signs of recovery after being admitted in critical condition earlier this month. Dr Balbir Singh, Group Chairman of Cardiac Sciences at Max Hospital, said Rana arrived at the hospital on June 1 after continuing to travel despite experiencing chest pain.

“He presented with an acute heart attack that was already three days old. He had been travelling and continued to experience chest pain before arriving at the hospital in a very critical condition. The artery responsible for the heart attack was completely blocked. It was found that his heart’s pumping function was severely weakened, and he was in heart failure,” Dr Singh said.

The hospital said Rana had responded well to treatment and had recovered enough to be considered fit for discharge. However, he suffered a sudden cardiac rupture in his sleep, leading to his death.

Rana had fallen ill while returning from the ISSF World Cup in Munich, Germany, with the Indian contingent. After landing in New Delhi, he was hospitalised and underwent a procedure in which a stent was inserted to clear a blocked artery.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid tribute to the shooting legend, describing his death as a major loss to Indian sport.

“Deeply saddened by the passing of Shri Jaspal Rana Ji. His passing is a profound loss to the world of Indian sports. He brought immense glory to the nation through his extraordinary achievements in shooting,” Modi said in a post on X.

“Equally remarkable was his contribution as a mentor, shaping and guiding young athletes with great dedication. His unwavering commitment to excellence, discipline and service to the sporting world earned him immense admiration,” the Prime Minister added.

Born in Uttarkashi, Rana emerged as a prodigy at a remarkably young age. He won his first national-level gold medal when he was only 12 years old, signalling the arrival of a talent who would transform the sport in India.

His international breakthrough came in 1994 when he won 25m centre fire pistol gold medals at both the Commonwealth Games and the Asian Games. The Asian Games triumph carried special significance, as it was India’s first shooting gold at the continental event in 16 years since Raja Randhir Singh’s success in 1978.

At a time when shooting occupied only a small place in India’s sporting landscape, Rana’s achievements made him one of the country’s first shooting superstars. Images of the teenage champion returning home after his Commonwealth Games success, carried on the shoulders of his father through crowds of admirers, became part of Indian sporting folklore.

Although Rana competed at the 1996 Atlanta Olympics and

did not secure a medal, his influence on Indian shooting extended far beyond Olympic results. Many believe he laid the groundwork for later achievements by Indian shooters, including Rajyavardhan Singh Rathore’s silver medal at the 2004 Athens Olympics and Abhinav Bindra’s historic gold medal at the 2008 Beijing Games.

His competitive career was marked by extraordinary resilience. At the 1995 Commonwealth Shooting Championships in New Delhi, he competed despite suffering severe food poisoning the previous night and went on to win more than half a dozen medals. More than a decade later, at the 2006 Asian Games in Doha, he battled high fever and nausea to produce one of the finest performances of his career, winning three gold medals and a silver while equalling the then world record.

Rana retired as India’s most successful Commonwealth Games athlete, collecting 15 medals, including nine golds, across four editions of the Games.

His achievements earned him some of the country’s highest sporting honours. He received the Arjuna Award in 1994, the Padma Shri in 1997 and the Dronacharya Award in 2020 for his contribution as a coach.

If Rana’s competitive achievements made him a legend, his coaching career cemented his place as one of the most influential figures in Indian shooting. After transitioning into coaching, he became known for identifying and nurturing young talent with remarkable precision.

As junior pistol coach from 2012 onward, he played a key role in developing a new generation of shooters, including Saurabh Chaudhary, Chinkri Yadav and Anish Bhanwala.

Through his academy in Dehradun and his work with the national team, he built a strong pipeline of talent that helped India become a consistent force in international shooting.

His greatest coaching success came with Manu Bhaker.

Despite a temporary split before the Tokyo Olympics because of differences over his demanding methods, the two reunited and achieved historic success at the Paris Olympics. Bhaker won two bronze medals, becoming the first Indian athlete to claim two medals at a single Olympic Games, a feat Rana had long believed she was capable of achieving.

Known as a strict trainer, Rana introduced intense practice routines designed to recreate the pressure of Olympic competition. He was also fiercely loyal to his athletes and often stood by them during disputes with sporting authorities. At one point, when federation rules prevented him from coaching Bhaker in an official capacity, he continued to guide her from the spectators’ gallery at the Karni Singh Shooting Range.

Rana’s strong personality, outspoken nature and willingness to challenge authority sometimes led to disagreements, but they also reflected his deep commitment to the sport and his athletes.

Influenced by his close relationship with Hungarian coach Tibor Gonczol, whom he regarded as a mentor, Rana sought to build similarly strong bonds with the shooters he trained.

He also briefly ventured into politics and was associated with both the BJP and the Congress at different times, though he never achieved electoral success.

His father, Narayan Singh Rana, is a veteran of the 1971 war.

The loss of Rana leaves a major gap in India’s shooting programme at a crucial time, with preparations underway for the Asian Games later this year.

As tributes pour in from athletes, coaches and administrators, many in the shooting community are remembering not only a champion marksman but also a mentor whose influence helped shape modern Indian shooting and whose legacy will continue through the generations of athletes he inspired.

NDA govt has worked to further women-led development: PM

Govt created environment for women to realise full potential, says Modi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday said the NDA government's efforts are rooted in dignity, opportunity and empowerment, and these have helped create an environment where women can realise their full potential and contribute even more strongly to nation-building.

Modi said that over the last 12 years, the NDA government has worked to further women-led development, and this is visible across sectors.

He said from financial inclusion and entrepreneurship to education, health-care, sanitation, housing, sports, science and governance, women are playing a prominent role across diverse sectors.

"The efforts of the NDA government are rooted in dignity, opportunity and empowerment. They have helped create an environment where women can realise their full potential and contribute even more strongly to nation-building," he wrote on social media platform X.



PM Narendra Modi

The Prime Minister said he was particularly happy to see India's "nari shakti" (women) make a mark in sectors like science, space and innovation.

The growing participation of women in emerging fields such as drone technology is opening new avenues of opportunity and transforming the development landscape across the nation, he said.

"Our government is actively supporting Self-Help Groups, which are going a long way in making women financially independent," he

said.

The Modi government has completed 12 years in power. Modi took oath as the Prime Minister of India for the first time on May 26, 2014, becoming the first-ever prime minister to be born after India attained Independence.

His second term began on May 30, 2019, while he was sworn in as prime minister for the third consecutive time on June 9, 2024, following another decisive victory in the 2024 Parliamentary elections.

On Wednesday, Modi also crossed the record of first

Highlights

» The Prime Minister said he was particularly happy to see India's "nari shakti" (women) make a mark in sectors like science, space and innovation

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prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru's 4,398 days in power as an elected prime minister following the 1952 general elections.

Nehru's stint from 1947 to 1952 was as head of an interim government as elections were not held till 1952.

Students, aspirants join Lucknow protest over exam irregularities

CJP chief seeks Pradhan's exit



Supporters of CJP protest demanding resignation of Union Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged examination-related lapses, in Lucknow

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Hundreds of youths gathered at Eco Garden in Lucknow on Friday under the banner of the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) to protest against alleged examination irregularities and paper leaks, demanding the resignation of Union Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET paper leak controversy.

Raising slogans against the government, the protesters alleged that repeated examination leaks and irregularities had jeopardised the future of lakhs of aspirants. Participants also demanded accountability in recruitment and competitive examinations, including NEET, UPSC, Lekhpal and CBSE examinations.

Anticipating a large turnout, the district administration deployed heavy police force and Rapid Action Force (RAF) personnel in and around the Eco Garden.

CJP founder Abhijeet Deepke, who arrived in Lucknow to lead the protest, said the demonstration would remain peaceful. He briefly got caught in the crowd before reaching the protest venue, where he addressed the gathering and later joined the sit-in.

Addressing the protesters, Deepke said, "Our country was built through movements. Had there been no freedom movement, India would not have attained Independence. Had there been no movement against the Emergency, democracy would not have survived. Peaceful protest is the highest form of patriotism."

He said the protesters, Deepke said, "Our country was built through movements. Had there been no freedom movement, India would not have attained Independence. Had there been no movement against the Emergency, democracy would not have survived. Peaceful protest is the highest form of patriotism."

ED issues fresh summons to former Kerala CM's daughter in PMLA case

KOCHI: The ED, which is probing a money laundering case involving minerals company CMRL, has issued a fresh summons to Veena T, daughter of former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, directing her to appear for questioning on June 17, sources said on Friday.

The ED had earlier asked Veena to appear before its Kochi unit on Friday. However, following an email from Veena seeking more time, citing health issues, the agency issued a fresh summons, sources said.

The ED has asked Veena to appear at its Kochi office at 10 am on June 17, along with relevant documents related to transactions involving her IT firm, Exalogic Solutions Private Limited.

The probe pertains to allegations that Cochin Minerals and Rutile Ltd (CMRL) made payments amounting to Rs 2.78 crore to Exalogic without receiving any services in return.

AGENCIES

Urge PM to direct Ram temple trust to disclose finances: BJP leader

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AYODHYA: Amid the ongoing controversy over alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya, senior BJP leader Rajneesh Singh has requested Prime Minister Narendra Modi to seek public disclosure of the finances and assets of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust since its inception.

In a letter sent on Friday, Singh urged the prime minister to direct the trust to disclose details of all income, expenditure, donations, bank accounts, land transactions and properties linked to it on its official website.

Referring to Lord Ram as the embodiment of truth, righteousness and public welfare, Singh emphasised that institutions functioning in his name should adhere to the highest standards of transparency.

"Crores of devotees from India and abroad have contributed their faith and lifelong earnings for the construction of the Ram Mandir. This wealth does not belong to any individual, group or institution, but is a symbol of the devotion of crores of devotees," he said in the letter.



He asserted that every devotee has a "moral and democratic right" to know how donations, including money, ornaments and other valuables, have been utilised.

Singh, a resident of Ayodhya, is also the official party spokesperson here. He is said to be close to the party leadership, including Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

The BJP leader's demand comes amid a growing row over alleged irregularities in the handling of the temple's donations.

On Wednesday, former BJP MP Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh claimed he was aware of alleged misuse and theft of donations at the Ram temple but was not in a position to reveal details.

AGENCIES

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Friday alleged that the Election Commission of India had applied blatantly unequal standards in the Rajya Sabha elections, invalidating the nomination of its candidate Meenakshi Natarajan in Madhya Pradesh on legally untenable grounds while allowing BJP candidate Parimal Nathwani to contest from Jharkhand despite what the party described as multiple substantive defects in his affidavit.

The party said the Returning Officer cancellation of Natarajan's nomination rested on her alleged non-disclosure of a criminal case, a claim Congress called factually incorrect. Under Section 223 of the



Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, a Magistrate must afford the accused an opportunity to be heard before taking cognizance; the legal notice served to Natarajan on September 17, 2025, was precisely that pre-cognizance notice. Congress argued that since no cognizance had been taken, Form 26 required no disclosure and Natarajan's entry was entirely valid.

In contrast, Nathwani described by the party as a billionaire with close ties to the Prime Minister filed his nomination under a name variant not matching his voter registration, left mandatory columns in Paras 5 and 6 blank, and omitted asset disclosures for himself and his spouse, removing those columns from the affidavit altogether.

The Returning Officer nonetheless accepted his nomination after allowing him to supply missing information, a remedy Congress said the Supreme Court had explicitly ruled was beyond a Returning Officer's jurisdiction at the scrutiny stage.

The BJP, Congress alleged, had entered the Madhya Pradesh seat knowing it was ten MLAs short of the required threshold, and turned to institutional manipulation when attempts to engineer defections failed.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Friday held a high-level review meeting with senior officials on the functioning of the Railway Recruitment Board and underlined the need for a more transparent, accurate and technology-driven system.

Vaishnaw noted that the annual recruitment calendar, coupled with quarterly notifications of vacancies, has been well received by candidates, the railway ministry said in a statement.

He said the calendar-based recruitment framework has enabled aspirants to plan their preparation more effectively as it brings greater predictability to the recruitment process.

Emphasising the need for continuous improvement, Vaishnaw stated that the railway recruitment system must keep evolving through the use of technology, faster processes and greater accountability, the statement said.

Vaishnaw also reviewed the progress made in shifting depart-

RAHUL GANDHI TO INDIA BLOC LEADERS ‘Next election ours as people angry but polls won’t be fair’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi told INDIA Bloc leaders earlier this week that going by the anger among the people, the next general election is "already won", but the main problem is that there won't be a free and fair election to win.

At the meeting of the INDIA Bloc on Monday, he also gave a clarion call to the leaders to stay united, saying it is easy to beat the BJP "if we stand together and resist".

Gandhi also dismissed the notion that the Opposition parties are not coordinated and do not act together.

"These are all ideas the BJP is putting out. This is not true — I am 100 per cent sure, and I can vouch right now for the DMK. When it comes to defending the idea of India, every single person will be in this room," Gandhi said.

The DMK had boycotted Monday's INDIA Bloc meeting over the Congress breaking alliance with it in Tamil Nadu and joining hands with the TVK.

Gandhi also responded to the criticism of the Congress by its allies, including the Left parties, by referring to the "blue-necked one (Shiva) who drinks all the poison", and said whatever criticism they have of him



Opposition leaders during the India Bloc meeting, in New Delhi

or his party will be accepted with a smile on the face.

He said the Congress is fundamentally differently organised than all other parties in India because it began as a resistance movement when modern India did not exist.

"Unlike all other political parties, it was not built using the infrastructure and protection of the Indian state. The Congress party is a resistance movement protecting the idea that all Indians are equal," he asserted.

"We will die — we will die in the Congress party — before we stand with or compromise with the BJP or the RSS. You will have to cut off our heads to make it happen. I know lakhs and lakhs of Congress workers in this country who will say: cut off our heads, we will not bow before the RSS," he said.

Gandhi on Friday shared on

his social media accounts his over nine-minute speech made at the meeting where the INDIA Bloc constituents stressed on unity against the BJP.

On Monday, the INDIA Bloc members unanimously decided to demand Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's immediate resignation over the NEET-CBSE row and write to the chief justice of India on the SIR exercise and "vote loot".

In his remarks at the meeting, Gandhi said, "It is not my place to answer any of the things that were said today about the Congress party. It is my place to -- like in the Shaiva tradition -- swallow everything. The idea of the blue-necked one who drinks all the poison. Whatever more you want to say, whatever criticism you have of me or the Congress party, we will accept it, and we will accept it happily, with a smile on our face."

Modi's 12 years of landmark transformational era in India: Nadda

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: Senior BJP leader and Union Health minister J P Nadda said on Friday that 12 years of Prime Minister Narendra Modi have proved to be a landmark, transformational era in the country's political history, laying a strong foundation for a developed new India.

Addressing the intellectuals' conference of the party in Shimla, in his home state, Nadda said the last 10 years have shaped the country's road to accelerated

development, growth, infrastructure building, and winning the trust of the people across states.

Nadda said the twelve years of the Modi-led Union government would be remembered as a golden chapter in India's history.

"Before 2014, Indian politics revolved around casteism, dynastic politics, appeasement, and corruption. Citizens had come to accept that governments would change, but governance would remain the same. But PM Modi changed the mindset of the people by making politics a medium

of service, accountability, and good governance," said the former BJP national president.

See the change: PM Modi introduced the mantra of "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, Sabka Prayas", whereas all earlier governments often remained confined to serving the interests of a particular family, region or vote bank. "Today, the Modi government works for all 1.4 billion Indians," he added.

He lauded PM Modi for fulfilling several long-standing national aspirations for which

BJP workers had struggled for decades. "The abrogation of Article 370 in Jammu and Kashmir, the construction of the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the abolition of 'Triple Talaq' and the implementation of the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) are historic decisions that previous governments avoided for political reasons," he said.

Nadda said India had witnessed an unprecedented transformation over the last twelve years. "Railway electrification has increased by over 200 per

cent. National highways, tunnels, four-lane projects, and modern transportation networks have dramatically changed the country's landscape."

On national security, he said that Prime Minister Modi has adopted a zero-tolerance policy against terrorism. India is now a nation that responds decisively to terrorism. Significant improvements have also been made in former Naxal-affected regions through enhanced infrastructure, education, healthcare, and development initiatives.

Kejriwal claims Punjab polls may be held in Nov, Mann to be AAP's CM face

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal on Friday claimed that Punjab Assembly elections may be held in November this year as against the expected February 2027.

Kejriwal also projected Bhagwant Mann as the party's chief ministerial face, saying, "We have to make him the chief minister again."

Addressing a roadshow in Bathinda alongside Mann and senior party leaders, including Manish Sisodia and Punjab AAP president Aman Arora, Kejriwal thanked people for AAP's impressive performance in the civic polls held last month.

On Thursday, four AAP

Kejriwal also thanked people for AAP's 'grand victory in the civic polls'

councillors were elected mayors of the municipal corporations of Barnala, Moga, Batala and Bathinda.

In his address, Kejriwal claimed he has come to know that the Punjab elections could be advanced.

"I am told that the polls will be held in November (2026), and not February (2027). So, only four months are left now. We must get to work and make Bhagwant Mann the chief minister again," Kejriwal said.

Kejriwal also thanked people for AAP's "grand victory in

Smriti Irani's name missing from Amethi Panchayat voter list

DM orders probe

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AMETHI: Former Union minister Smriti Irani has been left out of the Panchayat voter list of Medan Mawai village in Amethi district despite her name being present in the Lok Sabha and Assembly electoral rolls for the area, officials said on Friday.

Amethi District Magistrate Sanjay Chauhan said an inquiry had been ordered into the matter.

The BJP leader had represented Amethi in the Lok Sabha from 2019 to 2024. She built a residence in Medan Mawai village under the Gauriganj Assembly constituency after winning the 2019 parliamentary election.

She is registered as a voter from the village and had cast her vote there during the Lok Sabha polls.

The discrepancy came to light after the publication of the Panchayat voter list on June 10, in which her name did not appear.

Asked about the omission, Chauhan said the exact reason would be known only after the inquiry report is submitted.

BJP Amethi district president Sudhanshu Shukla said an application seeking inclusion of Irani's name in the Panchayat voter list had been submitted and the matter brought to the notice of senior officials.

According to Shukla, officials have assured that the name would be added after due verification.

Irani lost the 2024 Lok Sabha elections from Amethi to Congress leader Kishori Lal Sharma.

the civic polls", in which the party won 958 of the 1,977 wards across eight municipal corporations, 75 municipal councils and 19 Nagar Panchayats.

He contrasted it with the rule of the rival parties, saying public anger used to grow against them when they reached the last year of their term.

"We came to politics to do work. I see smiles on people's faces and feel good that after four years, people are liking our work."

"In Bathinda (civic polls), you gave a grand victory to us and put a stamp of approval that we are doing good work. The smile on your faces says that you are happy with our work," he claimed.

Nation Briefs

BIHAR DEPUTY CM RECEIVES ABUSIVE CALL, CASE REGISTERED

PATNA: Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Bijendra Prasad Yadav recently received an abusive phone call after allegedly refusing to share details sought by a caller attempting to defraud him, police said. According to police, the caller claimed that a parcel booked in the minister's name would be delivered only after certain details were provided. "The minister received a call. The caller tried to lure him by saying that he had booked a parcel, and that it would be delivered after he provided some details. When the minister disconnected the call, the accused called him several times and hurled abuses at him," cyber DSP Nitish Chandra Dharua told reporters. A case has been registered in this matter, and the phone from which the call was received has also been seized, he added.

KERALA BJP CHIEF ASSURES SUPPORT TO ARRESTED PARTY COUNCILLOR

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Kerala BJP chief Rajeev Chandrasekhar on Friday said that the party will provide all possible support and legal assistance to its councillor Sugathan, who was recently arrested in a dramatic manner from the state capital. Terming the action against the Thiruvananthapuram Corporation councillor from the Vazhottukonam ward as a "political vendetta," Chandrasekhar said the party will protect him from this "blatant misuse of the police system."

JAISHANKAR CALLS OUT EUROPE OVER ARMS & RUSSIAN OIL DEBATE

‘European weapons used against India for years’

HELSINKI: External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar hit back at European criticism of India's position on the Russia-Ukraine conflict, saying Europe sells weapons that are used against India, while New Delhi has never done anything to endanger the continent.

Speaking at the Kultaranta Talks in Finland on Thursday, Jaishankar defended India's purchase of Russian crude oil after the outbreak of the Ukraine war and rejected suggestions that New Delhi has adopted a “morally ambiguous” position on the conflict. “No European country has been attacked with Indian weapons. I wish I could say that for European weapons vis-a-vis India. So keep that in mind,” Jaishankar said when asked about criticism in Europe over India's ties with Russia and continued imports



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar takes part in a discussion with Finland Foreign Affairs Minister Elina Valtonen and UAE Minister of State at Foreign Affairs Ministry Lana Nusseibeh during the 14th edition of the Kultaranta Talks

of Russian oil. “Europeans sell weapons which are used to attack India. Not now. For many, many years,” he said in an apparent reference to the long-standing supply of arms and military equipment by several European countries to Pakistan. “We Indians have never

done anything to endanger Europe,” Jaishankar added. The minister said India's energy purchases were guided by economic considerations and the realities of the global market. India buys oil based on cost and availability, he asserted. When the Russia-Ukraine

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Jaishankar defended India's decision to continue purchasing Russian oil, saying India's energy purchases were guided by economic considerations and the realities of the global market
- » ‘No European country has been attacked with Indian weapons. I wish I could say that for European weapons vis-a-vis India,’ he said
- » ‘Europeans sell weapons which are used to attack India. Not now. For many, many years,’ he added

India has consistently maintained that the country's energy security needs and the welfare of its population require access to affordable oil supplies.

Jaishankar has frequently pushed back against Western criticism of India's Russia policy, arguing that Europe continued extensive trade with Russia in the initial stages of the conflict and that developing countries cannot be expected to bear a disproportionate economic burden.

Jaishankar was in Finland on the concluding leg of his two-nation Europe tour to participate in the Kultaranta Talks. He had arrived in Finland from Bulgaria.

The annual dialogue, hosted by Finnish President Alexander Stubb, brings together senior leaders and policymakers to discuss global and regional security challenges. AGENCIES

BRICS nations back inclusive & resilient urban development

13th Urbanisation Forum concludes



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The 13th BRICS Urbanisation Forum concluded in New Delhi with the adoption of a Ministerial Declaration reaffirming the bloc's commitment to inclusive, resilient and people-centric urban development.

Hosted by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs under India's BRICS chairship in 2026, the two-day forum brought together ministers, senior government officials, urban planners and experts from BRICS member countries. The event was organised around the theme, “Cities for People: BRICS Cooperation for Inclusive and Resilient Urban Futures.” Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal inaugurated the forum, highlighting the importance of strengthening cooperation among BRICS nations to address common urban challenges. Discussions focused on key areas such as inclusive growth, climate-resilient cities, institutional capacity building, sustainable urban governance and the use of digital technologies to improve urban living.

The forum marked the fourth time India hosted the BRICS Urbanisation Forum. During the inaugural session, Manohar Lal released a publication titled “India's Urban Transformation: Stories of Change.”

The book showcases successful urban development initiatives from various States and Union Territories, highlighting achievements across the forum's four priority areas. The publication presents case studies documenting transformative changes in urban governance, infrastructure and service delivery. Senior-level deliberations featured presentations by participating countries on their urban development experiences, policy innovations and future strategies. Delegates also visited key urban infrastructure projects in the national capital, including the new Parliament building and the redeveloped Kartavya Path precinct. On the sidelines of the forum, several bilateral meetings were held among participating nations, including discussions between India and Russia, India and Iran, as well as interactions involving delegates from Iran, China, Russia and the UAE.

A key outcome of the forum was the endorsement of India's proposal to establish the “BRICS Urban Research and Knowledge Network.” The proposed platform aims to facilitate research collaboration, knowledge-sharing and capacity-building among member countries, fostering cooperation on sustainable urban development.

Shah directs agencies to ensure safe & seamless Amarnath Yatra

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Friday chaired a high-level security review meeting in New Delhi to assess preparations for the Amarnath Yatra 2026, scheduled to be held from July 3 to August 28.

Reviewing the arrangements, Shah said the government is committed to ensuring a safe, secure and hassle-free pilgrimage under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He stressed the need for seamless coordination among all security and administrative agencies to provide comprehensive protection to pilgrims. The meeting was attended by Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha, National Security Advisor Ajit



Doval, the Union Home Secretary, the Chief of Army Staff, the Intelligence Bureau Chief, Chief Secretary and Director General of Police, along with chiefs of various CAPFs.

The Home minister directed authorities to strengthen security measures by leveraging advanced technology, including drone surveillance, CCTV monitoring and real-time tracking systems. He said a multi-layered security grid involving the Jammu and Kashmir Police, Central Armed Police Forces

and other agencies would be deployed along the Yatra routes.

Shah also emphasised the importance of maintaining a strong presence of officers on the ground and ensuring effective management of pilgrim registration, accommodation, healthcare facilities and emergency response systems. He instructed officials to closely monitor weather conditions and regulate the movement of pilgrims accordingly to ensure their safety.

During the meeting, officials informed Shah that all pilgrims, as well as ponies and other animals used during the Yatra, would be issued QR code-enabled identification cards. Veterinary and medical camps will also be set up to ensure the well-being of animals engaged in the pilgrimage.

war broke out in 2022, “at that point of time, much of the oil available in the market was Russian because Europeans were essentially buying up the Middle East oil, which was our traditional supply. So circumstances pushed us in a certain direction,” Jaishankar said. India has consistently

called for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve the Ukraine conflict while maintaining close relations with both Russia and Ukraine.

The war triggered major disruptions in global energy markets, prompting India to significantly increase imports of discounted Russian crude.

Bomb scare: IndiGo flight makes emergency landing in Lucknow

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: An IndiGo flight from Ahmedabad to Delhi via Lucknow made an emergency landing at Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport on Friday after a bomb threat message was discovered on a tissue paper inside the aircraft's lavatory.

The aircraft was en route when a crew member found a tissue paper with the word “bomb” written on it. The pilot immediately informed Air Traffic Control (ATC) and sought permission for an emergency landing at Lucknow.

ATC alerted the airport authorities and security agencies before clearing the aircraft for landing. Flight 6E-2111 landed safely at Lucknow airport at around 11.15 am.

The aircraft was en route when a crew member found a tissue paper with the word “bomb” written on it. The pilot immediately informed Air Traffic Control (ATC) and sought permission for an emergency landing at Lucknow.

All 180 passengers were safely evacuated from the aircraft along with their baggage. A comprehensive security check lasting nearly three hours was carried out by the bomb disposal squad, CISF personnel and other security agencies. A dog squad also screened every piece of luggage.

Officials said no suspicious object or explosive material was found during the search. After the aircraft was declared

safe, passengers were allowed to reboard and the flight departed for Delhi at around 2.40 pm.

Several passengers, including former IPS officer B.P. Ashok, were on board the flight. In a statement, an IndiGo spokesperson said, “A security-related alert was received just before the departure of Flight 6E-2111 from Lucknow to Delhi. In accordance with standard security protocols, the relevant authorities were immediately informed and the airline fully cooperated with all security procedures.”

Officials said the CISF and ATC will submit a detailed report on the incident to the aviation authorities. If investigators identify the person responsible for writing the bomb threat on the tissue paper, legal action will be initiated against them.

Hooda says aid for Rohtak blaze victims ‘inadequate’



MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Friday visited Rohtak's D-Park area, where a devastating fire recently claimed lives and caused extensive damage to shops and businesses.

Hooda met affected shopkeepers and bereaved families, expressing condolences to those who lost their loved ones in the tragedy. He also assessed the extent of the losses suffered by local traders and assured them of his support. MLA Bharat Bhushan Batra, former minister Subhash Batra and former MLA Anand Singh Dangi accompanied him during the visit.

Criticising the compensation announced by the state government as inadequate, Hooda demanded enhanced relief for all victims. He called for full compensation to those affected and urged the government to reconstruct the damaged shops to help traders restore their livelihoods. He also sought government jobs for members of families who lost relatives in the incident.

The Congress leader alleged that the scale of the damage could have been reduced had the fire department been adequately equipped and staffed. He claimed that nearly 50 per cent of firefighter posts in Haryana remain vacant and that recruitment has been pending for more than two years. Referring to the firefighting operation at D-Park, Hooda said one fire tender reportedly malfunctioned and failed to spray water, while another lacked sufficient water pressure to effectively tackle the blaze.

He further claimed that a second fire tender reached the spot nearly 50 minutes later, by which time significant damage had already occurred.

‘Conman’ who cheated 25 women by marrying them arrested in UP

THANE: A man accused of duping more than 25 women across several states by marrying them through matrimonial advertisements and then swindling them of large sums of money has been arrested from Uttar Pradesh, police said on Friday.

The accused, identified as Anuj Kumar Chandraprakash Trivedi, was apprehended from Greater Noida on May 24 after investigators tracked him down. According to police, he had been living under a false identity and used multiple aliases, including Ajay Agarwal, Ajay Santosh Singh and Jaiprakash Rameshchandra Gupta. The case came to light after a 75-year-old woman lodged a complaint with the Nayanagar police in Maharashtra's Thane district in March 2022. She alleged that Trivedi, posing as Ajay Agarwal, had responded



to a matrimonial advertisement seeking a match for her 45-year-old daughter and married her in March 2019.

Police said the accused gradually gained the family's trust and allegedly persuaded the complainant to sell her flat in Mira Road, promising to buy a new residence and build a two-storey house. He reportedly collected Rs 82 lakh from the family in several instalments. In February 2022, Trivedi allegedly took his wife to Delhi on the pretext of attending a relative's wedding. At a railway station, he

fled with 33 tolas of jewellery and forced the woman onto a train bound for Mumbai before switching off his phone.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime) Sandeep Doiphode said the accused cheated the complainant and her daughter of nearly Rs 97 lakh. Investigations later revealed that Trivedi had targeted over 25 women, including divorcees, disabled women and those in vulnerable situations, using similar methods.

Police also seized a car worth Rs 20 lakh allegedly purchased with the fraud proceeds, along with a fake Aadhaar card, three mobile phones and an ATM card. Trivedi's son has been named as a co-accused for allegedly assisting in the fraud. The accused is currently in judicial custody, while further investigations are underway. AGENCIES

Punjab: Saini slams AAP govt over ‘misgovernance’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday asserted that his government remains committed to protecting people's rights and advancing social welfare, while launching a sharp attack on the AAP government in Punjab for what he described as unfulfilled promises and misgovernance.

Addressing the Saini Mahasammelan in Rajpura, Punjab, Saini said both his office and official residence remain open to the public round the clock and assured people that his government would leave no stone unturned in addressing their concerns through policy measures and individual interventions.

Targeting the AAP government, Saini alleged that the party had misled Punjab's voters with promises that were never fulfilled. Referring to compensation announced dur-



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini offers prayers at a temple at Rajpura in Patiala

ing flood-related distress, he claimed contradictory assurances by Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal exposed the party's “double standards”. He further accused the Punjab government of corruption and exploitation. Saini said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's welfare policies had empowered the poorest sections of

‘Modi govt's 12 yrs marked by trust’

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday said the 12 years of the Narendra Modi government have been marked by trust, development, good governance, and public welfare, asserting that India has entered a new era under the prime minister's leadership. Addressing an event in Panchkula to mark 12 years of the Modi government, Saini said India is moving steadily towards becoming a developed nation. “The country is progressing at a rapid pace under PM Modi's leadership, and we are seeing a strong India, a new India,” Saini said.

He said a series of initiatives launched by the Modi government had benefitted farmers, women, the poor, and the youth. PM Modi completed 12 years in office on Tuesday. MPOST

society. He noted that Haryana was procuring all crops at Minimum Support Price (MSP), providing LPG cylinders at Rs 500, extending support for crop diversification and offering financial assistance to women, senior citizens, widows and persons with disabilities through direct benefit transfers.

The Chief Minister also highlighted initiatives under-

taken by Haryana to honour Sikh heritage, including projects dedicated to Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Sahib Ji, and said an agricultural college in the Guru's name would soon be established at Chhachhrauli.

He further said Punjab would benefit from development projects worth thousands of crores launched by the Centre, including the proposed Mohali-Rajpura Rail Bypass.

Ram Temple donation row: PIL in High Court seeks CBI probe

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: A public interest litigation (PIL) seeking a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the alleged embezzlement of donations collected through donation boxes at the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Temple in Ayodhya was filed before the Lucknow Bench of the Allahabad High Court on Friday. The matter is likely to come up for hearing next week.

The PIL has been filed by Ayodhya-based advocate Mohit Ashok in his personal capacity. The petition has urged the court to direct the CBI to register a case and conduct a comprehensive investigation into the alleged misappropriation of cash, gold, silver ornaments and other valuables offered by devotees at the temple.

The petitioner has also sought an audit of all donations received at the temple by the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG). According to the plea, reports of the alleged embezzlement published in the media have hurt the sentiments of millions of devotees for whom Lord Ram is a symbol of deep faith. It argues that



The controversy over the alleged embezzlement of temple donations has continued to gather momentum

an independent investigation and financial audit are essential to restore public confidence.

The petition has made the Centre, the Uttar Pradesh government, the CBI, the CAG and the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust parties to the case.

Meanwhile, the controversy over the alleged embezzlement of temple donations has continued to gather momentum, triggering wider discussions over financial transparency and administrative accountability at the Ram Temple. Sources said the investigation is progressing and that the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) has also

sought a detailed report on the developments. The report is expected to form the basis for a review of various aspects of the temple's management and administrative system.

Officials are also considering terminating the services of some employees or relieving them of key responsibilities after questions were raised over the role of certain staff members under scrutiny. The duties of several other employees working within the temple complex may also be reassessed to strengthen transparency and accountability.

There were also reports on Wednesday that around Rs 1.5 crore, allegedly linked to the suspected embezzlement, had been recovered. Discussions have continued over the questioning of suspects and scrutiny of their bank account details. The manager of the Central Bank of India declined to comment on the matter. Sources indicated that bank personnel involved in counting donations are also being examined as part of the inquiry.

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has so far not issued any official statement on the allegations.



EDITORIAL

THE SON PREFERENCE

The Supreme Court's observation that India still needs strict enforcement of the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (PCPNDT) Act is both a reminder of how far the country has come and how far it still has to travel. More than three decades after the law was enacted to curb sex-selective abortions, the very fact that the highest court finds it necessary to speak of the "behind-the-curtains" prevalence of such practices should unsettle us. This is not merely a legal issue. It is a moral and civilisational question. A society that debates women's empowerment while continuing to deny many girls the right to be born is trapped in a contradiction that no amount of economic growth can conceal.

The court's remarks arrive at a time when India proudly showcases women's achievements in politics, science, sports, entrepreneurship and the armed forces. From women fighter pilots and startup founders to Olympic medal winners and village sarpanches, the narrative of female advancement has become increasingly visible. Yet beneath this progress lies an uncomfortable reality. The preference for sons remains deeply embedded across social classes, regions and educational backgrounds. Female foeticide is often mistakenly viewed as a relic of rural backwardness. In reality, studies over the years have shown that sex selection has frequently been more prevalent in economically prosperous and better-educated sections of society, where access to technology and medical facilities makes such discrimination easier to execute and harder to detect. Patriarchy, it turns out, is not defeated by prosperity alone.

The numbers explain why the PCPNDT Act was considered necessary in the first place. India's child sex ratio declined from 945 girls per 1,000 boys in 1991 to 927 in 2001 and further to 919 in 2011. While some recent indicators suggest improvements in certain regions, several states continue to report sex ratios at birth below the national average. These figures are not statistical anomalies; they represent millions of missing girls. Every distorted sex ratio tells a story of a family that considered a daughter less desirable than a son. The reasons vary—inheritance practices, concerns about dowry, perceptions of economic burden, expectations of old-age support and deeply ingrained cultural norms—but the outcome remains the same. The unborn girl becomes the first victim of gender discrimination.

What makes this issue particularly troubling is that India has not lacked government intervention. Successive administrations have launched campaigns and welfare programmes aimed at improving the status of girls. Initiatives such as Beti Bachao Beti Padhao, Sukanya Samridhi Yojana, Ladli Lakshmi Yojana and numerous state-level schemes have attempted to address both social attitudes and economic concerns. Awareness campaigns, financial incentives and educational support have undoubtedly helped. Yet the persistence of son preference demonstrates the limits of policy when social beliefs remain unchanged. Governments can provide scholarships, insurance and incentives. They can prosecute offenders and regulate diagnostic centres. What they cannot easily legislate is respect. Laws can prevent discrimination; they cannot automatically create equality.

This is why the Supreme Court is correct in arguing that strict enforcement must continue until there is a genuine change in mentality. Critics occasionally argue that stringent regulations under the PCPNDT Act place burdens on medical practitioners and diagnostic centres. While procedural fairness and accountability are essential, the larger purpose of the legislation cannot be forgotten. The Act was never merely about regulating ultrasound machines. It was designed to protect the most fundamental right of all—the right to life. Weakening enforcement in a society where gender bias still influences reproductive choices would risk undoing decades of progress. At the same time, enforcement alone cannot succeed. Schools must challenge stereotypes from an early age. Media narratives must celebrate daughters not as exceptions but as equals. Religious, community and political leaders must consistently reinforce the message that the worth of a child is not determined by gender.

The deeper challenge is to redefine how society understands value itself. The Supreme Court's reference to Subhadra Kumari Chauhan's poem celebrating the birth of a daughter and its invocation of the ancient maxim "Yatra naryastu pujiyante ramante tatra devata" were not ornamental flourishes. They were reminders that India's cultural traditions contain resources for gender equality even as social practices often betray them. The question before modern India is not whether it can build a five-trillion-dollar economy or become a technological powerhouse. It is whether it can create a society where the birth of a girl is greeted with the same joy, expectation and dignity as that of a boy. Until that day arrives, the PCPNDT Act will remain necessary, and every celebration of women's empowerment will carry an asterisk. A nation cannot claim to honour its daughters if it still permits doubt about whether they deserve to be born.

ECONOMIC STATECRAFT



SMARAK SWAIN

THE WRITER IS A SANCTIONS TECHNOCRAT AND DIRECTOR IN THE DEPARTMENT OF REVENUE, MINISTRY OF FINANCE

Just as the Strait of Hormuz influences global energy flows, the US-centred CHIPS payment system remains a critical gateway for international dollar transactions

Fight Beyond the Dollar

As central banks race to build new digital payment networks, a quiet struggle is unfolding over who will control the future of cross-border finance—and with it, a powerful tool of geopolitical influence

The Bank for International Settlements (BIS) published a 97-page report on Project Agorá on May 27 this year. On the face of it, the report discusses a model for cross-border transactions using Central Bank Digital Currencies (CBDCs). However, this report marks a significant step in an ongoing economic war between great powers. Who wins this economic war will decide the future of global finance and of world domination. And yet, its reporting in mainstream Indian news was underwhelming.

The Dollar World Order
To understand this economic war, it is important to understand the current plumbing of world finance. Any cross-border transaction between banks located in two different countries happens through a network of intermediary banks called 'correspondent banks'. Because the banks in these countries have different local currencies, any international transaction between them would necessarily involve a global reserve currency.

About 90% of all foreign exchange transactions involve the US dollar as the reserve currency. Thus, when a bank in the UAE remits Dirhams to a bank in India, the Dirhams get converted into US dollars, and then the US dollars get converted into Indian rupees. However, every US dollar transaction in the world, no matter where it originates or ends, must ultimately be cleared through a correspondent bank account physically located in the United States.

The network of correspondent banks in the United States, called the



Project Agorá highlights the growing intersection of technology, finance and geopolitical rivalry

Clearing House Interbank Payments System (CHIPS), is a private network but must comply with economic sanctions issued by the US Department of the Treasury. It's a financial chokepoint for global trade and remittances, just as the Strait of Hormuz is a physical chokepoint for global trade in oil.

According to experts, as Iran has now weaponised the Strait of Hormuz, the US Treasury has consistently weaponised CHIPS in the last two decades. The US Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) can restrict foreign entities' and countries' access to CHIPS by applying sanctions that CHIPS is mandated to follow. Access to CHIPS is crucial for cross-border transactions, given the preeminence of the US dollar in foreign exchange transactions.

The rise of Digital Yuan
In 2021, BIS began developing an alternative rail for cross-border transactions called mBridge. The central banks of China, Hong Kong, Thailand, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE participated in the development of this

alternative rail. mBridge is built using similar technology to that used by Bitcoin. It enables CBDCs of participating countries to engage in direct, peer-to-peer payments, now called 'atomic settlement'.

The beauty of mBridge is that it bypasses all intermediaries, including CHIPS. It also does not require the assistance of SWIFT (a Belgium-based payment messaging system) for confirming the payment. It is economically attractive because transactions are near-instantaneous and save on various compliance costs.

A key concern is that the system bypasses the anti-money laundering (AML) compliance checks conducted by intermediaries. No doubt, the banks at either end of the transactions do conduct AML compliance checks. But AML compliance usually includes sanctions screening, and CHIPS intermediaries screen transactions involving entities sanctioned by the US Treasury. In short, mBridge potentially renders CHIPS powerless, if commercialised.

The G7 Counter Offensive

A major geopolitical fault line developed in late 2024 when BIS exited from mBridge. While a benign reason was given for this exit, experts believe it was due to discomfort among policymakers in Western countries. In early 2024, the US, the UK, Japan, France, Switzerland, South Korea, and Mexico backed the initiation of another BIS project called Project Agorá (Canada also joined the project later). It is developing an alternative rail that resembles CHIPS' current system.

Rather than promoting retail transactions in CBDCs, it promotes wholesale CBDCs between central banks and large commercial banks. It uses smart contracts to automate AML compliance, thereby reducing compliance costs. Yet AML compliance would include sanctions screening. It is still unclear whether the transactions would be screened only for global sanctions (imposed by the United Nations Security Council) or for unilateral sanctions imposed by the US Treasury as well.

Atomic settlement has its own disadvantages vis-à-vis CHIPS. It relies on real-time gross settlement (RTGS) principles, which require participating commercial banks to hold large pools of local currencies and/or CBDCs. CHIPS, on the other hand, optimises liquidity. The unique selling proposition of Agorá is that it modernises CHIPS, reduces AML compliance costs, and retains the advantages of CHIPS.

The BIS report of 27 May announces the successful development of Agorá's prototype; it will now move into a real-value testing phase.

The devil and the deep sea
As of now, there is no clear winner between mBridge and Agorá. mBridge is clearly dominated by China. By early 2026, it had facilitated USD 55 billion in payments, of which approximately 95% of transaction volume was in China's CBDC (e-yuan). Agorá seeks to maintain the status quo of Western dominance over cross-border payments.

As the technologies progress, they can potentially fragment the market of international transactions. It is unclear whether a single clear winner will emerge for instantaneous cross-border transactions. But it's clear that if a single winner emerges, whoever controls the rails will wield power over global finance and can weaponise it.

There are other projects that BIS is experimenting with central banks of various countries, such as Project Dunbar, Project Jura, Project Mandala, Project Rialto, etc. The Reserve Bank of India is a full participant in Mandala and Rialto, while it's an observer on mBridge. Views expressed are personal

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

Harvest festivals of 2026 took place against a background of gloom in states such as Assam and Punjab, where climate change wreaked havoc

Caught in a Storm

Climate change has been thrusting Indian farmers into situations of repeated crises. We need to bring the focus to building resilience in agriculture

At what point do pledges and promises seem empty? All of us do it ahead of days like, say, World Environment Day. We will hold up saplings and pose for Instagram while remaining unaffected as older trees are slaughtered without thought or care, and incomparable baby ones are planted in a different part of the region. This is one of the surest ways of greenwashing that ultimately yields nothing. Not my words — I gleaned this knowledge after speaking to arborists, environmentalists, and researchers.

I would love to ask you to do this and not to do that. But the truth is that our words seem hollow when actions don't follow. Yes, we aren't going with axes in hand to cull trees. Often, normal people have negligible say when green covers vanish. These decisions are taken by the administration in the name of development. And of course, that's essential. Metro railway projects must come up or expand, a populous city needs a second airport, and data centres will dictate the future. But can our planners take more than a moment to decide the fate of decades-old trees? Shouldn't there be stricter, more authoritative assessment reports that not only highlight the benefits of said development but also the environmental cost? Scrapping a project on ecological grounds may seem frustrating to those of a capitalistic bent of mind, but herein lies the real challenge — sensitisation. Even today, most people, including those commanding huge



Human-driven environmental damage and worsening weather extremes are eroding agricultural productivity

corporations, directing the flow of millions of dollars, and employing hundreds of people, miss this. While they claim to understand the environmental aspect, they seldom truly get it. The impact, the fall-out, the repercussions on current and future generations — this never really penetrates their being.

Case in point, behold the recent devastation caused by climate change to our nation's crops and the debilitating effect it's having on our farmers and food security. Our prized fruit, the Alphonso mango from Maharashtra, has faced a serious blow this year with hotter weather ruining the "King of Fruits". Experts ascribe losses in Devgad, one of the leading Alphonso growing regions in the state, to day and night-time temperature change during the flowering and fruiting months of December and January, followed by higher temperatures than usual in

April and May due to the El Niño effect. News reports cite a government survey to deduce that 85 per cent to 90 per cent of the crop has been lost this year. As the largest exporter of mangoes, the ongoing war in West Asia has further hurt the sector in India. Adding insult to injury, Japan has banned Indian mangoes over pest control lapses found in vapour heat treatment (VHT) facilities in the country, discovered during inspections made earlier this year.

Indian farmers are paying a heavy price due to climate change. Harvest festivals of 2026 took place against a background of gloom in states such as Assam and Punjab, where climate change wreaked havoc. In Assam, over 20,000 acres of crops were damaged by floods and hailstorms in the past year. In Punjab, the story was no different — wheat crops across 135,000 acres were destroyed

by unseasonal rain and hailstorms. For the rest of us, sudden hailstorms and unseasonal rain mean the onset of romantic weather with hot cups of chai and pakora; a few hundred kilometres away, our farmer brethren stare at destruction.

As per the UN Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), globally, almost 40 per cent of crops are damaged by pests and diseases; the Indian government put that number at 30 per cent for us. The resilience, survival, and accelerated breeding of insects is directly linked to climate change. Propelled by man-made land degradation and heightened pollution, crop yields are steadily declining as well, while frequent episodes of extreme weather are causing destruction of crops. Climate shocks are regularly impacting India's food security, driving up food inflation, causing shortages, and loss. Researchers suggest that there is hardly

any "normal" weather any longer, with pre-Monsoon emerging as the new high-risk period for crops. As per a study by the Centre for Science and Environment (CSE) and Down To Earth magazine, we were struck by climate-related disasters on 331 of 334 days in 2025, up from 295 in 2024, and 292 in 2022. This year, extreme weather events took place almost every day till early 2026. Real-time weather ranking in June showed that 95 of the world's 100 hottest cities are located in India. According to an Oxford University study, 14 of the world's 50 most heat-vulnerable cities are in India.

So what can we do to cope, tackle, and possibly reverse the effects of climate change? Policy-makers and administrators must brace the urgency of the situation and put plans into action. Agricultural and environmental experts suggest a change towards ecosystem-based adaptations (EbA), which use natural biodiversity to the communities' advantage. Other ways to be climate-ready would be to initiate crop diversification and rotation to handle pests and agroforestry to encourage an increase in green cover and aid with climate resilience. Enhanced use of technology, artificial intelligence (AI), drones, satellite systems, and so forth, can fortify surveillance and sound early alarms. Most importantly, we will have to shed climate scepticism en masse. Being climate-resilient is neither a fad nor an option, but rather a critical necessity. Views expressed are personal



DEAREEDITOR

LEGACY BEYOND MEDALS

The untimely demise of Jaspal Rana at just 49 is a profound loss not only to Indian shooting but to Indian sport as a whole. As a champion shooter, he brought glory to the nation with his record medal haul, and as a coach, he shaped a new generation of champions, most notably Manu Bhaker. His transition from elite athlete to mentor reflected his deep commitment to the sport. Rana's disciplined approach, passion and eye for talent helped build India's shooting ecosystem. His passing is a reminder that true sporting legacies are measured not only in medals won, but in lives inspired.

— ROHAN MATHUR, NEW DELHI via email

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TO WIND DOWN ONGOING WAR

Trump raises expectations of really closing deal with Iran

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump has long been looking for this weekend to be a big one for his presidency.

The World Cup returns to the US on Friday for the first time in 32 years after Trump threw himself into winning the bid to co-host the soccer tournament during his first term.



US President Donald Trump AP/PTI

He'll be feted Sunday, his 80th birthday, during a UFC fight night that's expected to draw thousands to the White House grounds. Hours after the final bout, he's scheduled to jet off to the G7 summit in the French Alps for talks with several world leaders he's been beefing with over war and tariffs.

But Trump set expectations even higher for the coming days when he announced Thursday that the US and Iran could come to terms this

weekend on an agreement that would set the pathway to end the three-month-old war that's been broadly unpopular with Americans and has rattled global oil markets.

He said he plans to dispatch Vice President JD Vance to the signing of the agreement.

Trump has said on several occasions in recent weeks that he's on the cusp of a deal without anything coming to fruition.

A spokesperson for Iran's Foreign Ministry told state television following Trump's comments that mediators were

Highlights

- » Trump set expectations even higher for the coming days when he announced that the US and Iran could come to terms this weekend
- » Trump has said on several occasions in recent weeks that he's on the cusp of a deal without anything coming to fruition

industry, including capturing Iran's vital Kharg Island oil facility. The president's threats followed back-and-forth strikes this week that had rendered a temporary ceasefire agreed to in early April all but meaningless.

"They've taken a pounding like very few people could take," Trump said in an Oval Office exchange with reporters as he explained why he was confident that, this time, a deal would come through. "And they want to make the deal a lot more than I do."

Trump offered scant details about the settlement he says is taking shape, but told reporters that he believed the Iranian supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, who is believed to have been wounded on the first day of the war and has not been seen in public since, is ready to sign off on the deal.

Indonesian students protest govt policies as economic pressures grow

JAKARTA: Hundreds of Indonesian students rallied on Friday in Indonesia's capital, Jakarta, demanding lower fuel and food prices and urging President Prabowo Subianto to roll back costly state spending programmes as economic pressures mount.

About 1,500 protesters tried to march to the Hotel Indonesia traffic circle, a key city landmark, after Friday prayers. Authorities stopped many of them and also blocked streets leading to the presidential palace, where many protests often end up. More than 6,000 police and soldiers were deployed there.

Protesters, many wearing yellow university jackets, voiced their frustration over living costs, which have risen as a result of higher fuel costs since the US launched its war against Iran.

Indonesia's rupiah currency has come under pressure, hitting a historic low of 18,000 rupiah to the US dollar earlier this month.

Protesters outlined five key demands, including cuts to what they called wasteful state



Police officers block student protesters during a rally against a fuel price hike, government inefficient spending, and military involvement in civilian affairs in Jakarta on Friday AP/PTI

spending, lower prices for fuel and staple goods, and a halt to major government programmes such as a free nutritious meal initiative and a plan to revitalise rural areas.

The free meals programme, costing about 268 trillion rupiah (USD 15 billion) for this year alone, is aimed at alleviating poverty and malnutrition, but Prabowo recently fired the head of the programme amid a massive graft probe.

They also called for an end

to what they described as the increasing role of the military in civilian affairs, something they view as a threat to the young democracy.

"The government is in denial about the current situation," said Yatalathof Ma'shum Imawan, who chairs the student organisation that organised the rally.

"We urge Prabowo to have the courage to acknowledge his mistake and stop denying it."

Starmer says he will fight to stay in job

Remarks come after top minister quits amid military spending row



British Prime Minister Keir Starmer

LONDON: British Prime Minister Keir Starmer vowed Friday that he will fight to stay in office after the sudden resignation of his trusted defence minister left his shaky leadership weakened still further.

Starmer has seen the departure of several junior and senior ministers in recent weeks, as Labour Party lawmakers revolt and rivals plot, in despair at the government's relentless unpopularity.

But the sudden resignation of Defence Secretary John Healey is a heavy blow. Healey quit Thursday, warning that the government is not spending enough on the military to keep Britain safe "at this time of rising threats."

His departure hits Starmer in the one place

the often embattled prime minister has won consistent praise: the world stage.

Since taking office after a landslide election victory in July 2024, Starmer has bolstered support for Ukraine, working with French President Emmanuel Macron on a multinational "coalition of the willing" to help guarantee the country's security if a ceasefire is reached.

France and the UK also have put together a maritime security force that would help keep the Strait of Hormuz open to shipping if the Iran war ends.

Starmer has also argued strongly that European nations must do more to fund their own defence in response to President Donald Trump's criticism of the United States' NATO allies.

UN anti-torture body to assess SL's detention reforms

COLOMBO: A United Nations anti-torture monitoring body will visit Sri Lanka next week to assess progress on reforms aimed at preventing torture and ill-treatment in places of detention, seven years after its last mission to the island nation, officials said on Friday.

The 10-day visit, scheduled from June 15 to 24, will evaluate whether Sri Lankan authorities have implemented recommendations made during the UN Subcommittee on Prevention of Torture's previous visit and strengthened safeguards for "people in detention or other places where they may be deprived of their liberty," the UN body said in a statement issued in Geneva.

ILLINOIS: Authorities and residents searched tornado-ravaged areas and assessed damage Friday after a strong line of storms barrelled through communities south of Chicago, leaving several hundred thousand customers without power in Illinois and Indiana and disrupting air travel in the region.

There were no immediate reports of deaths or life-threatening injuries from Thursday's storms, although several people were treated for minor injuries, officials said.

Officials in Merrillville, Indiana, about 33 miles (53 kilometres) southeast of Chicago, reported extensive damage. Homes and other buildings were torn apart, downed trees and power lines blocked streets and part of a high school's roof was ripped off.

Multiple agencies from the region helped local first responders search and assessed damaged areas, town officials said on social media. Crews



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

“SEVERAL HUNDRED THOUSAND CUSTOMERS ARE WITHOUT POWER IN ILLINOIS AND INDIANA”

worked into the night clearing roads.

Marsha Smith was in her

Merrillville apartment building when the tornado struck the complex, tearing roofs off three buildings, knocking down trees and breaking car windshields before heavy rain caused more damage. She and some neighbors huddled under an indoor stairwell holding hands and praying.

"The louder the tornado got, the louder I started praying," said Smith, 54, a CPR instructor.

NO REPORTS OF DEATHS SO FAR Strong storms hit Illinois, Indiana

Ahead of G7, Carney softens tone toward Trump with trade talks at stake

OTTAWA: Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney became a symbol of middle power resistance after a celebrated speech earlier this year, but he is expected to be more muted in his criticism of US President Donald Trump at an upcoming summit in Europe.

Carney's speech at the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, helped make him an international political star in January, when he declared the global rules-based order over and condemned coercion by great powers on smaller countries.

The prime minister received widespread praise and attention for his remarks and upstaged Trump at the gathering.

But the Group of Seven summit of industrialised democracies that begins Monday in France comes ahead of the scheduled July 1 review of the US-Mexico-Canada Agreement, or USMCA, the latest iteration of the North American free-trade pact that has intertwined the economies of the United States, Mexico and Canada since the early 1990s. It is a crucial

Key Points

- » Canadian PM Mark Carney becomes a symbol of middle power resistance after a celebrated speech earlier this year at World Economic Forum in Davos
 - » Trump leaves for G7 right after he hosts UFC fights at White House on Sunday for his 80th birthday
- OVER 70 % OF CANADA'S EXPORTS GO TO THE US

moment in trade talks, and Trump said this week that he may not renew the deal.

More than 70 per cent of Canada's exports go to the US, so preserving the accord is critical for Canada.

Canadian historian Robert Bothwell said Trump is more of a problem for Carney "than anybody else because we are more exposed to the United

States than anybody else."

Trump leaves for the G7 right after he hosts UFC fights at the White House on Sunday for his 80th birthday.

The summit will unfold as tensions are ramping up between Trump and Canada.

One of the world's most durable and amicable alliances — born of geography, heritage and centuries of common interests — is broken, as seen in several recent examples of tension between leaders.

Ontario Premier Doug Ford, the leader of Canada's

most populous province, had a reception with the US Chamber of Commerce in Washington cancelled Monday at the last minute.

Vic Fedeli, one of Ford's ministers, said if Trump forced the chamber to cancel, "Ford should be wearing that as a badge of honour."

Trump said again this week that the US doesn't need anything that Canada has. Carney has set a goal for Canada to double its non-US exports in the next decade, saying Trump's trade war is causing a chill in investment.

'Migrant rights will be safeguarded at third-country return hub'

NICOSIA: The European Union's executive arm will monitor any agreement to set up so-called return hubs in non-EU countries so that the rights of rejected asylum seekers sent there are protected, the bloc's migration commissioner said Friday.

Magnus Brunner said any such deal will also be vetted by the International Organisation for Migration and the UN refugee agency to ensure compliance with those legal safeguards.

"Human rights standards and international law is non-negotiable," Brunner told a news conference during a meeting of EU migration ministers to mark the implementation of the bloc's new migration and asylum pact.

The return hub concept is just one of the new pact's provisions that have been met with scepticism from human rights groups that question whether these centres could turn into long-term holding facilities overflowing with failed

The return hub concept is just one of the new pact's provisions that have been met with scepticism from human rights groups

asylum seekers stuck in legal limbo.

Greece repeated Friday that it is one of five EU members, along with Germany, Austria, Denmark and the Netherlands, that is negotiating with African countries to set up such return hubs on their territory.

According to the Greek Migration Ministry, the five EU countries are to strike a deal with these unnamed third countries this year so that the return hubs can be up and running in 2027.

Brunner wouldn't say which third countries are being considered for the return hubs.

Trauma lingers for UK families one year after Air India crash that killed 260

Prayers and tributes marked the sombre first anniversary of the crash

LONDON: Families in the UK continue to struggle with the trauma of losing loved ones in one of the world's biggest airline disasters, as prayers and tributes on Friday marked the sombre first anniversary of the Air India Flight 171 crash.

The Boeing 787 Dreamliner had 242 people, including 12 crew members, on board when it plummeted into the student hostel and canteen building of a medical college shortly after taking off in Ahmedabad on June 12, 2025.

The incident claimed 260 lives. Of those, 241 were passengers and crew on board the aircraft and 19 were on the ground. Mohammad Shethwala, 28, who lost his wife Sadikabanu, 24, and their two-and-a-half-year-old daughter Fatima is among those struggling both emotionally and financially.

Based in London as a dependent on his wife's visa, Shethwala applied for an extension on humanitarian grounds, but his struggle was compounded when the UK Home Office rejected the application.



Some families are being supported through the legal process

"Not only have I lost everything, but now I am not even being allowed the time to try and cope with this mental trauma. I am not asking for settlement rights in the UK. All I ask is a couple of years to be able to move on in the country

where I feel closest to the memory of my wife and child," said Shethwala.

He is pursuing a judicial review process but remains unsure about what the future holds for him.

Some families are being sup-

ported through the legal process, while an interim report by India's Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) - which was supposed to be released in a year - is awaited. Keystone Law in London, which is representing 25 British families who lost loved ones on AI171, said families expect and deserve to know why their loved ones lost their lives, and the AAIB has a "duty to be candid and honest about the causes."

"We are currently in ongoing, productive, and confidential negotiations with Air India and their aviation insurers, led by AIG, exploring full and fair settlements under our High Court rules here in London.

No money will ever bring back these loved ones, but it is a measure of the losses needlessly suffered by these families," said James Healy-Pratt, Aviation Partner at Keystone.

Stewarts, a London law firm representing several bereaved families, said one year on they are still waiting for "meaningful answers" about how and why the tragedy occurred.

World Briefs

PAK HIKES ITS DEFENCE SPENDING BY 17.6 PER CENT TO PKRS 3,000 BILLION

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Friday hiked its defence spending by 17.6 per cent to PKRs 3,000 billion, marking a significant increase from last year. Last year, the government allocated PKRs 2550 billion for defence, which was 20 per cent higher than the previous year. "The government has made a significant increase in the defence budget," Minister for Finance and Revenue Muhammad Aurangzeb said while presenting the budget 2026-27 before the National Assembly. Aurangzeb said that the total federal budget is estimated at PKRs 18,771 billion and the "GDP growth target is 4 per cent".

INDIAN-ORIGIN POLICE CONSTABLE KILLED IN LINE OF DUTY IN CANADA

OTTAWA: An Indian-origin provincial police constable in Ontario, who was killed in the line of duty, was on Friday remembered by Foreign Minister Anita Anand for his "courage, dedication, and commitment" to keeping Canadians safe. Originally from Brampton, 29-year-old Tarun Bali, a constable with the Ontario Provincial Police (OPP), was killed when he and the members of the James Bay detachment tried to stop a vehicle in which a person from a mental health facility had fled in Hearst, 950-odd kilometres northwest of Ottawa. "We mourn the loss of Provincial Constable Tarun Bali, who gave his life in service to others. His courage, dedication, and commitment to keeping Canadians safe will not be forgotten," Anand said.

Suspect dead
after Texas
shooting kills 1,
leaves 9 others
in hospital

MIDLAND: A shooter who opened fire in the West Texas city of Midland died Friday after a standoff with police following an attack that left one person dead and at least nine others injured, city officials said.

Midland police said the active shooter situation ended hours after the gunfire erupted in one part of the city before ending up near a veterinary hospital.

Police did not immediately say how the suspect died.

Andrea Mendias said she heard what sounded like a small explosion at the closed veterinary clinic next to the body shop where she works and saw a number of heavily armed police officers rush into the parking lot. Some appeared to go inside the building.

Mendias said she earlier heard what sounded like at least 40 gunshots.

Video from Mendias showed officers pouring out of the back of an armoured police vehicle and police deploying robots into the area.

Midland Memorial Hospital said four people were in the operating room and five others were in stable condition.

The city with about 140,000 residents sits in the heart of the state's oil region and was near the site of a deadly shooting rampage in 2019.

In that shooting, a gunman who had been fired from his oil services job killed seven people and wounded two dozen others while firing at random as he drove around the Odessa and Midland areas. The two cities are more than 300 miles (482 km) west of Dallas.AGENCIES

Pak: 2 killed in
separate blasts
near mosques

PESHAWAR: At least two people were killed and several others injured in two separate explosions near mosques in Pakistan's northwestern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa during Friday prayers, police said. In Bajaur district's Targao area, an improvised explosive device (IED) exploded near a seminary, in which a 60-year-old man died while two others sustained injuries.

Deputy Superintendent of Police Was-eullah Rehman said the deceased's body had been transferred to Khar Hospital.

He added that investigations into the IED explosion were underway. AGENCIES

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Ramesh Chandra, son of the late Ramswaroop Chandra, resident of 148, K-2, Sector-10, Faridabad, Haryana, had previously—through a public notice published on 26.03.2026—declared my sons, Aryan Chandra and Aryanman Chandra, disowned and deprived of any rights regarding my movable and immovable property as well as family affairs. In view of the mutual family consensus, improved relationships, and prevailing circumstances, the said public notice is hereby withdrawn. Therefore, my sons Aryan Chandra and Aryanman Chandra are once again acknowledged as my legal heirs and members of the family, and their legal rights regarding my movable and immovable properties shall be recognized.

LOST & FOUND

I, Amrit Vaish S/o Shiv Shankar Lal Vaish & Kumudini Vaish U/o Shiv Shankar Lal Vaish, R/o C011 Gulshan Bellina Plot GH02A Sector 16C, Greater Noida West-201318, U.P. have misplaced of my property papers of Allotment Booklet which was given by ICICI Bank, while going from Sector-16 to Central Bank of India Gaur City Centre on 05.06.2026 between 17:00 to 18:00 Hrs. If it will be found by anyone please contact @ 9325745055.

Amrit Vaish S/o Shiv Shankar Lal Vaish, R/o C011 Gulshan Bellina Plot GH02A Sector 16C, Greater Noida West-201318, U.P.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
First corrigendum to Tender Notice No. JHS-ENGG-N-2026-124

CORRIGENDUM NO. 1

It is notified that the following corrections are made in the tender invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Works) North Central Railway, Jhansi vide Tender Notice No. JHS-ENGG-N-2026-124 dt. 22.05.2026, which is due to be opened on 15.06.2026, the following correction is being made -

Existing Date of closing Tender	Modified Date of closing Tender
15.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.	22.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Other terms and conditions of the original tender notification shall remain unchanged. 117826 (MG)

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR

मध्यप्रदेश लघु उद्योग निगम मर्यादित
कार्यालय महाप्रबंधक (संपदा/निर्माण), संभाग क्रमांक-01, पंचानन भवन द्वितीय तल, मालवीय नगर, भोपाल (म.प्र.)
Email : laghubpl01@gmail.com, laghubpl2@gmail.com
दूरभाष : 0755-2673196
क्रमांक : लउनि/निर्माण/संभाग भोपाल/2026-27/743
भोपाल, दिनांक : 11.06.2026

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्न कार्यों की निविदा ई-टेंडरिंग पद्धति से वेबसाइट <https://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर आमंत्रित की जाती हैं:- भोपाल संभाग क्र.01, निविदा क्रमांक 54, कार्य का नाम - एमपीएसएसडीईजीबी एवं शासकीय संभागीय मुख्य भवन आई.टी.आई. केम्पस गोविन्दपुरा भोपाल, जिला भोपाल में विभिन्न सिविल एलाइड, इटीरियर रिनोवेशन एवं फर्नीशिंग कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 257.92 लाख। भोपाल संभाग क्र.02, निविदा क्रमांक 44, कार्य का नाम - कला निकेतन पॉलीटेक्निक कॉलेज साउथ सिविल लाइन जबलपुर, जिला जबलपुर में रिनोवेशन एवं फर्नीशिंग कार्य, अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 175.04 लाख। निविदाओं की समस्त जानकारी उक्त वेबसाइट पर दी जावेगी। निविदाओं में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है, तो वह उपरोक्त वेबसाइट पर देखा जा सकता है। बिना कोई कारण बताये निविदा को स्वीकृत अथवा निरस्त करने का अधिकार निगम के पास सुरक्षित है।
म.प्र. माध्यम/126356/2026 महाप्रबंधक (सं./नि.)

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN COMPANY LIMITED
(Govt. of M.P. Undertaking)
NISHTHA PARISAR, BIJALEE NAGAR, GOVINDPURA, BHOPAL-23, Phone No.0755-2602033-36
Fax : 2589821, 2586636
Ref:- MD/MK/04/816 Date : 12.06.2026

NOTICE

MPMKVVCL, Bhopal, invites Expression of Interest through e-tendering.

EOI Number	Particulars	Last Date for submission of EOI	Date of opening of EOI
MD/ MK/04/ 816	Expression of Interest for Annual Maintenance Contract for LT Underground Infrastructure in Bhopal City	24.06.2026 03.00 PM	25.06.2026 at 03:00 PM

Other details would be available on Company website <https://portal.mpcz.in> & Govt. Website <https://mptenders.gov.in> shortly.
M.P.M./126368/2026 CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (PROC.)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1. Name of Work with its location	Augmentation/Replacement of Catenary wire over Delhi Division (7th Phase).
2. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 1,80,29,018.38/-
3. Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 3,60,600/-
4. E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	24.06.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 08.07.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5. E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	08.07.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender No.: 09A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 12.06.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2024/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Engineer/IV, Northern Railway, Delhi Division for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender on prescribed form for the following work.

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

Name of work with its location	Yard Improvement in DLI-BTI section in the Jurisdiction of DEN-IV/DLI, CTR-45.05 Km in loop lines (Contractor's SORS-28.90 Km & Manual-16.15 Km), TTR-54 sets Trap-34 sets & SEJ renewal-53 sets, (NIT-18-26-27-W-IV)
Approx cost of work	Rs. 9,67,97,826.23/-
Earnest Money	Rs. 19,36,000.00/-
Date and Starting time for filling e-tender & Tender opening time	Starting time for filling e-tender is Date-23.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs. & Tender opening time is Date-07.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Website particulars, published e-tender notice location etc. complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No: 128-W/260/Tender Notice/18-26-27/W-IV Dated: 12.06.2026	2022/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Padam Singh, S/o: Lt. Sh. Pyarela R/o: H.No. 265, Village- Kanjhawala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 864/2016, U/s: 279/338 IPC & 185 MV ACT, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Padam Singh**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Padam Singh**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Padam Singh, of FIR No. 864/2016, U/s: 279/338 IPC & 185 MV ACT, PS: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.07.2026**.

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. JHS/BR/L/2026-27/05 Date : 11.06.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE
Single Packet System

Dy. Chief Engineer/Bridge/Lines/Jhansi, North Central Railway, Jhansi for and on behalf of President of India invites open E-tenders on the prescribed forms for the under noted work :-

Tender no. : Br-JHS-2026-05	Approx. Cost of work : Rs. 2,90,85,513.52
Name of work : Painting of FOBs, ROB's & track girder bridges over Jhansi division under DYCE/BR/L/JHS.	
Bid Security (Earnest Money) : Rs. 5,80,300.00/-	
Date of closing of Tender : 03.07.2026	Completion Period : 12 Months
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : "Any bridge painting work"	
Note : 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on the due to date of tender closing i.e. 03.07.2026. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entry in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightway ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. Payment of Bid Security (Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway or bank guarantee only. 6. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 7. Tender on file can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on dated 03.07.2026. 134026 (AS)	
North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR	

कार्यालय नगर पालिक निगम, भोपाल
यांत्रिक, विभाग (मुख्यालय) अटल भवन लिंक नम्बर 02 तुलसी नगर
निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

क 71 / यांवि / 26
निम्न कार्य हेतु म.प्र. लोक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।
विस्तृत विवरण [website.https:// www.mptenders.gov.in](http://www.mptenders.gov.in) पर है।

क्र	निविदा क्र.	कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रु. में)	निविदा कब करने का अंतिम दिनांक	समय
01	2026_UAD 514628_1	Providing and Fixing Paver Block, Tiranga Grill and Other Beautification Work Parallel to Kolar Six Lane from Bhoj University to Sarvdharm Bridge Ward No.80, Zone no.18	3,17,17,913/-	13-Jul-2026	05:30 PM

नोट— संशोधन वेबसाइट पर ही देखे जा सकेंगे, समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित नहीं होंगे।
नि.क्र. 312 / 026 / 027 कार्यपालन यंत्री (सिविल)
नगर निगम भोपाल

कार्यालय संयुक्त संचालक एवं अधीक्षक
छत्तीसगढ़ आयुर्विज्ञानसंस्थान (सिम्स चिकित्सालय) बिलासपुर छग0— 495001
FAX (o) — 07752-237400, PHONE (O): 07752-237400 Email address- mscmsbsp@gmail.com
FINACC/8004/2026-BUDGET_GMCH_BILASPUR/Yantriki Date 11-06-26

// दावा आपत्ति हेतु सूचना //

सिम्स चिकित्सालय में रेडियोलॉजीसिंस विभाग में स्थापित DX—D 300 DI AXYS, DX —M DI 5503 एवं DX-D 100 DI 5503 मशीन का सी.एम.सी किया जाना है जिस हेतु निर्माता कंपनी से प्राक्कलन प्राप्त हुआ है विवरण निम्न है—

Sr. No.	Item discription	Purchase Price Per Unit	Qty	CMC Rate	GST18 %	G.Total
1.	DX—D 300 DI AXYS	1,12,00,439.04	01	4,92,677.12	88,681.88	5,81,359.00
2.	DX —M DI 5503	34,25,000.00	01	1,32,612.71	23,870.29	1,56,483.00
3	DX-D 100 DI 5503	79,00,000.00	01	5,45,000.00	98,100.00	6,43,100.00

उक्त मशीन के वार्षिक रखरखाव सीएमसी / मरम्मत हेतु दावा आपत्ति / प्राक्कलन हेतु निर्माता / अधिकृत एजेंसी से मुहरबंद लिफाफा सीडीपोस्ट / रजिस्टर्ड डाक के माध्यम से भेजी जा सकती है।

दावा आपत्ति एवं प्राक्कलन संबंधी दिनांक 13.07.2026 समय शाम 4 बजे तक दस्तावेज भेजने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय परा— संयुक्त संचालक एवं अधीक्षक, सदर बजार, गोंडपारा, सिम्स चिकित्सालय, बिलासपुर, छग0

G 262701415/ 4 संयुक्त संचालक एवं अधीक्षक
सिम्स चिकित्सालय, बिलासपुर छग0

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (BHOPAL REGION)
M. P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN COMPANY LTD.
NISHTHA PARISAR, BJULINAGAR, GOVINDPURA, BHOPAL-462023
Phone: 0755-2588291, E-mail : sepurchasebr@gmail.com

NIT No. : CGM/BR/02/Pur/2432 Bhopal, Dated : 12.06.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER (OPEN TENDER)

E-tenders are invites bids from eligible bidders for supply of following item :-

TS No.	Particulars	Approx. Value (In Lakh)	Tender Fee (In Rs.)	EMD (In Rs.)	Date of Opening of Bids Online
CGM/BR/ TS-164	Supply of DPC Aluminium Wire (1.60 mm)	31.86 Lakh	5000/-+ GST @ 18 % Extra	64000/-	30.06.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.
CGM/BR/ TS-165	Supply of DPC Aluminium & Super Enamelled Wire (Assorted Size)	62.47 Lakh	5000/- +GST @ 18% Extra	125000/-	01.07.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in> or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/126370/2026 CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (B.R.)

UTTARAKHAND POWER CORPORATION LTD.
Executive Engineer Electricity Distribution Division (South)
18 E.C Road, Dehradun Email : eddsouth.upcl@gmail.com

TENDER NOTICE

Executive Engineer, EDD(South), Uttarakhand Power Corporation Ltd. Dehradun invites tender for following work, as detailed below:-

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Tender Specificati on No.	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Cost of tender document including GST (in Rs.)	Last Date of Sale of tender document	Last Date of Submission of tender	Date of opening of Part-I of tender
1	Supply & Installation of Fire Extinguisher at 33/11 KV S/S Under EDD (South) Dehradun	17/EDD(S) /2026-27	45000.00	1180.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs
2	Shifting Work of Different Site against MPA/MLA Fund EDSD Niranjanpur, Turner Road/Vasnat Vihar/ Bhandari Bagh under EDD South Dehradun	18/EDD(S) /2026-27	29000.00	590.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs
3	Estimate of Damage U/G Cable of 11 KV Vaibhav Feeder Nera Anurag Chowk under EDD (South) Dehradun	19/EDD(S) /2026-27	20500.00	590.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs
4	Attending Breakdown of Damage Cable 11 KV 11 KV Pathri Bagh at Palm City gate EDSD Turner Road Under EDD (South) Dehradun	20/EDD(S) /2026-27	4800.00	295.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs
5	Strengthening & Maintenance of Lt Line at Different Site EDSD Bhandari Bagh under EDD (South) Dehradun	21/EDD(S) /2026-27	16400.00	295.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs
6	Providing & Fixing of Battery for GIS 33/11 KV S/S Pathri Bagh EDSD Turner Road under EDD (South) Dehradun	22/EDD(S) /2026-27	18000.00	295.00 (including GST)	29.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 upto 14:00 hrs	30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs

THE PRE-QUALIFYING REQUIREMENTS ARE AS UNDER:-

- The Bidder must be registered with Suppliers, GST, EPF, ESI Department.
- The Bidder must be registered with Electrical Inspector in 'A' class category, for electrical works/Suppliers, GST, EPF, ESI Department except tender no 17/EDD(S)/2026-27
- The Bidder must have successfully executed the similar work as an agreement with UPCL.
- Income tax return (Latest filed) of the bidder must be attached.
- An undertaking on Rs 100/- non-judicial stamp paper duly notarized by that the bidder has not been blacklisted/ debarred by any Govt. undertaking/Govt. Departments/SEB's/ Power Sector Utilities in last three years. In case same is found then their tender/order shall be treated as cancelled at any stage and EMD/Performance security shall be forfeited.
- Bidder must have validity of offer for 180 days from the date of opening of tender on 100/-stamp paper along with Rs 1/- revenue stamp (as per sheet enclosed).
- Completion Period : - Completion period shall be as per terms & conditions of LOA/Agreement.
- Earnest money/All Documents should be submitted to the office of undersigned before at 30-06-2026 before 14:00 Hrs.
- The part A must be consisted of essential documents, like terms & conditions, Income tax return, Earnest money in the form of FDR/CDR, GST/EPF/ESI registration & last Deposit Challan, Experience/ performance certificate etc.
- The bids shall be opened next day in case of holiday on the day of opening of the tender. The undersigned shall have the right to cancel one or all tenders. The other terms & conditions shall be as per boq.

The Earnest Money of the tender should be in form of FDR/CDR of any nationalized bank pledged in favour of Executive Engineer Electricity Distribution Division (South) Dehradun. Tenders will be received and opened on the dates as mentioned above. The undersigned reserve the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason there of and no claim on this account shall be acceptable. All other details and terms & conditions are available in tender document.

Executive Engineer EDD (South) Dehradun

No.: 1009/Lekha Dated: 12/06/2026

SAVE ELECTRICITY IN THE INTEREST OF THE NATION. Use LED Bulb to Save Electricity (Toll Free No. 1912) *Pay Electricity bill Online 24x7 from www.upcl.org (For Information on Electricity theft, Informer may report to Toll free No. 18001804185/ Fax No. 0135-2760911)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/26 Dt. 12.06.2026

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement Tenders.

S N	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Open- ing Date
1	38261246A	Coupler Body for Transition CBC	1622 Nos.	23.06.2026
2	30261740	Air Brake Hose Coupling for Feed Piple	43003 Nos.	07.07.2026
3	38262613	Knuckle	18391 Nos.	22.07.2026
4	64255263B	Circuit Breaker, Oil Pressure Sensor	500.00 Nos.	29-Jun-26
5	6326RG14	This is tender to enter into Running Contract for Manufacture and Supply of F.S. Switches with Drg.Nos. T-4966.	342.00 Set.	20-July-26
6	50261373	Lead Acid secondary cell 2 volte 200 Ah	5535 Nos.	31.08.2026
7	20263620	Set of Cylindrical Roller Bearing for MSU Tube	131 Set.	01.07.2026
8	80261195	Taper Roller Suspension Bearing for Hitachi Traction Motor	154 Nos.	09-Jul-26
9	80261198A	ISI Marked Portable Fire Extinguisher	3299 Nos.	06-July-26

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in new paper. 1338/26 FA

North central railways @ CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Letter No.-DRM/C/AGRA/PARKING/E-AUCTION/2026 Dated:-11.06.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category : Parking Auction Catalogue No.: PARKING-26-02

Asset Details : Bhuteshwar Railway Station, Circulating Area - Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:00

E-Auction End Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:30

Asset Details : Idgah Jn. Railway Station, IDH Station PF-1, Circulating Area-Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:00

E-Auction End Date and time : Date:-29.06.2026, Time : 12:40

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available there under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1333/26 (ADM)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE (Through e-tendering)

Name of work with its location	1. Provision of Rainnet, WiFi coverage and information display board at BLC Depot/TKD, 2. Provision of CCTV cameras at TKJ ORH Abhinandan, 3. Provision of IP based CCTV at Weighbridges installed at TKD, NDLS, DKZ, PTNR, HN2M & DLI for online monitoring.
App. Cost of the work (₹)	₹ 1,12,56,235.24/- only
Earnest Money Deposit (₹)	₹ 2,25,200/- only
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3 rd Floor, Annex-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.
Date & Time for upload the tender/closing of tender	Tender uploading / closing date & Time 06.07.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at S&T branch, 3 rd Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Tender No.: 558-Sig-16-Tele-OT-1036 Dated: 11.06.2026	2003/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

छ.ग. राज्य सहकारी विपणन संघ मर्यादित
मुख्यालय, हवी मंजिल, टावर 'सी' कमाँरीयल कॉम्प्लेक्स, सी.बी.डी., सेक्टर 21, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर (छ.ग.) 492002
फोन : 0771-2425405, 2425444 E-mail : mf_ctr@room_raipur@gov.in

क्रमांक/खाद प्रशा./40/1234 /2026, न.रा.अ.न. दिनांक 12/06/2026

खरीफ 2026 हेतु रासायनिक उर्वरकों (एनपीके ग्रेड्स) के क्रय बाबत ई-निविदा सूचना

छ.ग. राज्य सहकारी विपणन संघ मर्यादित, मुख्यालय रायपुर द्वारा खरीफ 2026 हेतु रासायनिक उर्वरक एनपीके 12:32:16, एनपीके 20:20:0:13, एनपीके 14:35:14, एनपीके 28:28:0 एवं एनपीके 10:26:26 क्रय करने हेतु ई-निविदा (जिसमें विस्तृत निविदा निर्देश एवं सर्त बर्तित हैं) दिनांक 13.06.2026 से 19.06.2026 तक ऑनलाईन आमंत्रित की जाती है।

ई-निविदा सूचना, वेबसाइट <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> में जाकर संबंधित इच्छुक निविदाकर्ता ऑनलाईन रजिस्ट्रेशन कर निविदा-प्रश्न में दर्शाए गए निर्देश अनुसार ऑनलाईन निविदा भर सकते हैं। निविदा प्रारूप, सर्तों एवं निबंधन विपणन संघ के वेबसाइट <https://markfed.cg.nic.in> पर निविदाकर्ता के अध्ययन हेतु माइडलाइन के रूप में उपलब्ध है। ई-निविदा की कार्यवाही के संबंध में अन्य किसी भी प्रकार की तकनीकी जानकारी हेतु Mjunction में संपर्क किया जा सकता है।
E-mail :- helpdesk.cgproc@mjunction.in, phone no.- 18004199140.

samvad 48145/4 महाप्रबंधक (वृ.सा.)

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER MOHALI AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Bhawan, Sector 62, SAS Nagar, Punjab
Tender Reference No. 999-1008 dated 12-06-2026
Divisional Engineer (PH-2), GMADA, SAS Nagar invites online bids for the below mentioned works:

Design, drawings and consultancy services for construction of 5 MLD capacity STP with tertiary treatment by UF in Ecocity-2, New Chandigarh, SAS Nagar by some modern technology to achieve the latest parameters fixed by CPCB/PPCB, consisting of detailed project report, tender documents, evaluation of bids, proof checking of documents of construction agency and fortnightly supervision up to completion of construction and stabilization of STP with tertiary treatment by UF.

Closing date & time: 30-06-2026 at 11:00 AM
For details log onto: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
RO No PR-Advt. No :-1324/12/2026-27/12310

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Badal Gulati, S/o Sanjay Gulati, R/o M-144, Top Floor, M-Block, Laxmi Nagar, East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 572/2021, U/s 279/338 IPC Act, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Badal Gulati** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Badal Gulati** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Badal Gulati** accused of **FIR No. 572/2021, U/s 279/338 IPC Act, P.S. Jagatpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Anushtha Sr

Bourses rebound amid fall in crude oil prices as US ends war with Iran

The market capitalisation (mcap) of BSE-listed companies surged by Rs 9,66,538.35 crore to Rs 4.62,00,318.80 crore (\$4.84 trillion)

OUR CORRESPONDENT

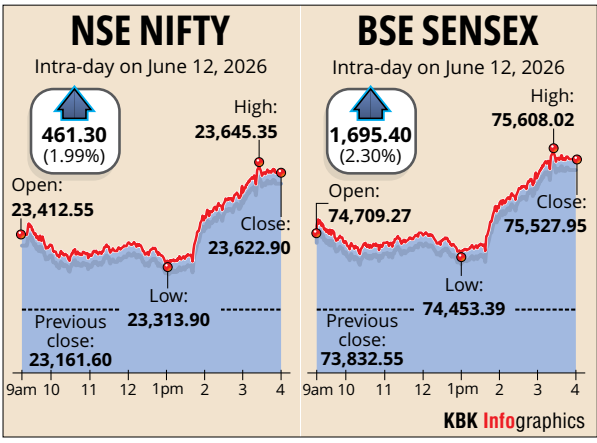
MUMBAI: Benchmark BSE Sensex jumped by 1,695 points while broader NSE Nifty closed above 23,600 on Friday, driven by a fall in crude oil prices and a global stocks rally after US President Donald Trump declared that his country has ended the war with Iran.

The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 1,695.40 points, or 2.30 per cent, to settle at 75,527.95. During the day, it surged 1,775.47 points, or 2.40 per cent, to 75,608.02.

The market capitalisation (mcap) of BSE-listed companies surged by Rs 9,66,538.35 crore to Rs 4,62,00,318.80 crore (\$4.84 trillion).

The 50-share NSE Nifty ended sharply higher by 461.30 points, or 1.99 per cent, to close at 23,622.90. Intra-day, the benchmark index zoomed 483.75 points, or 2 per cent, to 23,645.35.

US President Donald Trump said that a deal to end the war with Iran is nearly complete and is expected to be signed over the weekend in Europe, as he called off military strikes on the Islamic Republic hours after threatening to take control of its



Among 30 Sensex firms, Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, InterGlobe Aviation, Titan, Eternal and HDFC Bank were among the biggest winners

oil industry.

Crude oil prices tanked nearly 4 per cent, trading below \$90 per barrel in global markets after Trump's comments.

"I don't know if you heard, but we ended the war with Iran today (Thursday), and they have agreed never to have a nuclear weapon, something that we insisted on." That was the whole purpose," Trump said.

Among 30 Sensex firms,

Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, InterGlobe Aviation, Titan, Eternal and HDFC Bank were among the biggest winners.

Tech Mahindra and Power Grid were the only laggards from the pack.

"Indian benchmark indices witnessed a strong rally on Friday, driven by aggressive short covering and improving global sentiment. Optimism surrounding a potential US-Iran peace deal, a decline in

Highlights

» Tech Mahindra and Power Grid were the only laggards from the pack

» BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 2.75% & MidCap Select index climbed 2.66%

» Among sectoral indices, realty surged 3.55%, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (3.49%), Industrials (3.45%), Financial Services (3.14%), Private Banks index (3.07%), Bankex (2.94%) & Top 10 Banks (2.85%)

crude oil prices below the \$88 mark, a sharp recovery in the Indian Rupee, and supportive global cues collectively fuelled buying interest throughout the session," according to Bajaj Broking Research.

The BSE SmallCap Select index jumped 2.75 per cent and MidCap Select index climbed 2.66 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, realty surged 3.55 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Qual-

ity Tilt (3.49 per cent), Industrials (3.45 per cent), Financial Services (3.14 per cent), Private Banks index (3.07 per cent), Bankex (2.94 per cent) and Top 10 Banks (2.85 per cent).

A total of 3,222 stocks advanced, while 1,046 declined and 154 remained unchanged on the BSE.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark jumped 1,284.61 points, or 1.73 per cent, and the Nifty surged 256.2 points, or 1 per cent.

In Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi jumped 4.63 per cent, while Japan's Nikkei 225 index went up by 2.81 per cent.

Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng also ended higher.

European markets also traded in the positive territory. US markets ended significantly higher on Thursday.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 1,987.09 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

In the previous session, the 30-share BSE Sensex declined 150.63 points, or 0.20 per cent, to settle at 73,832.55. The Nifty edged lower by 53.35 points, or 0.23 per cent, to end at 23,161.60.

India won't be second to anybody in developing AI models: IT Secy

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India will not lag behind in its efforts to develop foundational AI models and those developed under the IndiaAI mission are a response to people who have questioned the country's potential in coming up with advanced AI platforms, a senior government official said on Friday.

While launching the country's first video foundational model by start-up Avataar.ai, Electronics and IT Secretary S Krishnan said that the government has supported a range of foundational models across different applications, not just language models.

"For all those people who say that model making or these kind of efforts cannot succeed in India, this (Avataar.ai's video platform) is an answer that shows that it can actually be done, and it's an answer that shows that India won't be second to anybody in an effort of this nature," Krishnan said.

Avataar.ai launched Varya, an indigenous AI video model developed with support from the IndiaAI Mission to make high-quality video generation more affordable, accessible and relevant for India.

Users can upload photos and raw videos on the platform and generate an edited version by just writing details of the desired video output.

Avataar CEO and Co-Founder Sravanth Aluru said that users will be able to create a 211-second video for every Rs



Electronics and IT Secretary S Krishnan said that the government has supported a range of foundational models across different applications, not just language models

100 they spend on the platform. He claimed that Varya will cut video generation time from 50 steps to 4 which makes it 10 times more efficient over leading models.

"We are today about 27x faster in video generation and equally 27 times cheaper in video generation. The reason why we've done that is we believe together as a collective that if we really want to unlock the productivity curve in India, affordable AI is very important," Aluru said.

Aluru said that the firm has

developed a video AI platform by using 14 billion parameters.

"We anticipate that we'll be unlocking markets that were not served yesterday. We'll likely create new markets by people who weren't doing videos because they thought it's too expensive and too cumbersome to actually start doing videos. We'll have to see and evolve the overall impact," he said.

When asked about the impact on the jobs in the video development segment, Aluru said that there is a need to upskill people and AI tools will need to work along with human ingenuity.

"We are allowing ideas and imagination of the creator, which is where the value lies. Convert them into actual physical videos that you can see in an efficient way. We're removing the grunt work, but preserving the ability for someone to develop a great idea that was never thought before. I think there's enough originality and human ingenuity that still exists," Aluru said.

Rupee rises 67 paise to 95.18 against dollar



MUMBAI: The rupee surged 67 paise to close at 95.18 against the greenback on Friday as global oil prices fell sharply after US President Donald Trump indicated an imminent deal with Iran.

A firm trend in domestic equity markets and a weaker American currency also supported the rupee during the day, forex traders said.

Trump has said a deal to end the war with Iran is nearly complete, and is expected to be signed over the weekend in Europe, as he called off military strikes on the Islamic Republic hours after threatening to take control of its oil industry.

Following Trump's remarks, international crude oil prices fell with Brent crude — the global oil benchmark — trading lower by 4.25 per cent at \$86.54 per barrel in futures trade.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.40 and traded in the range of 94.95-95.53 before settling at 95.18, up 67 paise from its previous close.

The rupee had plunged 60 paise to settle at 95.85 against the US dollar on Thursday.

PTI

'RBI's forex measures to cut banks' overseas borrowing costs by 2-2.5%

The report highlighted attractive economics for both depositors and lenders under the FCNR(B) framework

MUMBAI: The RBI's recent measures to incentivise overseas borrowings could lower funding costs for banks by 2-2.50 per cent through the external commercial borrowing (ECB) route, helping lenders raise resources at cheaper rates while improving liquidity conditions, according to a report.

It also said that the RBI's concessional USD/INR swap facility for ECBs and overseas foreign currency borrowings (OFCBs) will significantly reduce hedging costs for banks, allowing them to mobilise overseas funds while keeping funding costs under control.

"The borrowing cost for banks via the ECB route is



expected to fall by 2-2.50 per cent, which will enable the system to raise resources while keeping funding costs under control," said brokerage firm Motilal Oswal Financial Services in its report.

The brokerage firm said the central bank's twin measures on ECBs and Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits are likely to strengthen forex reserves,

improve systemic liquidity and provide temporary relief to banks facing deposit mobilisation pressures.

The report highlighted attractive economics for both depositors and lenders under the FCNR(B) framework, estimating that customers can earn returns of 15-26 per cent on leveraged deposits, while banks may generate around 0.65 per cent of additional spreads by deploying such funds, making it a 'win-win proposition'.

It said banks have already raised FCNR (B) deposit rates in the 3-5 year bucket to 6-7 per cent to attract inflows after the RBI opened a special swap window till September-end. PTI

MSME loan growth decelerates to 13% in April amid global uncertainties: IIFL Capital report

NEW DELHI: Global uncertainty has started to drag micro, small, and medium enterprise (MSME) activities, with loan growth decelerating to 13 per cent year-on-year in April 2026 compared to 20 per cent in December 2025, according to a report by IIFL Capital.

However, the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) is expected to cushion the impact, as past schemes had improved credit activity, fund utilisation, and lowered non-performing assets (NPAs).

To tide over the challenges arising from the West Asia conflict, the government announced ECLGS 5.0 in May 2026. This latest iteration provides a 100 per cent credit

guarantee coverage for loans extended to standard MSMEs, with the total quantum capped at Rs 1 billion per borrower.

The report expects this intervention to drive an additional credit flow of Rs 2.55 trillion, which represents approximately 5 per cent of outstanding MSME loans, with Rs 350 billion already sanctioned until the end of May.

"We believe ECLGS 5.0 should cushion the potential impact as the earlier schemes had improved (1) the credit activity, (2) fund utilisation, and (3) lowered NPA and forward flow rates," the IIFL Capital report stated. The slowdown is more pronounced for manufacturing and trading activities,

and for public sector undertakings (PSUs), which also lost three percentage points in market share over the last two years. The overall growth momentum is softening, with loan growth by value and volume slowing down to 3 per cent and negative 3.5 per cent, respectively, in the current calendar year-to-date, compared to 10 per cent and 3 per cent during the corresponding period last year.

On the asset quality front, the report mentioned that there is a marginal deterioration, with the "PAR30+ metric rising 40 basis points month-on-month in April 2026," though the shift appears largely seasonal for now.

Stress has increased relatively more for micro and small

borrowers, PSU lenders, cash credit and term loan products, alongside manufacturing and service industries. On the other hand, the report data revealed a structural resilience among larger contributors. While only 17 per cent of borrowers contribute 70 per cent of total MSME loans, their delinquency is not only lower compared to single-loan borrowers, but also improving against the marginal deterioration observed in the single-loan segment.

Simultaneously, lenders have been shifting towards higher quality borrowers, with the share of the very low-risk borrower segment rising by four percentage points over the last two years.

AGENCIES

Gold rebounds ₹3K, silver up ₹10K to ₹2.55 lakh/kg

NEW DELHI: Gold prices rebounded by Rs 3,000 to Rs 1.56 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Friday, and silver advanced by Rs 10,000 to Rs 2.55 lakh per kilogram as signs of a diplomatic breakthrough in the US-Iran stand-off rekindled interest in the precious metals.

According to local marketmen, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity climbed by Rs 3,000 to Rs 1,56,900 per 10 grams from Thursday's closing level of Rs 1,53,900 per 10 grams.

Silver also recovered sharply, surging Rs 10,000 to Rs 2,55,700 per kilogram. The



white metal had settled at Rs 2,45,700 per kg in the previous session.

In the international markets, spot gold is trading marginally lower at \$4,206.88 per ounce while silver also slipped 0.48 per cent to \$67.02 per ounce, holding on to most of its recent gains despite some profit-taking.

PTI

India's forex stocks fall \$711 mn to \$681.610 bn: RBI data

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves dropped \$711 million to \$681.610 billion during the week ended June 5 due to a sharp decline in foreign currency reserves, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week, the overall reserves had jumped \$938 million to \$682.321 billion.

For the week ended June 5, foreign currency assets — a major component of the reserves — was down \$2.704 billion to \$543.444 billion, the data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

However, the value of gold reserves increased \$1.975 billion to \$114.575 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were up \$18 million to \$18.765 billion, the RBI said.

India's reserve position with the IMF stood at \$4.826 billion in the reporting week, it added.

MAPOST

FICCI CASCADE calls for stronger action against counterfeiting & smuggling

Illicit trade has become a complex challenge with significant economic, social consequences: Amardeep Singh Rai, Special DGP, Punjab

AMRITSAR: Senior government officials and law enforcement officers on Friday called for stronger enforcement, capacity building and inter-agency collaboration to combat counterfeiting and smuggling at a programme organised by FICCI CASCADE in Amritsar.

Addressing a capacity-building programme for police officers on "Tackling Counterfeiting and Smuggling: Strategies for Effective Enforcement", Amardeep Singh Rai, Special Director General of Police (DGP), Punjab, said illicit trade has become a complex challenge with significant economic



and social consequences. "Counterfeiting and smuggling not only undermine

legitimate businesses and government revenues but also threaten consumer safety and

CLOSER LOOK

» 'Tackling these challenges requires robust enforcement, continuous capacity building & coordinated action'

» 'Illicit trade causes major losses to legitimate businesses and governments'

fuel illegal networks. Tackling these challenges requires robust enforcement, contin-

uous capacity building and coordinated action among government agencies, law enforcement authorities and industry stakeholders," Rai said.

Mohammed Tayyab, Secretary, Jails Department, Government of Punjab, stressed the need for institutional preparedness, saying, "As illicit trade networks become increasingly sophisticated, enforcement agencies must remain equipped with the knowledge, skills and tools required to effectively detect, investigate and prevent such crimes. Capacity-building initiatives play a vital role in strengthen-

ing this preparedness."

Ankurjeet Singh, Additional Secretary Home, Government of Punjab, said counterfeiting and smuggling are increasingly linked to organised crime. "Effective enforcement today requires a combination of intelligence-led policing, inter-agency cooperation and awareness of emerging trends in illicit trade," he said, adding that strengthening frontline officers' capabilities is critical to protecting the economy and citizens.

Deep Chand, Advisor, FICCI CASCADE and Former Special Commissioner of

Police, New Delhi, said illicit trade causes major losses to legitimate businesses and governments. "Counterfeiting and smuggling distort fair market competition, deprive governments of revenue and expose consumers to unsafe products," he said.

The programme brought together police officers, government officials, legal experts and industry representatives to discuss the economic and social impact of illicit trade, its links with organised crime, and measures to strengthen enforcement and consumer protection.

LIMITS DIESEL SALES TO 200 LITRES PER VEHICLE IN A DAY

Govt restricts bulk users from buying fuel via petrol pumps

OUR CORRESPONDENT

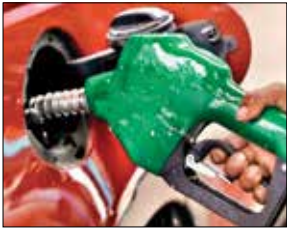
NEW DELHI: The government has capped diesel sales to a vehicle in a day at 200 litres and restricted industrial, commercial, and institutional users from buying petrol and diesel from petrol pumps in a bid to prevent local shortages amid global supply disruption, according to an official order.

Retail outlets can sell diesel only into a vehicle tank or PESO-approved container, and not more than 200 litres per customer or vehicle per day.

Also, industrial, commercial and institutional consumers will no longer be allowed to buy petrol or diesel from retail outlets. They must source their fuel from their own consumer pumps.

The restrictions, which will be in place for up to 90 days, follows abnormal demand growth, particularly that of diesel, in some pockets after bulk users started buying fuel from petrol pumps due to the pricing difference. While diesel at petrol pumps costs Rs 95.20 a litre in Delhi, bulk sales are priced at Rs 134.50.

The differential arose as state-owned oil companies modulated retail prices to insulate common users from the spike in cost that followed the West Asia crisis in late Febru-



The curbs, which will be in place for up to 90 days, follows abnormal demand growth, particularly that of diesel

ary. While bulk users such as telecom towers and industries using diesel for power generation and other feedstock needs are charged market price, the retail pump rates are way lower than cost.

Commercial customers like trucking companies and state road transport buses, too, had been tapping pumps for their needs, resulting in abnormal rise in demand in some pockets.

The price differential has also led to a shift in sales pattern with volumes shifting to PSU petrol pumps from private sector outlets that priced petrol and diesel at higher rates. In May, three state-owned firms IOC, BPCL, and HPCL saw a

Highlights

- » While diesel at fuel pumps costs Rs 95.20 per litre in Delhi, bulk sales are priced at Rs 134.50
- » The differential arose as oil PSUs modulated retail prices to insulate common users from the spike in cost
- » In May, three oil PSUs IOC, BPCL, & HPCL saw 4.8% jump in petrol & 6.4% rise in diesel sales

4.8 per cent jump in petrol sales and 6.4 per cent surge in diesel.

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas on June 11 issued the Motor Spirit and High Speed Diesel (Temporary Regulation of Supply through Retail Outlets) Order, 2026, directing fuel retailers and oil marketing companies to curb bulk purchases from retail outlets for periods of up to 90 days at a time.

The government said the move was necessitated by the "current prevailing geopolitical situation affecting certain regions of the world" that has adversely impacted international petroleum supply chains, shipping logistics and the avail-

ability of petroleum products.

"It has been observed in current situation that abnormal increases in sales of Motor Spirit (petrol) and High Speed Diesel (diesel) through Retail Outlets in certain parts of the country are driven by shifting of industrial, commercial and institutional consumers to Retail Outlets owing to the price difference between retail and bulk sale prices," the notification said.

According to the order, institutional, industrial and commercial consumers may be barred from procuring petrol and diesel from retail fuel stations and would instead be required to source supplies through their own consumer pumps.

The notification also restricts diesel sales at retail outlets to vehicle fuel tanks or Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation (PESO)-approved containers, with purchases capped at 200 litres per customer or vehicle per day. Such diesel "cannot be resold", the order said.

The government said bulk procurement through retail stations could divert supplies intended for ordinary consumers and "create the potential for localised shortages and disruption of essential services to the common man". The

order empowers public-sector oil marketing companies and other authorised fuel retailers to enforce the restrictions and requires state governments and Union Territories to take action against hoarding, black marketing, unauthorised procurement and diversion of fuel supplies.

Any restrictions imposed under the new framework can remain in force for an initial period of up to 90 days and may be extended through a fresh government order.

The government said the measures were aimed at ensuring the "equitable availability" of petrol and diesel, preventing hoarding and diversion, and maintaining uninterrupted supplies across the country.

"The government may by a special order exempt any consumer, class of consumers, area, transaction, or category of transactions from all or any of the provisions of this Order," the notification said, adding that any violation shall be punishable in accordance with the provisions of the Essential Commodities Act. It also directed state governments and Union Territory Administrations to take "all necessary measures to implement" the order, including "action against hoarding, black marketing, unauthorised procurement, diversion and other malpractices."

NEW DELHI: India must expand its international engagement to realise its vision of becoming a \$30 trillion economy by 2047, according to Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal.

Speaking at the closing session of the 5th Annual Meeting of the India Global Innovation Connect, the Minister emphasised that India's economic growth is not a zero-sum game. Instead, he argued that the country's trajectory is deeply linked to fostering strategic partnerships with developed nations, which stand to complement rather than compete with Indian industry.

"We have a very clear roadmap and a stated goal to make India a developed country by 2047... At that point in time, I would think the Indian economy should be anywhere in the ballpark of about \$30 trillion... This will not be possible unless we expand our international engagement," the Minister said.

He further noted that these developed economies face demographic challenges that provide a unique opening for India's growth strategy. "They have ageing populations and therefore need young talent and skill, which India has in abundance," Goyal highlighted.

The Minister explained that the high costs of research, development, and production in these advanced nations make a collaborative model essential.

"Considering all of this, we recognise that large parts of the world, Europe, the US, Canada,



Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal

Israel, Gulf countries, Australia and New Zealand are no threat to India and its businesses," the Minister added.

"Cost of production and cost of research and development in these developed economies are becoming prohibitively high... therefore, a partnership between India and such developed countries complements each other rather than competes with them," he stated.

According to Goyal, these international alliances are a calculated component of India's long-term economic roadmap. He highlighted that India has "entered into 9 free trade agreements in the last 3-3.5 years. These cover 38 countries, significantly richer and more prosperous than India... offering to them a large Indian market."

These pacts are intended to provide these nations access to India's growing market of 1.4 billion aspirational consumers while channelling much-needed capital into the Indian ecosystem.

"They also have signifi-

cant capital, pools of capital, which they want to deploy. And India is a perfect opportunity," he said.

Beyond these broad economic goals, the Minister stressed the importance of building a high-level ecosystem to promote new technologies and adhere to global quality standards.

During his visit, Goyal also held an interaction with Claude Smadja, Chairman of Smadja & Smadja, to discuss the government's efforts to bolster infrastructure and simplify the business environment.

In a post on X, Goyal said, "Had an engaging interaction with Mr. Claude Smadja, Chairman of Smadja & Smadja, at the India Global Innovation Connect 2026. Highlighted the Modi Government's dedicated efforts to boost infrastructure development, strengthen India's position in global supply chains & enhance ease of doing business while fostering innovation-led growth."

He underscored that initiatives such as "Make in India" and various business-friendly reforms are positioning the nation as an increasingly attractive destination for global investment.

"Emphasised the scale of opportunities India presents today, powered by initiatives like Make in India, a thriving manufacturing ecosystem & business-friendly reforms, positioning the nation as an attractive destination for global investment," the Minister stated.

AGENCIES

NLC India bags critical mineral block in Telangana

NEW DELHI: State-owned NLC India Ltd on Friday said it has secured a critical mineral block in Telangana.

In a stock exchange filing, the company said NLC India has been "declared as preferred bidder for critical and strategic mineral block auctions conducted by the Ministry of Mines".

The company said it has been declared the preferred bidder for the Parvathapur vanadium, titanium, and aluminium laterite block in Sanga Reddy, Telangana, following the critical and strategic mineral block auction held on June 11 by the ministry.

State-run NLC India Ltd (NLCIL) on Thursday said it has signed an MoU with CSIR-Central Electrochemical Research Institute (CSIR-CECRI), Karaikudi, for collaboration in the field of critical and strategic minerals beneficiation and extraction technologies.

Under the MoU, detailed studies will be undertaken on overburden materials and tailings generated from NLCIL's Neyveli Mines to assess the potential for extraction and recovery of rare earth elements (REEs) and other trace elements.

Both parties will also explore similar opportunities across other mining and exploration projects of NLC India, with the objective of developing sustainable and economically viable technologies for resource recovery from secondary sources.

PTI

DoT delicenss key spectrum bands for connected, autonomous vehicles

NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) has exempted the 5.9 GHz and 77-81 GHz spectrum bands from licensing requirements, a move expected to enhance vehicle safety, support intelligent transport systems and accelerate the development of connected and autonomous vehicles in India.

Under a notification issued on June 11, the 5875-5905 MHz band has been delicensed for Cellular Vehicle-to-Everything (C-V2X) communication, enabling vehicles to connect with traffic infrastructure and other road users as part of intelligent transport systems.

The spectrum can be used on a non-interference, non-protection and non-exclusive basis without assignment of radio frequency.

The notification also exempts possession, sale and hire of onboard communication units operating in the band from licensing requirements.

Similarly, the 77-81 GHz band has been delicensed for short-range automotive radar systems installed in vehicles.

These radar systems are widely used in Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS), supporting features such as automatic emergency braking, lane departure warnings and adaptive cruise control.

Industry experts welcomed the move, describing it as a major boost for road safety and innovation.

Anupam Shrivastava, former CMD of BSNL and India head of datacentre company Submer, said the deci-

sion removes a key hurdle for smart mobility by enabling real-time communication between vehicles, traffic signals and emergency services, helping reduce accidents and congestion.

IAFI President Bharat Bhatia termed the decision a landmark step that will accelerate deployment of intelligent transportation systems, improve road safety and support connected and autonomous mobility.

Former TRAI principal advisor Satya N. Gupta said delicensing 30 MHz in the lower 6 GHz band for C-V2X communications would significantly strengthen intelligent transport systems, improving safety, efficiency and passenger experience while helping reduce emissions and road accidents.

AGENCIES

Hindenburg Research: Five offshore funds named in report approach SAT against SEBI proceedings

NEW DELHI: Five offshore funds named in the January 2023 Hindenburg Research report have approached the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT), challenging adjudication proceedings initiated by the SEBI. The matter is scheduled to be heard on Friday, according to media reports.

The funds involved are Albulba Investment Fund, LTS Investment Fund, Cresta Fund, Asia Investment Corporation Mauritius and APMS Investment Fund. They have reportedly questioned SEBI's decision to initiate adjudication proceedings without disclosing the reasons and material relied upon by the regulator.

According to reports, SEBI had issued show-cause notices to the funds last year over alleged violations of disclosure norms and investment limits.

Funds have argued that while they responded to show-cause notices, SEBI did not communicate rationale for proceeding with adjudication

The notices were part of the regulator's investigation into investment structures linked to Adani Group companies following allegations raised in the Hindenburg report.

The funds have argued before SAT that while they responded to the initial show-cause notices, SEBI did not communicate the rationale for proceeding with adjudication. Their counsels have sought a

stay on the adjudication process until the tribunal decides the matter.

Media reports said the funds contended that the absence of supporting material made it difficult for them to understand the basis of the proceedings.

Their plea cites Rules 4.3 and 4.4 of the SEBI Adjudication Rules, which require an Adjudicating Officer to consider a response to a show-cause notice before deciding whether a formal inquiry is warranted.

SEBI had alleged that certain offshore funds named in the Hindenburg report may have breached disclosure requirements and prescribed investment limits. The regulator's position was that disclosures should have been made on an aggregated offshore fund group basis, rather than individually by each fund.

The dispute stems from the January 2023 Hindenburg Research report, which alleged stock manipulation and accounting irregularities within the Adani Group. The report triggered a sharp sell-off in Adani Group stocks and led to multiple regulatory and legal reviews.

The Adani Group had rejected the allegations, calling them unfounded and malicious. Following the report, SEBI launched investigations into various aspects of the allegations, including disclosures by offshore funds holding investments in Adani Group companies.

The latest challenge before SAT marks another development in the regulatory and legal proceedings arising from the Hindenburg report and its aftermath.

AGENCIES

Tata Sons Board reviews strategic priorities in key meeting at Bombay House headquarters

MUMBAI: The powerhouse board of Tata Sons convened for a pivotal meeting on Friday at its historic headquarters, Bombay House, in Mumbai.

The high-profile gathering brought together the group's top leadership and influential independent directors to deliberate on critical issues, including structural transitions, capital allocation strategy, and the group's highly debated regulatory stance.

Among the key figures who were seen arriving at the headquarters were Executive Chairman Natarajan Chandrasekaran, alongside Noel Naval Tata, Chairman of Tata Trusts, whose presence continues to highlight the strength-

ening governance alignment between the philanthropic trusts and the holding company.

The crucial meeting was also attended by T V Narendran, CEO of Tata Steel, representing the bedrock industrial side of the conglomerate. They were joined by a distinguished bench of independent directors, including Anita George, Harish Manwani, and Venu Srinivasan, the Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor Company, whose oversight is vital as the board navigates a multi-billion-dollar shift toward semiconductor manufacturing, aviation integration, and digital platforms.

While the specific resolutions remained tightly under wraps, the primary agenda

focused heavily on the group's future roadmap. Topping the table was the formal review of leadership continuity for Chandrasekaran, whose current tenure concludes in early 2027, alongside performance audits of capital-intensive ventures like Air India and Tata Neu.

Apparently, the board also evaluated its position regarding the RBIs upper-layer investment company mandates, following Tata Sons' aggressive moves to clear debt and maintain its unlisted, private status.

As the marathon session concluded, the directors left the Bombay House premises without disclosing any outcomes of the deliberations to the waiting press. The tight-lipped depart-

ure closely mirrored the aftermath of the previous six-hour special board session on May 26, which took place at the very same venue and left the market guessing.

However, this time, a subtle shift in atmosphere caught the attention of onlookers. Unlike the intense, solemn exit of the May meeting, Executive Chairman Natarajan Chandrasekaran offered a distinct, reassuring smile to the media before his vehicle pulled away. While the official boardroom verdicts remain unannounced, that fleeting smile has already ignited widespread speculation that Tata Sons is moving forward with a confident, unified vision for its next chapter.

AGENCIES

KAPURTHALA: Hitendra Malhotra, Director General (Safety), Railway Board, visited Rail Coach Factory (RCF), Kapurthala, on Friday to review coach safety, production performance and the manufacturing of new-generation coaches.

Malhotra held a meeting with General Manager Ajay Nandan, principal heads of departments and senior officers, where key issues related to coach safety and production during the current financial year were discussed. The Design Department made a presentation on initiatives undertaken to strengthen coach safety and other critical safety features.

During his visit to the work-



shop, Malhotra inspected coach manufacturing processes and reviewed the production of a rake equipped with newly introduced safety features. He also examined electrical equipment and systems installed in coaches and discussed various safety-related aspects with RCF officials. Appreciating the factory's modern infrastructure and manufacturing processes, he offered suggestions to fur-

ther enhance safety standards and operational efficiency.

The Railway Board official also visited the Technical Training Centre and reviewed employee training programmes, course content and skill-development facilities. He stressed the importance of continuous learning and upskilling to meet the evolving technological requirements of modern coach manufacturing. Commending RCF's technological advancements, Malhotra advised the factory to adopt best practices to improve safety, productivity and operational excellence. He assured Railway Board's support for RCF's growth and innovation initiatives.

MP05T

SpaceX stocks soars 23% in Wall Street debut, makes Elon Musk world's first trillionaire

The shares opened at \$150 and kept rising, reaching \$166.90 around 12:20 pm ET. That price gave the company a market value of \$2.18 trillion

NEW YORK: Shares of SpaceX soared 23 per cent in their Wall Street debut on Friday, making the rocket maker's CEO Elon Musk the first-ever trillionaire.

The shares opened at \$150 and kept rising, reaching \$166.90 around 12:20 pm ET. That price gave the company a market value of \$2.18 trillion. Forbes is now estimating Musk's net worth at \$1.1 trillion.

Institutional and retail investors jumped at the opportunity to buy 555.6 million shares of SpaceX at the offering price of \$135 apiece. The \$75 billion in proceeds easily topped the previous record IPO from oil giant

Saudi Aramco in 2019.

Musk says SpaceX is going public now because it needs money to fund its ambitions of putting satellites and data centres in space and eventually establishing a colony of people on Mars.

Musk earlier marked the opening of trading on Nasdaq, where the company's are trading under the symbol "SPCX," by joining a ceremonial bell ringing from Starbase, the South Texas home of SpaceX.

He reiterated his lofty goals "to make life multi-planetary." "Not just a few astronauts, I mean literally you," Musk said.



SpaceX CEO Elon Musk

"Whoever you are watching this, SpaceX wants to be able to take you to the moon, take you to Mars and ultimately beyond."

Known for his technology breakthroughs, as well as wild claims and missed deadlines, Musk was widely expected to

CLOSER LOOK

- » Forbes is now estimating Musk's net worth at \$1.1 trillion
- » Institutional and retail investors jumped at the opportunity to buy 555.6 million shares of SpaceX at the offering price of \$135 apiece
- » The \$75 billion in proceeds easily topped the previous record IPO from oil giant Saudi Aramco in 2019

break the trillion dollar mark despite SpaceX generating losses as big as its ambitions.

In addition to establishing a one-million person Martian colony, the company has promised to save humanity by establishing other outposts in space, launch

data centers the size of football fields into orbit and outdo rivals Anthropic and OpenAI in the race to make money from artificial intelligence.

To reach its goals, SpaceX needs billions more than it currently takes in from its rocket

and satellite business. Between the start of 2025 and March 31, 2026, the company lost \$8.7 billion.

Wall Street bankers that helped take SpaceX public are enthusiastic about the company — and the big fees they will earn — but not everyone thinks the stock price is justified.

Analysts at research firm Morningstar, which doesn't earn any investment banking fees, wrote that the IPO is "significantly overvalued" because of SpaceX's unproven technology and massive capital needs.

They estimate the company is only worth \$780 billion — less

than half its IPO value.

Still, Musk has pulled off the seemingly impossible before.

The trillionaire — on paper at least — made his fortune by creating two companies, Zip2 and PayPal, that netted him about USD200 million at sale. He used that money to start SpaceX and invest in Tesla, and defied the odds by creating a space company that figured out how to reuse rockets and a car company that made electric vehicles cool.

Musk has realised vast sums of wealth for himself, much of it in stock he has yet to cash in or grants for shares he'll only

receive if Tesla or SpaceX hit ambitious performance targets.

His recent pay package from Tesla drew criticism from the Vatican. At Tesla, he's worried shareholders by fighting with regulators or dividing his attention between multiple companies and last year by taking a role in the Trump administration.

But a rising stock price has cured all ills: Since it went public in 2010, Tesla has returned 20,000 per cent for shareholders, or more than \$1.2 trillion in investor wealth. That has helped lift Musk's pre-SpaceX IPO worth to \$795 billion, according to Forbes magazine.

AGENCIES

Mexican wave sweeps SA

Mexico gets off to roaring World Cup start with 2-0 win over South Africa

MEXICO CITY: Mexico made an immediate impression on the largest World Cup in history, giving the roaring home crowd at the iconic Azteca Stadium a huge jolt of excitement four years after a major disappointment.

Mexico's players understood the intense pressure and high expectations they were facing on Thursday in the opening match of the first 48-team World Cup tournament. But they embraced their role and got off to a winning start by beating South Africa 2-0 in a match that also produced three red cards.

"I made an effort to explain to them what a World Cup and an opening match on home soil meant, but they are young and had to experience it for themselves," said Mexico coach Javier Aguirre, who played for his team the last time Mexico hosted the tournament in 1986. "I can no longer talk about having played in a home World Cup, because they already know what it's like."

Julian Quiñones and Raúl Jiménez scored the goals for Mexico, which is co-hosting the 2026 tournament with Canada and the United States.

The Mexicans rebounded from the massive disappointment of being eliminated after the group stage four years ago in Qatar. That followed seven



Mexico's Raul Jimenez celebrates after scoring his side's second goal

BCCI

straight trips to the round the 16 — an achievement that became more of a curse for failing to reach the quarterfinals.

But there is hope this year. Mexico has reached the quarterfinals twice in its history, and both times it was the host country — in 1970 and 1986. Aguirre was on that team in 1986.

In front of a capacity crowd of 80,824, Mexico got working fast and took the lead in the ninth minute when Quiñones scored. Jiménez added the second goal on a header in 66th — his 46th for Mexico but first in

three World Cup tournaments.

"We didn't play well in the first half, but we could have gone into the break leading 3-0 and no one would have complained — we were far superior," Aguirre said. "In the second half, it felt like we relaxed a bit, but starting with a win is good, and we can certainly improve."

With his goal, Jiménez moved into a tie with Jared Borgetti for second place in scoring for Mexico's national team. He is six goals shy of leader Javier "Chicharito" Hernández.

Jiménez wears a protective headguard because he was seriously injured in November 2020 while playing for Wolverhampton Wanderers in a Premier League match against Arsenal. He fractured his skull and had to have surgery. He was out for eight months and returned in July 2021. South Africa players Sphephelo Sithole and Themba Zwane were both given red cards, forcing the team to finish with only nine players. Mexico defender César Montes was then given a red in injury time.

AGENCIES

BOTH SIDES WILL MISS KEY PLAYERS

Early blockbuster as Brazil and Morocco face off

EAST RUTHERFORD: Brazil begin their latest hunt for a long-awaited sixth World Cup crown on Saturday with little room for a gentle landing, facing up-and-coming Morocco in a Group C opener that will test the side's ability to cope with a lengthy injury list.

The record five-time winners arrive in North America under Carlo Ancelotti, whose World Cup debut as a coach comes a little over a year after he left Real Madrid following a glittering haul of European titles to take on one of football's most demanding rescue missions. Brazil have endured three turbulent years, four managers and a series of disappointments, while Neymar's long decline from untouchable talisman to fitness gamble has added uncertainty.

Where other leading contenders get a chance to ease their players into the tournament against more modest opposition, Brazil start against what is expected to be their sternest Group C test.

Morocco were the great disruptors of the 2022 World Cup in Qatar, knocking out Spain and Portugal before losing to France in the semi-finals. Built around a generation of players shaped in the academies and



Vinicius Jr will lead Brazil's attack under Ancelotti's steer

REUTERS

2

This will be just the second meeting between Brazil and Morocco at the World Cup

leagues of Spain and France, they return with enough quality to make Brazil's opening night uncomfortable.

However, they also arrive with turbulence of their own.

Injuries have added to the disruption, with Nayeef Aguerd and Abde Ezzalzouli cut from the 26-man squad after being hurt in Morocco's final friendly against Norway on Sunday.

Brazil, however, have suffered their own medical avalanche.

Ancelotti has lost Rodrygo, Estevao, Eder Militao and Wesley, all potential starters, while Neymar has been ruled out of the match as he continues to recover. When he may return, and in what condition, remains uncertain.

AGENCIES

All eyes on Rohit, Reddy as India begin road to 2027

DHARAMSALA: Rohit Sharma's match fitness will be tested but India's team management would also closely monitor Nitish Kumar Reddy's performance as a back-up for injury-prone Hardik Pandya when they formally begin their 2027 World Cup preparations with the first ever ODI series against Afghanistan here on Saturday.

Having nursed a hamstring niggle during the IPL, Rohit has managed to regain full fitness just in time for the three games against Afghanistan while top draw Virat Kohli will miss the series due to a rare hamstring injury.

As India plan for the World Cup in South Africa in October-November 2027, there are doubts over whether the



Rohit Sharma during a practice session

PTI

39-year-old Rohit can last till the ODI showpiece.

India are scheduled to play 25 odd ODIs before the mega event, giving the team enough time to experiment with players and combinations.

With two losses in three series, the start to Shubman Gill's ODI captaincy has not been smooth and working alongside head coach Gautam Gambhir, he would be expected to expand his footprint in the dressing room.

Shubman and Rohit are expected to open the innings while there would be a toss-up between comeback man Ishan Kishan and Yashasvi Jaiswal at number three in Kohli's

absence. Newly appointed T20 captain Shreyas Iyer will bat at number four. Both Rohit and Shreyas linked with the India squad in Chandigarh before the team travelled to the picturesque hill town on Thursday.

KL Rahul, the No. 1 wicket-keeper batter in the side, is part of the middle-order and Nitish Kumar Reddy is likely to follow him in the batting line-up at No. 6. Reddy's batting credentials have never been in doubt but whether he can consistently do the job with the ball as Hardik's back-up remains to be seen. Like Hardik, Reddy too had his share of injuries.

AGENCIES

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

EXAM SPECIAL TRAINS 2026

It is notified for the information of all concerned that following exam special trains will be run by Northern Railway to facilitate the candidates appearing in RRB NTPC Exam. The details are as mentioned below:-

Train No. 04321/04322 Moradabad - Dehradun - Moradabad Unreserved Exam Special Express				05 Trips		
Train No. 04321		↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No. 04322	
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.
----	22:00		Moradabad		05:00	----
06:15	----		Dehradun		----	19:50

DAYS OF RUN: 04321 Ex. Moradabad on 13.06.2026 & 14.06.2026 and 04322 Ex. Dehradun on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026 & 15.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Amroha, Gajraula Jn., Mandi Dhanaura, Chand Siau, Haldaur, Bijnor, Basi Kiratpur, Muazzampur Narain Jn., Laksar Jn., Jwalapur & Haridwar Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04323/04324 Bareilly - Ghaziabad - Bareilly Unreserved Exam Special Express					05 Trips	
Train No. 04323		↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No. 04324	
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.
----	22:50		Bareilly		23:50	----
04:35	----		Ghaziabad		----	20:10

DAYS OF RUN: 04323 Ex. Bareilly on 13.06.2026 & 14.06.2026 and 04324 Ex. Ghaziabad on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026 & 15.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Rampur, Moradabad, Amroha, Gajraula Jn. & Hapur Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04425 New Delhi - Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04425	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
New Delhi		---	04:30
Saharanpur Jn.		08:30	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04425 Ex. New Delhi on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026 & 16.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Tilak Bridge, Anand Vihar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Naya Ghaziabad, Muradnagar, Modinagar, Meerut City, Meerut Cant, Daurala, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Muzaffarnagar, Deoband, Nagal & Tapri Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04426 Saharanpur Jn. - Shakur Basti Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04426	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
Saharanpur Jn.		---	11:30
Shakur Basti		16:20	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04426 Ex. Saharanpur Jn. on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026 & 16.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Tapri Jn., Nagal, Deoband, Muzaffarnagar, Mansurpur, Khatauli, Daurala, Meerut Cant, Meerut City, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Naya Ghaziabad, Ghaziabad, Sahibabad, Anand Vihar, Tilak Bridge, New Delhi, Delhi Kishan Ganj & Dayabasti Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04427 Shakur Basti - Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04427	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
Shakur Basti		---	17:15
Saharanpur Jn.		22:00	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04427 Ex. Shakur Basti on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026 & 16.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Dayabasti, Delhi Kishan Ganj, New Delhi, Tilak Bridge, Anand Vihar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Naya Ghaziabad, Muradnagar, Modinagar, Meerut City, Meerut Cant, Daurala, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Muzaffarnagar, Deoband, Nagal & Tapri Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04428 Saharanpur Jn. - Shakur Basti Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04428	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
Saharanpur Jn.		---	04:45
Shakur Basti		09:40	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04428 Ex. Saharanpur on 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026, 16.06.2026 & 17.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Tapri Jn., Nagal, Deoband, Muzaffarnagar, Mansurpur, Khatauli, Daurala, Meerut Cant, Meerut City, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Naya Ghaziabad, Ghaziabad, Sahibabad, Anand Vihar, Tilak Bridge, New Delhi, Delhi Kishan Ganj & Dayabasti Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04429 Shakur Basti - Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04429	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
Shakur Basti		---	10:50
Saharanpur Jn.		15:30	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04429 Ex. Shakur Basti on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026 & 16.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Dayabasti, Delhi Kishan Ganj, New Delhi, Tilak Bridge, Anand Vihar, Sahibabad, Ghaziabad, Naya Ghaziabad, Muradnagar, Modinagar, Meerut City, Meerut Cant, Daurala, Khatauli, Mansurpur, Muzaffarnagar, Deoband, Nagal & Tapri Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04430 Saharanpur Jn. - New Delhi Unreserved Exam Special Express		04 Trips	
STATIONS		Train No. 04430	
↓		ARR.	DEP.
Saharanpur Jn.		---	17:45
New Delhi		22:30	---

DAYS OF RUN: 04430 Ex. Saharanpur Jn. on 13.06.2026, 14.06.2026, 15.06.2026 & 16.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Tapri Jn., Nagal, Deoband, Muzaffarnagar, Mansurpur, Khatauli, Daurala, Meerut Cant, Meerut City, Modinagar, Muradnagar, Naya Ghaziabad, Ghaziabad, Sahibabad, Anand Vihar & Tilak Bridge Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04643/04644 Firozpur Cant - Amritsar-Firozpur Cant Unreserved Exam Special Express					16 Trips	
Train No. 04643		↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No. 04644	
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.
-----	05:10		Firozpur Cant		23:20	----
09:30	-----		Amritsar		-----	19:30

DAYS OF RUN: 04643 Ex. Firozpur Cant & 04644 Ex. Amritsar from 13.06.2026 to 20.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Makhu, Lohian Khas Jn., Sultanpur Lodi, Kapurthala, Jalandhar City & Beas Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04645/04646 Ludhiana Jn. - Jalandhar City- Ludhiana Jn. Unreserved Exam Special Express					16 Trips	
Train No. 04645		↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No. 04646	
ARR.	DEP.				ARR.	DEP.
----	12:00		Ludhiana Jn.		20:50	----
13:10	----		Jalandhar City		----	19:30

DAYS OF RUN: 04645 Ex. Ludhiana Jn. & 04646 Ex. Jalandhar City from 13.06.2026 to 20.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Phillaur Jn. & Phagwara Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

Train No. 04549/04550 Saharanpur Jn. - Jalandhar City - Saharanpur Jn. Unreserved Exam Special Express				16 Trips	
Train No. 04549		↓ STATIONS ↑	Train No. 04550		
ARR.	DEP.		ARR.	DEP.	
----	05:00	Saharanpur Jn.	21:15	----	
10:50	----	Jalandhar City	----	15:20	

DAYS OF RUN: 04549 Ex. Saharanpur & 04550 Ex. Jalandhar City from 13.06.2026 to 20.06.2026.

STOPPAGES: Sarsawa, Yamunanagar Jagadhri, Jagadhri Workshop, Mustafabad, Barara, Ambala Cant Jn., Ambala City, Rajpura Jn., Sirhind Jn., Khanna, Ludhiana Jn., Phillaur Jn. & Phagwara Jn. Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General.

For any kind of information, passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

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NORTHERN RAILWAY
Open E-Tender Notice

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of Work	Provision of New RPF Barrack two story 100 Bed Capacity at Delhi Main station and Provision of Dog kennel cum breeding center for RPF at Delhi main station (04 Nos) ANVT (02 Nos) and HN2M (02 Nos) in the section of ADEN/DLI NDLS & HN2M.
Approx. Cost of work	₹ 4,57,31,750.40 (Rupees Four Crore Fifty Seven Lakh Thirty One Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty and Forty Paise only)
Earnest Money to be Deposit	₹ 9,14,600.00/- (Rupees Nine Lacs Fourteen Thousand Six Hundred Only)
Cost of tender document	₹ 0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	06.07.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
Allocation	20646203

*The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system.

*For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.

*No manual offers are acceptable.

*Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/28-2026-27/W-3 Dated : 12.06.2026 2017/2026

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OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY JKRRDA JAMMU
Phone No.: 0191-2470284, Fax No.: 0191-2479335

Sub:- Change of critical dates of bids / extension of Notice Inviting Tenders

Ref:- This office e-NIT No. CEJ/PMGSY/812 of 2026-27 dated 18-05-2026 issued vide endorsement No:- CEJ/PMGSY/3316-90 dated 18-05-2026.

CORRIGENDUM

Due to poor response of the work at Serial No. 06, 07, 08, 14 & 15 of the above mentioned NIT, the critical dates have been changed as per details given below:-

S.No	Particular	Original date	Revised date
1	Closing date of down loading bidding documents.	11-06-2026 (05.00 PM)	15-06-2026 (05.00 PM)
2	Dead line for submission of bids in electronic format on the web site.	11-06-2026 (05.00 PM)	15-06-2026 (05.00 PM)
3	Time and date of opening of received bids on the website.	13-06-2026(11.00 AM)	17-06-2026 (02.00 PM)

Rest all other terms and conditions will remain same as already advertised.

No:-CEJ/PMGSY/5710-5784

Dated:-11-06-2026

DIP No:DIP/J-3538/26

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu
For and on behalf of The Government of Jammu and Kashmir

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, रामगढ़।

अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा संख्या:- 03R3/2024-25/RWD/RAMGARH दिनांक :- 11.06.2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, रामगढ़ द्वारा मुख्यमंत्री ग्राम सड़क योजनान्तर्गत निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र० सं०	आईडेंट्री फिकेशन संख्या	प्रखण्ड	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	टेंडर कॉल
1	RWD/RAMGARH/04/2024-25/PMGSY	रामगढ़	लावालींग शोलेस चौधरी के घर से खैरा सौड़ा होते हुए लुकया तक पथ निर्माण कार्य। (1.600 कि०मी०)	141.464	09 माह	चतुर्थ

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि:- 15.06.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय:- 22.06.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।

4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:- 24.06.2026 अपराह्न 11.30 बजे।

5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता:- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, रामगढ़, नयानगर, धुदुवा, बरकाकाना, रामगढ़ झारखण्ड, पिन- 829103

6. ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया का दृष्टांत सं०- 06553254005

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग
कार्य प्रमंडल, रामगढ़।

PR 382256 (Rural Work Department) 26-27 (D)

NORTHERN RAILWAY	
NOTICE INVITING TENDER	
Name of work and its location	91-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Electrical work in connection with "Removing, commissioning and other associated works of Pumps over Delhi Division".
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 9887080.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 197800.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	06.07.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	06.07.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divt. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2030/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
E-Tendering Tender Notice	
Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.	
E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-GSU-2026-04	
Description of work : Track work-Khajuraho-setting-up an Electric Locomotive Trip Shed at Khajuraho.	
Approx Cost(Rs): 18882415.92	Earnest Money(Rs): 377700.00
Date of closing Tender : 01.07.2026	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 month	
• Tender online can be submitted up to 10:30 hrs on 01.07.2026	
• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1321/26 (ADM)	
North central railways @ CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in	

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
T. Notice No. GSU/Elect/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/67 Date- 11.06.2026	
E-Tender Notice	
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/GSU/N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-	
Tender No.: GSU-EL-WC-80-2026	
Description of work: 25 kV OHE modification work due to (1) Provision of Advance Trip Maintenance Centre at Electric Trip Shed PRYJ (2) Provision of Advance Trip Maintenance Centre at Electric Trip Shed, at CNB WL & GMC area in Prayagraj division.	
Advised Value: ₹ 31836849.81	Bid Security: ₹ 637600.00
Completion Period: 12 months	Bidding System: Single Packet
Tender Closing Date & Time: 06.07.2026 & 14.00 Hrs.	
Tender Opening Date & Time: 06.07.2026 & 15.00 Hrs.	
Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 3. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 4. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1332/26 FA	
North central railways @ CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in	

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON	
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023	
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Sunil Kumar S/o Bhora Lal R/o N-251, Sector-01, DSIIDC, Bawana, Outer North, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 449/2019, U/S 323/341 IPC, PS Bawana, Outer North Distt., Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Sunil Kumar cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Sunil Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);	
Proclamation is hereby made that Sunil Kumar the said accused of FIR No. 449/2019, U/S 323/341 IPC, PS Bawana, Outer North Distt., Delhi , is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 27.07.2026 .	
By Order Ms. Bharti Beniwal Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, North Distt., Room No.-114, 1st Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi	
DP/7884/ON/2026 (Court Matter)	

APPENDIX IV-A		
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property		
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.		
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd. ("IHFL") [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] and Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Company Limited [CIN : U67110MH2006PLC305312] acting as a Trustee of Indiabulls ARC - XXXI Trust (both SCL and IARCL) are jointly and severally referred to as ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 30.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of the following amounts due to SCL and IARCL: DUES OF SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.):		
S. No.	Loan Account Number	Outstanding Amounts (In Rs.) as on 11.06.2026
1.	HHLDP00190322	Rs. 23,58,566/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh Fifty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Sixty Six only)
DUES OF INDIABULLS ASSET RECONSTRUCTION COMPANY LIMITED:		
S. No.	Loan Account Number	Outstanding Amounts (In Rs.) as on 11.06.2026
1.	M012XXXI (Old Loan Account No. HHLNOD00316624)	Rs. 8,09,803/- (Rupees Eight Lakh Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Three only)
The Loan Account No. HHLNOD00316624, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s) including the Immovable Property, has been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd. ("IHFL") to and in favour of Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Company Limited ("IARCL") vide Assignment Agreement dated 21.08.2023, and the same has been renounced by IARCL and bears new Loan Account No. M012XXXI. Consequently, IARCL has also become a Secured Creditor for the said assigned Loan Account. IARCL has given its consent to SCL to issue this Notice of Sale.		
The amounts mentioned in both the tables given above are pending towards the respective Loan Accounts of SCL and IARCL, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 11.06.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement(s) and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 12.06.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges are also due and payable to the Secured Creditor from MANOJ KUMAR and RADHA PANDEY.		
The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be Rs. 10,00,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 1,00,000/- (Rupees One Lakh only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.		
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY		
FLAT NO. - S - 5, SECOND FLOOR REAR RHS, LIG, PLOT NO. - B - 1/143 DLF DILSHAD EXTN. - II, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH - 201010.		
For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124 - 6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.		
Sd/- AUTHORIZED OFFICER SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)		
Date : 12.06.2026 Place : GHAZIABAD		

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
E-Tendering Tender Notice	
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.	
E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG - C - 2026-141	
Description of work : VGLJ - CNB Section:- Construction of road under bridge (RUB) at trespassing location km 125/30-2 in between Sarsoki -Ata stations.	
Approx Cost : 52656964.09	Earnest Money : 1053100.00
Date of completion /period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months	
Date of closing Tender : 06/07/2026 at 15:00 hrs., Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 06.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1325/26 (D)	
North central railways @ CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in	

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)										
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts										
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.										
Website : https://auction.arcil.co.in ; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884										
PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002										
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e-auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").										
Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrowers / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notice dated 08.04.2021	Possession type and date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction	
Borrower : 1. RANA PRATAP MUKHERJEE 2. DIPANWITA MUKHERJEE	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00320990	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 17,62,506/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Sixty Two Thousand Five Hundred Six only) as on 31.03.2021 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 29.10.2025	Will be arranged on request	Freehold - 400 Sq. ft. (total area)	Rs. 1,35,500/- (Rupees One Lakh Thirty Five Thousand Five Hundred only)	Rs. 13,55,000/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Fifty Five Thousand only)	On 29.07.2026 at 04:30 P.M.	
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : RESIDENTIAL FLAT BEARING NO. - S - 3 (L.I.G.), HAVING TOTAL AREA OF 400 SQUARE FEET EQUIVALENT TO 37.16 SQUARE METERS ON SECOND FLOOR, FRONT LEFT HAND SIDE (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS), CONSTRUCTED UPON PART OF PLOT NO. - A - 1/46, DLF DILSHAD EXTENSION - II, SITUATED IN VILLAGE BHOPURA, PARGANA LONI, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201010, UTTAR PRADESH.										
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL		Nil		Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL			Nil			
Last Date for submission of Bid		Same day 2 hours before Auction		Bid Increment amount :			As mentioned in the BID document			
Demand Draft to be made in name of :		ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST Payable at par								
RTGS details		ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. – 57500001353101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamala Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.								
Name of Contact person & number		Deepak Tripathi – 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).								
Terms and Conditions : 1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein. 2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc. 3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice. 4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law. 5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues. 6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission. 7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale. 8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.										
Place : GHAZIABAD Date : 04.06.2026		Sd/- Authorized Officer Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust)								

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)										
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts										
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.										
Website : https://auction.arcil.co.in ; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884										
PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002										
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e-auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").										
Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrowers / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notice dated 19.09.2017	Possession type and date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction	
Borrower : 1. MR. MANOJ KUMAR 2. MRS. SHAKUNTALA DEVI	Loan Account No. HHLNOD00220610	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 18,04,937/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Four Thousand Nine Hundred Thirty Seven only) as on 19.09.2017 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 08.04.2026	Will be arranged on request	Freehold 400 Sq. ft. (covered area)	Rs. 1,50,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand only)	Rs. 15,00,000/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh only)	On 10.07.2026 at 04:45 P.M.	
Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned : FREE HOLD RESIDENTIAL FLAT NO. G - 2, GROUND FLOOR (L.I.G.), REAR LEFT HAND SIDE WITHOUT ROOF RIGHT, HAVING SUPER COVERED AREA OF 400 SQUARE FEET. E. 37.16 SQUARE METER CONSISTING OF ONE BEDROOM, ONE DRAWING CUM DINING ROOM, ONE KITCHEN AND ONE TOILET, BUILT ON PLOT NO. 173, SITUATED AT SHALIMAR GARDEN EXTENSION - 1, HADBAST VILLAGE PASONDA, PARGANA LONI, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201010, UTTAR PRADESH AND BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS : EAST : SERVICE LANE; WEST : 40 FEET ROAD; NORTH : PLOT NO. 172; SOUTH : PLOT NO. 174.										
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL		Nil		Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL			Nil			
Last Date for submission of Bid		Same day 2 hours before Auction		Bid Increment amount :			As mentioned in the BID document			
Demand Draft to be made in name of :		ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST		Payable at par						
RTGS details		ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. - 57500001353101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamala Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.								
Name of Contact person & number		Deepak Tripathi - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).								
Terms and Conditions : 1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website https://auction.arcil.co.in and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein. 2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") / ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc. 3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice. 4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law. 5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues. 6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission. 7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale. 8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.										
Place : GHAZIABAD Date : 04.06.2026		Sd/- Authorized Officer Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust)								

Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)

Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts

Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.

Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e-auction, for recovery of outstanding dues together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrowers / Guarantor/s / Mortgager/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding amount as per SARFAESI Notice dated 09.07.2019	Possession type and date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. MOHD. BASHARATULLAH 2. SAYEEDA KHATOON	Loan Account No. HHLN00100377600 Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Ltd. ("EARC")	Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust	Rs. 12,21,759/- (Rupees Twelve Lakh Twenty One Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Nine only) as on 09.07.2019 + further interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 19.12.2024	Will be arranged on request	Freehold - 32 sq. yards	Rs. 1,06,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Six Thousand only)	Rs. 10,60,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh Sixty Thousand only)	On 10.07.2026 at 05:45 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned :
FLAT ON FIRST FLOOR, BUILT ON HOUSE NO. A-1/199, ADMEASURING AREA 36 SQ. YARD, COMPRISING ONE BED ROOM, ONE DRAWING / DINING ROOM, KITCHEN AND TWO TOILETS, SITUATED AT DLF DILSHAD EXTN. - II, VILLAGE BRAHAMPURA @ BHOPURA, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201003, UTTAR PRADESH. THE PROPERTY IS BOUNDED AS UNDER :
EAST : PLOT NO. A-1/198, WEST : PLOT NO. A-1/200, NORTH : 25 FEET WIDE ROAD ON THE GROUND FLOOR, SOUTH : PLOT.

Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - CPS - IV - TRUST, Trust Account No. - 5750000133101, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamala Mill, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Deepak Tripathi - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

- The Auction Sale will be conducted through e-auction through the website <https://auction.arcil.co.in> and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
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Place : GHAZIABAD
Date : 04.06.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd.
(Trustee of Arcil - CPS - IV - Trust)



I think it's pretty cool: Janhvi

Janhvi Kapoor opened up about stepping outside her comfort zone for 'Peddi'

Janhvi Kapoor memorised her Telugu lines, walked into a scene she was terrified of and came out the other side with a story she said she will pass on to her children. In a recent interview, the actress reflected on 'Peddi', the director she trusted completely and what Sridevi taught her without ever meaning to.

Buchi Babu Sana made his directorial debut with 'Uppena' in 2021, which won the National Film Award for 'Best Feature Film' in Telugu. For Janhvi Kapoor, that track record mattered. When the question of creative control came up during an interaction with 'Beyond the Brief by District Movies', she was clear about where the final word rests. "The director obviously gets the final word because he is the one who says cut. And especially when it is a director like Buchi Babu Sana, who has a track record of making such amazing, rooted work like 'Uppena'," said Janhvi.

In 'Peddi', set against the backdrop of 1980s rural Andhra Pradesh, the actor plays a character named Achiyyamma in a story about a spirited villager who unites his community through sports to defend their pride against a powerful rival. It is a significant departure from anything she has played



One of the most striking moments she described from the shoot wasn't a deeply human one

before and she knew it going in. One of the most striking moments Janhvi described from the shoot wasn't a technically demanding scene but a deeply human one. There were two instances in the film where her character addresses a large crowd. The lines were in Telugu, a language she doesn't speak natively and she had memorised the monologue to deliver on set. "When I delivered my monologue, everyone in the crowd started clapping," she said, adding, "because I think even they were surprised that I mugged up the lines and performed it. So that was a very tangible visual validation." Janhvi Kapoor has spoken before about growing up in the shadow of Sridevi's extraordinary dedication to her craft. Sridevi worked across Telugu, Tamil, Hindi, Malayalam, and Kannada films over a career that spanned five decades. The stories that circulated about her on-set commitment became part of the family mythology that Janhvi grew up with. "I've grown up on stories of my mother saying, 'Oh, I shot this rain song with a 104 fever' or 'danced until my feet bled'. I've sort of always glorified that work ethic and tried to stick by it," she said.

AGENCIES

Priyanka hails Madhuri for 'Maa Behen'

Chopra wrote a detailed note appreciating the film's writing, performances and direction



Priyanka Chopra Jonas heaped praise on Suresh Triveni's dark comedy-thriller 'Maa Behen'. The movie, which is currently streaming online, opened to glowing reviews and even a shoutout from Chopra, who took to 'Instagram' to congratulate the entire cast and crew.

In her 'Instagram Story', Priyanka wrote a detailed note appreciating the film's writing, performances and direction.

She said, "Such a clever film. Sharp, funny and so well done. My queen Madhuri Dixit Nene, always the scene stealer and the phenomenon Triptii Dimri, what an amazing show and tell! And Dharna, I have been such a fan always and I cannot wait to see what all you unleash upon us. Keep crushing!! And most importantly... So honest and cine-

The film follows the story of three women who discover a dead body inside their home

matic. Suresh Triveni, such a beautiful vision. Congratulations to the entire team."

Director Suresh Triveni was quick to respond after Priyanka shared her appreciation post. Resharing her story, he wrote, "This means a world, Priyanka Chopra... Woah!"

'Maa Behen' follows the story of three women who discover a dead body inside their home. Using this domestic noir setup, the film touches upon themes of everyday patriarchy and misogyny.

AGENCIES

Akshay explains 'flop actor' remark in 'Welcome to the Jungle'

Bollywood superstar Akshay Kumar explained the reason behind using the expression 'flop actor' for him in his upcoming film 'Welcome to the Jungle'. The actor attended the trailer launch of his upcoming film in the city on Thursday.

When asked why the makers of the film deem it fit to use the expression for him, the actor said that the phrase should be seen in the context of a film rather than as a personal remark.

"We are not told that you have to use such dialogues as taunts. So, when you watch a movie, I am sure you are a smart person. Whenever you watch a movie, you watch it according to its character. So, please, thank you for feeling bad about it. But don't take it so seriously," said the actor.

Elsewhere during the event, the superstar, whose romance with actress Raveena Tandon during the 1990s enjoyed significant public attention, spoke up about her. He shared how times have changed as his former love interest once ruled Bollywood as a heroine, but now, she has become the heroine's mother. The superstar pointed to Raveena's daughter, Rasha Thadani.

Kumar also lauded Raveena for her professionalism and strong set of ethics, as the former said, "I want to tell you about Raveena that she has been very, very professional. I still remember, I was shooting a film where the sun was about to set. And when the sun was about to set, there were only 25-30 minutes. And the green room was very far and she had to quickly change and come. That was impossible. But I still remember, she went to the generator van and quickly changed and came."

AGENCIES



SONGWRITERS HALL OF FAME

TAYLOR BECOMES THE YOUNGEST WOMAN INDUCTED AT AGE 36

'It was instinctual. No one taught me how to do it,' says Swift

Taylor Swift became the youngest woman ever inducted into the 'Songwriters Hall of Fame' on Thursday night at age 36.

"It was instinctual. No one taught me how to do it," she said of songwriting through a raspy voice she attributed to screaming along to the night's performances and Wednesday night's historic NBA game between the New York Knicks and the San Antonio Spurs.

She told the room about her family uprooting their lives to move her from Pennsylvania to Nashville, Tennessee, as a teen. "I will never be able to express my gratitude," the singer-songwriter said while holding back tears, crediting their sacrifice for her career.

She offered young songwriters her advice: "You really have to prioritise what you love, down to your very core. Because you'll need that."

Steven Spielberg intro-



She has brought new eyes to this year's ceremony and undeniably shaped contemporary pop music trends with her songwriting

duced Swift with a surprise speech about the power of songwriting. "There is something undeniable about how songs imprint on our souls,"

he said, before changing his focus to Swift. "Somehow, Taylor knows us all too well." Swift started her speech by acknowledging Spielberg. "Because of examples like Steven's, I trusted my imagination," she said.

The Gen Z singer Sombra launched Swift's segment by performing 'Cardigan' and 'Dear John' in front of her.

Swift has brought new eyes to this year's ceremony and undeniably shaped contemporary pop music trends with her songwriting. Swift is the youngest woman inducted, but Stevie Wonder, who started his recording career at 13, was the youngest ever inducted, it was announced on stage. It was a notable moment in an evening full of them, where Swift, Kiss' Gene Simmons and Paul Stanley, Christopher 'Tricky' Stewart, Alanis Morissette, Kenny Loggins and more were honoured.

AGENCIES



The Love Hypothesis to stream on Prime Video on Sept 23

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Based on the 'New York Times' best-selling novel by Ali Hazelwood, 'Prime Video' released the first images from 'The Love Hypothesis', which will stream globally on September 23.

It follows Olive (Lili Reinhart), a brilliant PhD candidate focused on her academic future. But when she realises her best friend Ahn (Rachel Marsh) has fallen for her crush Jeremy (Nicholas Duvernay), Olive impulsively kisses intimidating professor Adam Carlsen (Tom Bateman) to prove she's moved on.

What begins as a desperate act of friendship spirals into a fake relationship with rules, boundaries and a mutually beneficial agreement. When their



arrangement begins to blur the lines between performance and reality, Olive is forced to test her most daunting hypothesis yet: that love might actually be worth the risk.

Directed by Claire Scanlon, the cast of 'The Love Hypothesis' also includes Jaboukie Young-White and Arty Froushan.

Steven Spielberg says Bond franchise can't afford him

'I've regrets that they didn't approach me to direct a Bond film,' he says

Director Steven Spielberg wanted to add a Bond film to his storied career in Hollywood but was rejected twice. Now, he believes the makers cannot afford him.

During a recent interview on 'The Rest Is Entertainment' podcast, the 'Disclosure Day' director was asked whether he had any regrets about not helming a 007 film.

"I have regrets that they didn't approach me to direct a Bond film. I approached Cubby Broccoli (James Bond franchise producer) after 'Jaws' was a big hit. I'd



always wanted to make a James Bond film from the day I saw 'Dr No', so I called Cubby Broccoli after 'Jaws' and volunteered. I said, 'If

you need a director, I would love to direct one'. And he said no and he moved on."

The 'E.T. The Extra-Terrestrial' director then pitched himself again after the release of 'Close Encounters of the Third Kind' when Broccoli reached out to him, asking to use the film's iconic five-note musical melody in a scene in 1979's 'Moonraker'.

"I said, 'I'll make you a deal. I'll give you permission to use the five notes if you let me direct a Bond film'. And he said no. But I gave him the five notes anyway," Spielberg recounted. "They consistently turned me down.

He never explained why he wasn't letting me into the Bond family."

But this missed opportunity led to one of his most memorable franchises in 'Indiana Jones'. He went on to direct four films in the series. "When I told the story to George Lucas in 1977, when we were in Hawaii together getting ready for the release of 'Star Wars: A New Hope', he said, 'I have something better than Bond. It's called Indiana Smith', which is what it was called at the time. He told me the premise of the 'Indiana Jones' series and that's how I got that job." PTI